

IELTS Listening — Full Tests 1-10

Eleven v4 production edition · 10 tests · 40 parts · 400 questions

IELTS AI by nextED

About these tests

- Full four-part tests in the Cambridge IELTS format: Part 1 everyday conversation, Part 2 everyday monologue, Part 3 academic discussion, Part 4 lecture; 10 questions per part, answers in question order (except within a “choose TWO” group).
- Harder than the practice bank and about 10-15% longer than a typical test (Part 1-2: 850-1,000 spoken words; Part 3: 950-1,100; Part 4: 900-1,050). Every question carries a distractor: corrections and changed plans, options mentioned then rejected, negative contractions that reverse a meaning, “used to / now” contrasts, all multiple-choice options mentioned, extra matching options, spelled names and confusable numbers.
- Each key is tied to an exact quote in the script (machine-checked for order, word limits and spoken form), and every test was then solved blind by an independent reviewer against the key; ambiguous items were fixed. Band 7-8 targets are estimates for practice, not calibrated on candidates. Original material, not official Cambridge content.

Eleven v4 production guide

Topic	Guidance
Model	eleven_v4 for every part. Parts 1 and 3: Text to Dialogue, one voice per speaker label. Parts 2 and 4: Text to Speech with one voice.
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 for dialogues, $\approx$ 0.60 for monologues and lectures; Similarity $\approx$ 0.75.
Narrator	One narrator voice for all ten tests (neutral, measured British RP). Narrator lines (grey) are generated separately and spliced in; they are not part of the dialogue chunks.
Pauses	v4 has no SSML. Short pauses are written as [short pause], ellipses and sentence breaks. The exam pauses after narrator lines (30 s reading time, 45 s before Part 4, 60 s checking time, 120 s at the end) are added in post-production as marked.
Accents	Pick Voice Library voices whose own accent matches the part (en-GB, en-AU, en-US, en-CA, en-NZ; Scottish/Irish/South African where noted). Give each speaker in a dialogue a clearly different voice.
Tags	Square-bracket directions ([hesitant, thinking aloud], [correcting herself], [chuckles]) are not spoken. Paste the script exactly as printed. Scene cues appear only at the start of a scene; if one misfires, delete it and add a separate sound effect, kept very low.
Numbers & spelling	Answer-bearing numbers are written as words the way a speaker says them; spelled names are letter by letter with ellipses so v4 separates the letters.
Long scripts	Every part is longer than a single 4,500-character generation, so scripts are split at speaker-turn boundaries into purple "Chunk n of N" sections. Generate chunk by chunk and pass neighbouring text as previous_text / next_text (API) so tone stays continuous.
Maps / plans	Map-labelling tasks include a written plan description for the designer. Draw each plan exactly as described: the directions in the audio depend on it.
QA before release	Listen against the answer key: each answer clearly audible, self-corrections natural, no tag read aloud, letters separated in spelled words, speakers distinguishable. Regenerate a single line when one turn is off.

Test index

Test	Part	Title	Questions	Accent
FT01	1	Hiring a Community Hall	note completion 1–6, multiple choice 7–10	British (en-GB)
FT01	2	Open Day at Brickfield City Farm	multiple choice 11–15, map labelling 16–20	British (en-GB)
FT01	3	Dissertation: Food-Packaging Waste in Supermarkets	multiple choice 21–25, matching 26–30	Tutor British (en-GB); Kirsty Australian (en-AU); Owen British (en-GB)
FT01	4	The History and Science of Glassmaking	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)
FT02	1	Joining a Car-Share Club	form completion 1–7, multiple choice 8–10	Australian (en-AU)
FT02	2	The Ashcombe Heritage Trail	matching 11–16, multiple choice 17–20	British (en-GB)
FT02	3	Seminar Presentation: How Young Children Acquire Language	multi select 21–22, multi select 23–24, multiple choice 25–30	British (en-GB) and New Zealand (en-NZ)
FT02	4	Urban Heat Islands	note completion 31–40	Canadian (en-CA)
FT03	1	Booking a Canal Narrowboat Holiday	note completion 1–5, table completion 6–10	British (en-GB)
FT03	2	Induction for Volunteer Theatre Ushers	map labelling 11–15, multiple choice 16–20	British (en-GB)

Test	Part	Title	Questions	Accent
FT03	3	River Erosion Field-Trip Report	matching 21–25, multiple choice 26–30	British (en-GB); one student Scottish-accented (en-GB)
FT03	4	The Economics of the Medieval English Wool Trade	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)
FT04	1	Reporting a Lost Bag	form completion 1–10	British (en-GB)
FT04	2	The Mill Lane Allotment Scheme	multi select 11–12, multi select 13–14, matching 15–20	British (en-GB)
FT04	3	A Sleep and Memory Experiment	flow chart completion 21–24, multiple choice 25–30	American (en-US) and British (en-GB)
FT04	4	Bioluminescence in Deep-Sea Animals	note completion 31–40	Australian (en-AU)
FT05	1	A Home Contents Insurance Quote	form completion 1–6, table completion 7–10	British (en-GB)
FT05	2	Arriving in Kelmouth	map labelling 11–16, multiple choice 17–20	British (en-GB)
FT05	3	Case Study: A Failed Product Launch	multiple choice 21–24, matching 25–30	Tutor British (en-GB); Leah Canadian (en-CA); Owen British (en-GB)
FT05	4	The Printing Press and the Spread of Literacy	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)
FT06	1	Joining a Running Club	note completion 1–10	Australian (en-AU) secretary · British (en-GB) caller
FT06	2	Outdoor Education Week	multiple choice 11–14, matching 15–20	British (en-GB)
FT06	3	Commuting Survey Data	summary completion 21–25, multiple choice 26–30	British (en-GB) · Irish-accented English (en-GB)
FT06	4	How Suspension Bridges Carry Loads	note completion 31–40	American (en-US)
FT07	1	Renting a Flat	form completion 1–5, table completion 6–10	British (en-GB)
FT07	2	A New Exhibition of Historical Maps	multiple choice 11–15, map labelling 16–20	British (en-GB)
FT07	3	A Presentation on Bioplastics	matching 21–26, multiple choice 27–30	Tutor British (en-GB); student Australian (en-AU)
FT07	4	The Domestication of the Horse	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)
FT08	1	A Volunteer Conservation Week	note completion 1–10	Canadian (en-CA) organiser · British (en-GB) caller
FT08	2	Ashcombe Botanic Garden	map labelling 11–15, matching 16–20	British (en-GB)
FT08	3	Placements in a Theatre Costume Department	multiple choice 21–25, matching 26–30	British (en-GB)
FT08	4	Ice Cores and Past Climate	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)
FT09	1	Ordering Food for a Staff Lunch	form completion 1–4, table completion 5–10	British (en-GB)
FT09	2	Volunteering at a Community Radio Station	multiple choice 11–15, matching 16–20	Australian (en-AU)

Test	Part	Title	Questions	Accent
FT09	3	Choosing Archaeology Modules	matching 21–25, multiple choice 26–30	British (en-GB) tutor and student; South African English student
FT09	4	Desalination Technologies	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)
FT10	1	Booking a Wildlife Boat Trip	table completion 1–6, note completion 7–10	British (en-GB)
FT10	2	Changes to Ashbury Market	multi select 11–12, multiple choice 13–16, map labelling 17–20	British (en-GB)
FT10	3	The Economics of Music Streaming	multiple choice 21–25, matching 26–30	Tutor British (en-GB); Maya American (en-US); Callum British (en-GB)
FT10	4	Animal Camouflage	note completion 31–40	British (en-GB)

Listening Full Test 1

FT01 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Hiring a Community Hall	British (en-GB)
2	Open Day at Brickfield City Farm	British (en-GB)
3	Dissertation: Food-Packaging Waste in Supermarkets	Tutor British (en-GB); Kirsty Australian (en-AU); Owen British (en-GB)
4	The History and Science of Glassmaking	British (en-GB)

Hiring a Community Hall

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A man phones a community centre to hire its hall for his mother's seventieth birthday party.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Janet	Centre bookings manager — female, 50s, brisk but warm, efficient; British accent (southern England)
Voice: Daniel	Caller — male, 30s, friendly, slightly rushed and disorganised; British accent
Script length	5,879 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a man phoning a community centre to book a room for a family party. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 6. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Janet: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [brisk, friendly]* Good morning, Larkfield Community Centre, Janet speaking. How can I help?

Daniel: *[friendly, slightly rushed]* Oh, hello. Um, I'm ringing about hiring one of your rooms for a party. It's for my mum — she's turning seventy, and we wanted to do something a bit special for her.

Janet: *[warm]* Oh, how lovely. Well, you've come to the right place, we do a lot of birthdays. Let me just take a few details first. Could I have your name?

Daniel: Yes, it's Daniel Cartwell.

Janet: *[typing, murmuring]* Daniel... Cartwright, was that?

Daniel: *[light laugh]* Everyone says that. No, it's Cartwell. C... A... R... T... W... E... double L.

Janet: *[repeating slowly, as if writing it down]* C, A, R, T, W, E, double L. Got it, thank you. And what sort of date were you thinking of?

Daniel: *[thinking aloud]* Well, her actual birthday is Wednesday the tenth of May, but obviously a weekday's no good for most people, so we were looking at the Saturday after that... the thirteenth.

Janet: *[apologetic]* Ah. *[short pause]* I'm afraid the thirteenth has gone. We've got a wedding reception in all day. How about the following Saturday?

Daniel: *[hesitant, checking]* So that'd be... the twentieth?

Janet: That's right. The twentieth is completely free at the moment.

Daniel: *[relieved]* Then let's go for that. My sister did say she couldn't make the thirteenth anyway, so it's probably for the best.

Janet: *[efficient]* Lovely, I'll pencil you in. And roughly how many guests are you expecting?

Daniel: *[uncertain, a little embarrassed]* That's the tricky bit. We sent out sixty invitations, but quite a few people are bringing partners, and Mum keeps adding cousins I've never heard of... *[chuckles]* so realistically we're planning for about eighty-five.

Janet: *[thoughtful]* Eighty-five. Right, that does narrow things down. Our Willow Room is lovely, but it only takes forty-five, so that's out. The main hall holds two hundred...

Daniel: *[doubtful]* That sounds a bit enormous for us.

Janet: *[agreeing]* It can feel rather empty with a smaller group, yes. So I'd suggest the Orchard Room. It takes up to a hundred, and it opens straight onto the garden, which is nice in May.

Daniel: *[pleased]* Oh, that sounds perfect. Mum's a keen gardener.

Janet: *[informative]* Now, the price. On a Saturday the standard rate is forty-five pounds an hour...

Daniel: *[slightly worried]* Ah. Right.

Janet: *[correcting herself, a little flustered]* No, hang on, sorry, that's the main hall. I was looking at the wrong line. The Orchard Room is thirty-eight pounds an hour.

Daniel: *[relieved]* Thirty-eight. That's better than I expected. Is there a discount for people who live locally? Someone told me there was.

Janet: *[regretful]* There used to be, but the trustees stopped it last year, I'm afraid.

Daniel: *[good-humoured]* Never mind. And what time could we get in? We'd want to put decorations up.

Janet: *[helpful]* The room's free from midday, so you can come in any time after that, but the time you spend decorating does count towards the hire.

Daniel: *[laughs]* Then we'll be quick about it. Probably three o'clock until eleven.

Janet: *[typing]* Three till eleven. Now, as for what's included... tables and chairs, of course, and we can lend you white tablecloths at no extra charge. There's a fully equipped kitchen, with plates and cutlery for a hundred.

Daniel: And glasses?

Janet: *[apologetic sigh]* We had a set of glasses, but so many got broken that we don't supply them any more. So you'd have to bring your own glasses, or hire some.

Daniel: *[noting it down]* Right. I'll ask the caterers, they might have some.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 7 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Janet: *[brisk]* Now, there are a few other things I should mention. Parking first.

Daniel: Yes, that'll matter. A lot of Mum's friends drive.

Janet: *[reassuring]* Well, the car park has forty spaces, and it doesn't shut at night, so nobody gets locked in. People used to need a permit to park there, but we got rid of that system a couple of years ago.

Daniel: Great.

Janet: *[slightly cautious]* The only thing is, there's a yoga class in the studio on Saturday evenings, and they normally take about a dozen of those spaces until half past seven. So your first guests might struggle a little.

Daniel: *[thinking]* OK, I'll tell people not to come too early. Now, music. My cousin's band is playing. Is that all right?

Janet: *[cheerful]* Of course. Our licence runs until midnight on Saturdays. It's only on weekday evenings that things have to stop at eleven.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Daniel: And would they have to use your sound system?

Janet: No, they don't need to, most bands prefer their own. *[more serious]* What we do ask, though, is that you put a short note through the doors of the houses on Mill Lane, at least a week before the party, so they know there'll be some noise. We've had complaints in the past when people weren't warned.

Daniel: *[agreeably]* That's fair enough. I can do that.

Janet: And will you be doing the food yourselves?

Daniel: *[laughing]* That's been a long family debate. My aunt offered to cook everything, but she's seventy-three herself, and we didn't want her stuck in a kitchen all night. Then someone suggested everybody bringing a dish, but Mum said that would be like asking her guests to pay to come.

Janet: *[chuckles]* I can see her point.

Daniel: So in the end we've gone for a local firm, Hollis Catering. They'll bring hot dishes already cooked and just keep them warm in your ovens.

Janet: That's no problem at all. *[businesslike]* Finally, there's a deposit of a hundred pounds to secure the date, and you get that back as long as the room's left tidy.

Daniel: Can I pay that now? I've got my card here.

Janet: *[apologetic]* Normally, yes, but our card machine's being replaced this week, so I can't take cards at the moment. And we don't accept bank transfers any more. Our treasurer found it too hard to match payments to bookings.

Daniel: *[slightly puzzled]* So...

Janet: So you'd need to drop it into the office here, cash or a cheque. We're open nine till five on weekdays.

Daniel: *[decisive]* I'm driving past on Thursday anyway, so I'll call in then.

Janet: *[warm, wrapping up]* Perfect. I'll hold the room until Friday, and once the deposit's in, it's confirmed. And happy birthday to your mum!

Daniel: *[smiling]* Thanks, I'll pass that on. Bye now.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-6

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

ROOM HIRE ENQUIRY — LARKFIELD COMMUNITY CENTRE

- 1 Name of person booking: Daniel _____
- 2 Event: mother's 70th birthday, Saturday _____ May
- 3 Approximate number of guests: _____
- 4 Room recommended: the _____ Room (has access to garden)
- 5 Saturday charge: £_____ per hour
- 6 Not included in hire — hirer to provide own _____

Questions 7-10

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 7 What does Janet say about the car park?
 - A Drivers must display a permit.
 - B Part of it may be unavailable early in the evening.
 - C It is locked after a certain time.
- 8 What must Daniel do because of the band?
 - A make sure the music ends by 11 p.m.
 - B let local residents know about the party beforehand
 - C arrange for the band to use the centre's equipment
- 9 How will the food for the party be provided?
 - A A relative will prepare it.
 - B Guests will each contribute something.
 - C A company will deliver it ready to serve.
- 10 How will Daniel pay the deposit?
 - A by card during this phone call
 - B by transferring money from his bank
 - C by taking it to the centre in person

Open Day at Brickfield City Farm

Monologue in an everyday social context (volunteer briefing) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A volunteer coordinator briefs a group of new volunteers before a city farm's open day.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Megan	Volunteer coordinator — female, late 30s, energetic, warm, practical; British accent
Script length	5,017 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 2. You will hear a volunteer coordinator talking to a group of new volunteers about a city farm's open day. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 15. [post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Megan: *[cheerful, voice slightly raised to address a group]* Right, good morning, everyone, and thank you so much for coming along. I'm Megan, I coordinate the volunteers here at Brickfield City Farm, and I'll be your main point of contact on Saturday. I know one or two of you have helped out before, but most of you are new, so I'll go through everything from the beginning.

Megan: *[warm, explaining]* Now, you may have heard that this is our twentieth year, and yes, there will be a cake. *[light laugh]* A very large one. But the anniversary isn't really why we're holding the open day. Nor is it mainly about money. We'll have collection buckets, of course, but the new roof for the goat barn has already been paid for by a council grant.

Megan: *[candid, more serious]* The honest truth is that we're seriously short of regular helpers, especially on weekday mornings, and an open day is far and away the best way we've found of signing people up. So if anyone shows an interest, please send them to the green gazebo.

Megan: *[informative]* A few things are different from last year. Last time, we charged visitors three pounds at the gate, which caused long queues and, frankly, put some local families off. This year, thanks to a sponsor, there won't be any charge at all. Some people have rung up asking whether they need to book a place online. They don't, they can just turn up. And the hours are exactly the same as before: ten until four.

Megan: *[lighter, amused]* Right, the animals. The rabbits are always the most popular, with the guinea pigs a close second. Children can feed them, we sell little bags of feed for fifty pence, and that's absolutely fine.

Megan: *[firmer, emphasising]* What we don't allow is children walking around holding them. Rabbits wriggle, and if they're dropped they can be badly hurt. So the rule is that the child sits down on the bench first, and then you place the rabbit on a towel on their lap. *[casual]* Last year we put the rabbits back in their hutches at lunchtime to give them a rest, but in fact they coped perfectly well, so they'll be out all day this time.

Megan: *[reflective, a little rueful]* People often ask me what I worry about most on the day. Parking always looks chaotic from the gate, but it does sort itself out, because the school next door lets us use their playground. And the queue for the café can get long, but people are usually very patient when there's cake involved.

Megan: *[serious, slowing down]* No, what really keeps me awake is the lost children's point. Last year we had eleven children separated from their parents in a single afternoon, and one little boy was missing for nearly forty minutes. So whoever's on that point needs to stay there, and not

wander off to help elsewhere.

Megan: *[practical]* And the weather. If it rains, the tractor rides will still run, because the trailer's covered. We used to move the craft tables into the big barn when it rained, but the noise upset the animals, so now they go into the classroom instead. The only activity we'll actually call off is the pony rides. The ground gets far too slippery.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 16 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Megan: *[brisk, orienting the group]* OK, if you look at the plan I've given you, I'll show you where everything's going to be on the day. We're standing at the main entrance, at the bottom of the plan, facing into the farm, so north is straight ahead. The main path runs from here up to the duck pond in the middle. It then splits and goes round both sides of the pond, and the two halves join up again on the far side.

Megan: *[explaining]* First aid. In previous years the first-aid post was right beside the café, which is just inside the gate on your left. But it got far too crowded there, so this year it's moving further up on the same side, right against the west fence, just south of the big barn. So it isn't on the main path at all. It's over by the fence.

Megan: *[emphatic]* Now, the lost children's point, and please do remember where this is. Lots of parents assume it'll be at the entrance, and we'll put a sign up here, but the point itself is beyond the pond, at the place where the two paths meet again. So that's on the north side of the pond.

Megan: *[clear, matter-of-fact]* Pony rides. You'd expect them to be in the paddock, but the paddock's being used for the sheep-shearing display this year. So the ponies will be in the small field in the bottom right-hand corner of the site, the south-east corner, to your right as you come in.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Megan: *[informative]* The plant sale is new this year. It'll be along the north fence, at the very top of the plan, halfway between the big barn and the orchard. *[slightly apologetic]* It won't be inside the orchard itself, I'm afraid, because the trees are being pruned that week.

Megan: *[wrapping up]* And finally, the cheese-making demonstration. Originally we'd planned to have it in the barn, by the door, but there just isn't enough light in there. So it'll be over on the east side of the site, between the orchard and the paddock, right up against the east fence.

Megan: *[warm, upbeat]* Right, that's everything from me. Grab a coffee, and I'll come round and give you your T-shirts.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-15

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 11** What is the main reason for holding this year's open day?
- A** to celebrate a special year in the farm's history
 - B** to raise money for repairs to a building
 - C** to find more people to help at the farm
- 12** What is different about this year's open day?
- A** Visitors have to reserve tickets beforehand.
 - B** Visitors will not have to pay to get in.
 - C** It will finish earlier in the afternoon.
- 13** What rule do volunteers have to follow with the rabbits?
- A** Children may only hold them when seated.
 - B** They must go back in their hutches at midday.
 - C** Only volunteers are allowed to feed them.
- 14** Which aspect of the day is Megan most anxious about?
- A** finding space for visitors' cars
 - B** children becoming separated from adults
 - C** long waits for refreshments
- 15** What will happen if the weather is wet?
- A** The pony rides will not take place.
 - B** The craft activities will be moved to the barn.
 - C** The tractor rides will be stopped.

Questions 16-20

Label the plan below. Write the correct letter, A-I, next to Questions 16-20.

Brickfield City Farm — Open Day Plan

Plan (for the designer): A rectangular site, north at the top. The MAIN ENTRANCE is in the middle of the south (bottom) edge. A MAIN PATH runs straight north from the entrance to the DUCK POND in the centre of the site; at the pond the path splits into two halves that pass round the west and east sides of the pond and join up again on its north side. The CAFÉ (labelled) is just inside the entrance, to the west (left) of the main path. The BIG BARN (labelled) occupies the north-west corner. The ORCHARD (labelled) occupies the north-east corner. The Paddock (labelled) is on the east side of the site, level with the duck pond, below the orchard. Letters: A = beside the main path on its west side, between the Café and the Duck Pond. B = just inside the entrance on the east (right) side of the main path, opposite the Café. C = on the north side of the Duck Pond, exactly where the two halves of the path rejoin. D = immediately outside the Big Barn's door on its east side, facing the pond. E = against the east fence, between the Orchard (to its north) and the Paddock (to its south). F = a small field in the south-east (bottom right-hand) corner of the site. G = inside the Orchard, in its north-east corner. H = against the west fence, between the Café and the Big Barn, directly south of the barn. I = against the north fence, halfway between the Big Barn and the Orchard.

A	A
B	B
C	C
D	D
E	E
F	F
G	G
H	H
I	I

- 16** First-aid post
- 17** Lost children's point

- 18** Pony rides
- 19** Plant sale
- 20** Cheese-making demonstration

Dissertation: Food-Packaging Waste in Supermarkets

Academic discussion (2 students + tutor) · Tutor British (en-GB); Kirsty Australian (en-AU); Owen British (en-GB)

Scenario: Two students, Kirsty and Owen, discuss their joint dissertation on food-packaging waste in supermarkets with their tutor, Dr Lawson.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	Tutor British (en-GB); Kirsty Australian (en-AU); Owen British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Dr Lawson	Tutor — male, 50s, calm, measured, dry humour; British accent
Voice: Kirsty	Student — female, early 20s, lively, direct, enthusiastic; Australian accent
Voice: Owen	Student — male, early 20s, thoughtful, slightly hesitant; British accent
Script length	6,263 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 3. You will hear two students, Kirsty and Owen, talking to their tutor about their dissertation on food-packaging waste in supermarkets. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 25. [post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Dr Lawson: *[door closes softly] [welcoming, relaxed]* Come in, both of you, have a seat. So, it's been about a month since we last met. How's the packaging project going?

Kirsty: *[upbeat]* Pretty well, I think. Though you'll have noticed from the outline that it's changed quite a bit since then.

Dr Lawson: *[curious]* Yes, I did. You were originally going to look at plastic waste across the whole retail sector, weren't you? Now it's just food packaging in supermarkets. Was that because of what I said about the scope?

Owen: *[slightly sheepish]* Well, you did say it was ambitious, and to be fair you were right. But honestly, we'd probably have stuck with it if we could. The real problem was that the council wouldn't give us the waste figures broken down by type of business. They said the data simply wasn't held in that form.

Kirsty: *[agreeing]* Whereas the supermarkets publish their own packaging reports, so at least there's something to work with.

Dr Lawson: *[dry]* And there I was thinking you'd taken my advice. *[chuckles]* Still, it's a much tighter project now, and a great deal more manageable. So, you've done your store visits now?

Kirsty: *[enthusiastic]* Yeah, three stores, all in the city centre. And some of it wasn't what we expected at all. We'd assumed loose fruit and veg would be dearer than the packaged stuff...

Owen: *[interrupting gently]* Which it was, in one shop.

Kirsty: *[conceding quickly]* In one shop, sure, but in the other two it actually worked out cheaper per kilo. What really struck us was how little room it got. In the biggest store the loose produce took up barely a fifth of the display.

Owen: *[thoughtful]* And the managers kept telling us that loose items get bruised and damaged more, so there's more waste. But honestly, we didn't see much sign of that.

Dr Lawson: *[measured]* Interesting. Let's talk about your shopper survey. How many responses have you got?

Owen: *[slightly defensive]* Sixty-two. We know that's not huge.

Dr Lawson: *[reassuring]* For a dissertation, that's perfectly defensible, I wouldn't worry about the numbers. And I know some people would say you should have done it online rather than standing outside shops with clipboards, but face to face tends to get you more thoughtful answers.

Dr Lawson: *[more serious]* No, my concern is the wording. Take question four. You ask people whether they agree that supermarkets use far too much unnecessary plastic. You're more or less telling people what to think.

Kirsty: *[wincing, light laugh]* Yeah... reading it back, it's not exactly neutral, is it?

Dr Lawson: *[practical]* Then acknowledge that as a limitation, and don't build too much on that question. Now, compostable packaging. You've written quite a lot on that.

Owen: *[keen]* Yes, I think it's one of the more hopeful developments. It does cost the supermarkets more, but...

Kirsty: *[cutting in, firm but friendly]* See, the cost isn't really what bothers me. And yes, shoppers get confused about which bin it goes in, but that's true of nearly all packaging. My real problem with it is that our local plant can't actually process it. So it gets sent to landfill with everything else, and nobody's any better off.

Owen: *[conceding a little]* That's true round here. It's not true everywhere, though.

Dr Lawson: *[moving on]* Which brings us to the international chapter. Owen, I gather you wanted to add Germany and France?

Owen: *[hopeful]* I did. The German deposit scheme is fascinating.

Dr Lawson: *[dry]* I'm sure it is, but you're already well over the word count. I wouldn't get rid of the chapter altogether, because the comparison does strengthen your argument, but it can't stand on its own.

Kirsty: *[thinking aloud]* So... we squeeze it down to a couple of pages and fold it into the literature review?

Dr Lawson: Exactly that.

Owen: *[resigned, good-humoured sigh]* OK. Goodbye, France.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 26 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Dr Lawson: *[businesslike]* Right, let's go through your main sources, because one or two of them worry me slightly. First, the government report on packaging waste, the one from twenty nineteen.

Kirsty: *[eager]* That's our main source for the national figures. We thought we'd check its numbers against the industry ones?

Dr Lawson: *[gently correcting]* You could, but there's no real need. There's an updated edition. It came out last spring, with figures up to twenty twenty-four. You should be using that one rather than the old one.

Owen: *[surprised]* Oh. We had no idea. Right, we'll swap it.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Kirsty: *[slightly dismayed]* Though if the figures have changed much, we'll have to redo a couple of our graphs.

Dr Lawson: *[unsympathetic but kind]* Probably, yes. But better now than after the examiners have noticed.

Dr Lawson: Then the Packaging Industry Alliance website.

Owen: *[sceptical]* Honestly, I'd rather leave that out. They're a lobby group. Of course they say packaging reduces food waste.

Dr Lawson: *[considered]* They're not neutral, certainly. But ignoring them completely would look as if you hadn't considered the other side. What I'd do is compare their statistics with the university study from Exeter, and see whether they hold up.

Kirsty: *[agreeing]* That makes sense.

Dr Lawson: And the television documentary... Wrapped, I think it was called.

Kirsty: *[enthusiastic]* Oh, I love that one. I was going to quote the presenter in our introduction. She's got this brilliant line about plastic mountains.

Dr Lawson: *[amused, but firm]* It's a good line, but a documentary isn't evidence in academic terms. It's fine for giving you a feel for the debate, but I wouldn't cite it.

Kirsty: *[slightly disappointed]* OK, so it's just something we watched to get our heads round the issue, then.

Dr Lawson: The PhD thesis from Leeds, by Dr Okafor?

Owen: *[keen]* Yeah, that one's really close to what we're doing. Kirsty thought we could borrow her questionnaire design...

Kirsty: *[light laugh]* But our survey's already done, so that's a bit late now.

Dr Lawson: *[thoughtful]* Quite. But she mentions that she collected weekly store data she didn't have space to analyse. If I were you, I'd email her and ask whether she'd share it. Researchers are usually happy to.

Owen: *[pleased]* That would save us weeks.

Dr Lawson: And lastly, the newspaper interview with the chief executive of Fairway supermarkets.

Kirsty: *[uncertain]* We weren't sure about that one. Newspapers aren't exactly peer-reviewed.

Dr Lawson: Normally I'd agree. But it's the only time anyone at that level has admitted publicly that their targets won't be met, so his exact words matter. Use them, word for word, in quotation marks.

Owen: *[hesitant]* Should we put the whole article in an appendix as well?

Dr Lawson: *[mild, unhurried]* No, I wouldn't bother with that. The quotation's enough. Right, shall we look at your timetable?

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21–30

Questions 21–25

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 21** Why did the students narrow the focus of their dissertation?
- A** Their tutor told them the original plan was too ambitious.
 - B** They were unable to obtain some information they needed.
 - C** They found the supermarket reports more interesting.
- 22** What surprised the students about loose fruit and vegetables?
- A** It was usually more expensive than packaged produce.
 - B** It was given relatively little space in stores.
 - C** It was often in poor condition.
- 23** What is the tutor's view of the students' survey?
- A** The sample is too small to be useful.
 - B** One item may have influenced the responses.
 - C** It ought to have been carried out online.
- 24** What is Kirsty's main objection to compostable packaging?
- A** It increases costs for retailers.
 - B** Customers do not know how to dispose of it.
 - C** It cannot be dealt with in the area.
- 25** What do they decide to do with the chapter on other countries?
- A** remove it completely
 - B** shorten it and include it in another section
 - C** expand it to cover more countries

Questions 26–30

What do the students decide to do with each of the following sources? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A–G, next to Questions 26–30.

A	use it only for general background
B	verify its data using another source
C	quote from it directly
D	replace it with a more recent version
E	contact the author for further material
F	use it as a model for their own research tool
G	include it in full as an appendix

- 26** the government report
- 27** the industry website
- 28** the documentary
- 29** the PhD thesis
- 30** the newspaper interview

The History and Science of Glassmaking

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A lecturer gives a talk on what glass is and how glassmaking developed from the ancient world to the present.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	University lecturer — female, 40s, articulate, lively, occasionally wry; British accent
Script length	5,792 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about the history and science of glassmaking.*

First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. [post: 45 s pause]

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture theatre, faint murmur fading] [lively, clear]* Good afternoon, everyone. Today we're turning to a material that's so familiar we hardly notice it: glass. I want to look first at what glass actually is, and then trace how people learned to make it, and to make it better, over roughly four and a half thousand years.

Lecturer: *[explaining carefully]* So, the science. Most of the solids we think of as hard, metals, salt, ice, are crystalline. Their atoms are lined up in a neat, repeating lattice, rather like soldiers on parade. Glass isn't like that. When you examine its structure, the arrangement of the atoms is random. It's essentially the structure of a liquid that's been frozen in place before it had time to organise itself.

Lecturer: *[wry]* This has given rise to a famous myth, which I'm sure some of you have heard: that glass is really a very slow-moving liquid, and that's why old church windows are thicker at the bottom. It isn't true. Calculations suggest that glass at room temperature wouldn't flow noticeably in the entire lifetime of the universe. The thick bottoms are simply because glaziers tended to put the heavier edge of an uneven pane at the bottom.

Lecturer: *[informative]* The main ingredient of most glass is silica, which in practice means sand. The difficulty is that pure silica only melts at around seventeen hundred degrees Celsius, far hotter than any ancient furnace could reach. So glassmakers added soda, that is, sodium carbonate, which brings the melting point down dramatically. An ingredient that does this job is known as a flux, and do note that word, because you'll meet it again and again in the literature.

Lecturer: *[measured]* But soda on its own creates a problem. Soda glass is chemically unstable. Strange as it sounds, it will slowly dissolve in water. People often guess that it's acid that attacks it, but in fact ordinary rain is quite enough, given time. The solution was to add lime, which acts as a stabiliser, and that combination of sand, soda and lime is still the basis of about ninety per cent of the glass made today.

Lecturer: *[shifting tone, narrative]* Now to the history. The oldest glass objects we know of come from Mesopotamia, from about four and a half thousand years ago. You might imagine cups or bottles, but those didn't appear for another thousand years or so. The earliest objects were beads: small, brightly coloured, and treated almost like precious stones.

Lecturer: *[enthusiastic]* The real revolution came in the first century BC, probably somewhere along the coast of what's now Syria, with the invention of glassblowing. Instead of slowly shaping glass

around a core, a worker could gather molten glass on the end of a hollow tube and blow it into shape in a matter of seconds. Suddenly, glass was cheap.

Lecturer: *[informative]* The Romans adopted the technique with great enthusiasm. They did make some window glass, though it was thick and not very transparent. But the commonest use for blown glass was containers. Now, you might expect these held wine. In fact wine was mostly kept in clay jars called amphorae, which were cheaper and far less fragile. Glass was particularly valued for perfume, because unlike clay, it doesn't absorb the scent or alter it.

Lecturer: *[narrative]* Let's jump forward to medieval Venice, which became the centre of European glassmaking. In twelve ninety-one the city ordered all its glassmakers to move to the nearby island of Murano. You'll often read that this was done to protect trade secrets, and it certainly helped with that. But the official reason given in the decree was the danger of fire. Venice was a crowded city full of wooden buildings, and the furnaces burned day and night.

Lecturer: *[explaining]* Murano's great achievement was a glass called cristallo, which was almost colourless. Ordinary glass had a greenish tint, which comes from iron in the sand. It isn't caused by copper, as is sometimes claimed; copper tends to give a blue colour. The Venetians found that adding a small amount of manganese cancelled out the green, which is why manganese is sometimes nicknamed glassmaker's soap.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[informative]* In England, in the sixteen seventies, George Ravenscroft began adding lead oxide to his glass. People assume lead glass must be stronger, but it's actually rather softer, which makes it easier to cut. What it gained was brilliance. Lead makes glass bend light much more, so when it's cut into facets, it sparkles. *[dry]* That's the origin of what we call lead crystal, which, ironically, given what I said earlier, isn't a crystal at all.

Lecturer: *[moving on]* For centuries, making flat glass for windows remained difficult. You either blew a large cylinder and cut it open, or spun a disc. Both methods left the glass slightly wavy and uneven. The breakthrough came in the nineteen fifties with the float process, developed by Alastair Pilkington in Britain.

Lecturer: *[explaining clearly]* In the float process, molten glass is poured continuously onto a bath of molten tin. People sometimes assume mercury was used, because it's liquid at room temperature, but it boils far too easily. Tin stays liquid over the whole working range, and because its surface is perfectly flat, the glass floating on top ends up perfectly flat as well. Almost all window glass is made this way today.

Lecturer: *[informative]* Finally, a word about safety glass. Toughened glass is made by heating ordinary glass and then cooling the outside very quickly using jets of air. Water was tried, but it cools the surface so violently that the glass simply cracks. This rapid cooling puts the surface under compression, which makes the glass several times stronger. And if it does break, it shatters into small, blunt pieces rather than dangerous shards.

Lecturer: *[wrapping up, friendly]* Next week we'll look at more modern uses, glass in fibre-optic cables and so on, so please read chapter six before then.

Narrator: *That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.*

[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 • Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

GLASS: SCIENCE AND HISTORY

- 31** Structure: unlike in crystalline solids, atoms in glass have a _____ arrangement
- 32** Soda (sodium carbonate) lowers the melting temperature of silica — it is an example of a _____
- 33** Without lime, soda glass will gradually be destroyed by _____
- 34** First glass objects (Mesopotamia, c. 4,500 years ago): _____
- 35** Roman blown-glass containers were especially used for _____ (glass did not change its smell)
- 36** 1291: glassmakers moved to Murano — officially because of the risk of _____
- 37** Greenish colour of ordinary glass was due to _____ (removed by adding manganese)
- 38** Ravenscroft's lead glass (1670s): softer than earlier glass, but notable for its _____
- 39** Float process (1950s): liquid glass spread over a surface of melted _____
- 40** Toughened glass: outer surface rapidly cooled with _____

FT01 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Cartwell	Janet first writes 'Cartwright'; the double L must be caught from the spelling.
2	20th / 20 / twentieth / the 20th	Her birthday is the tenth and the family first wanted the thirteenth, which is already booked.
3	85 / eighty-five	Sixty invitations were sent; forty-five and two hundred are room capacities.
4	Orchard	The Willow Room is mentioned first but is too small, and the main hall is rejected as too big.
5	38 / £38 / thirty-eight	Janet first quotes forty-five pounds, which is the main hall's rate.
6	glasses	Tablecloths, plates and cutlery are all mentioned but are supplied by the centre.
7	B (Part of it may be unavailable early in the evening.)	Permits were needed in the past (A) and Janet says it doesn't shut at night (C).
8	B (let local residents know about the party beforehand)	Eleven o'clock applies only on weekdays (A), and the band doesn't need to use the sound system (C).
9	C (A company will deliver it ready to serve.)	The aunt's offer (A) and the bring-a-dish idea (B) are both discussed and rejected.
10	C (by taking it to the centre in person)	Daniel offers his card but the machine is being replaced (A), and bank transfers aren't accepted any more (B).
11	C (to find more people to help at the farm)	The twentieth year is mentioned but 'isn't really why' (A); the barn roof is already paid for (B).
12	B (Visitors will not have to pay to get in.)	Booking online is raised but not needed (A); the hours are 'exactly the same' (C).
13	A (Children may only hold them when seated.)	Hutches at lunchtime was last year's practice (B); children are allowed to feed them (C).
14	B (children becoming separated from adults)	Parking (A) and café queues (C) are both mentioned but dismissed as problems that sort themselves out.
15	A (The pony rides will not take place.)	Crafts used to go into the barn but now go to the classroom (B); tractor rides still run (C).
16	H (H)	It used to be beside the café, and A (beside the path on the same side) is a distractor; Megan stresses it 'isn't on the main path at all'.
17	C (C)	Parents assume it is at the entrance (B), where only a sign will be.
18	F (F)	The paddock (next to E) is where listeners expect them, but it's being used for sheep-shearing.
19	I (I)	It is not inside the orchard (G), because the trees are being pruned.
20	E (E)	It was originally planned for the barn door (D) but there isn't enough light.
21	B (They were unable to obtain some information they needed.)	Owen admits the tutor called it ambitious (A) but says that isn't why; supermarket reports are mentioned only as something available (C).
22	B (It was given relatively little space in stores.)	It was dearer in only one shop (A); managers claimed it gets damaged but the students saw little sign of that (C).
23	B (One item may have influenced the responses.)	He says sixty-two is 'perfectly defensible' (A) and defends face-to-face collection (C).
24	C (It cannot be dealt with in the area.)	Cost is Owen's point and Kirsty says it 'isn't really what bothers' her (A); confusion is admitted but true of all packaging (B).

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
25	B (shorten it and include it in another section)	Owen wanted to add Germany and France (C); the tutor says he wouldn't get rid of it altogether (A).
26	D (replace it with a more recent version)	Kirsty suggests checking its numbers against industry figures (B), but the tutor says there's no need.
27	B (verify its data using another source)	Owen wants to leave it out, but the tutor rejects that.
28	A (use it only for general background)	Kirsty planned to quote the presenter (C), which the tutor rules out.
29	E (contact the author for further material)	Borrowing her questionnaire design (F) is mentioned but it is too late.
30	C (quote from it directly)	Kirsty doubts newspapers, and Owen's appendix idea (G) is rejected.
31	random	'neat, repeating lattice' describes crystals, not glass.
32	flux	Candidates may write 'soda' or 'sand', which are named just before.
33	water / rain	Acid is the common guess but is explicitly corrected.
34	beads	Cups and bottles came about a thousand years later.
35	perfume	Wine is suggested but was mostly kept in clay amphorae.
36	fire	Protecting trade secrets is the popular explanation, not the official one.
37	iron	Copper is mentioned as a mistaken explanation.
38	brilliance	People assume it is stronger; 'softer' is said just before.
39	tin	Mercury is mentioned as a wrong assumption.
40	air	Water was tried but makes the glass crack.

Listening Full Test 2

FT02 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Joining a Car-Share Club	Australian (en-AU)
2	The Ashcombe Heritage Trail	British (en-GB)
3	Seminar Presentation: How Young Children Acquire Language	British (en-GB) and New Zealand (en-NZ)
4	Urban Heat Islands	Canadian (en-CA)

Joining a Car-Share Club

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · Australian (en-AU)

Scenario: A woman phones a city car-share club to become a member.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	Australian (en-AU)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Craig	Membership officer — male, 30s, easy-going, helpful, slightly chatty; Australian accent
Voice: Joanna	Caller — female, late 20s, friendly, organised but a little hurried; Australian accent
Script length	6,144 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a woman phoning a car-share club to become a member. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 7. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Craig: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [cheerful, professional]* Harbour Car Share, Craig speaking. How can I help?

Joanna: *[friendly, slightly hurried]* Oh, hi, Craig. I'd like to join the club, please. The online form kept freezing on me, so I thought I'd just ring.

Craig: *[apologetic chuckle]* Yeah, sorry about that. No worries, I can do it over the phone. Can I start with your name?

Joanna: Sure. It's Joanna Pellowe.

Craig: *[careful]* And how do you spell the surname?

Joanna: *[slowly, spelling each letter clearly]* P... E... double L... O... W... E.

Craig: *[reading back as he types]* P... E... double L... O... W...

Joanna: *[quickly, politely correcting him]* Sorry, there's an E on the end as well. People always leave it off.

Craig: *[light laugh]* Got it, with the E. And your home address?

Joanna: *[clearly]* It's flat six, forty-two Lennox Street, in Rozelle.

Craig: *[murmuring as he types]* Lennox Street... *[normal voice]* and the postcode?

Joanna: *[thinking]* Two-oh-three-nine... *[short pause] [correcting herself, a bit embarrassed]* no, hang on, that's the office. Home is two-oh-three-seven.

Craig: *[reading back slowly]* Two-oh-three-seven. Lovely. Now, we ask everyone what they'll mainly be using the cars for. Is it mostly for work, or...?

Joanna: *[thoughtful]* Not for work, no. I cycle to the office. I used to borrow a friend's car to take my sister to the airport, but she's moved to Perth now, so... *[warmly]* these days it'd mostly be to drive up and see my grandmother. She lives in a little town in the Blue Mountains, and the train doesn't go all the way.

Craig: *[sympathetic]* Yeah, the trains up there aren't great at weekends. And which of our car bays would be handiest for you? In Rozelle we've got three.

Joanna: *[considering]* Well, the one at the light rail stop would be ideal, but every time I've looked on the map, the cars there are booked out.

Craig: *[rueful]* That one's very popular, I'm afraid.

Joanna: *[thinking aloud]* And the bay outside the library, I thought that'd be the closest, but...

Craig: *[helpful]* Ah, that one's actually closed till the end of the year. The council's digging up the road there.

Joanna: *[decisive]* Right, then put me down for the one behind the swimming pool. It's only a five-minute walk, so that's fine.

Craig: *[typing]* Behind the pool, no problem. You can change that any time in the app anyway. *[explaining, clear]* Now, we've got three plans. There's Casual, which has no monthly fee but higher hourly rates; there's Plus, which has a small monthly fee and cheaper hours; and Premium, which is really for people who drive most days.

Joanna: *[hesitant]* I was thinking Casual, because I honestly won't drive that much. Maybe twice a month?

Craig: *[measured, reasoning it through]* You could. But two return trips to the mountains a month, they're long bookings, say six or seven hours each. On Casual you'd be paying the higher rate the whole time. I reckon the middle one would work out cheaper for you.

Joanna: *[doing the maths slowly]* Hmm... yeah, if they're full-day trips... *[decisive]* Okay, you've talked me into it. I'll go for Plus. Not Premium, though, that's way more than I need.

Craig: *[laughs]* Fair enough. Plus it is.

Joanna: And what's the monthly fee on that? The website said twelve dollars fifty.

Craig: *[apologetic]* Ah, that's last year's figure, the page hasn't been updated. It went up in July. It's fourteen dollars ninety-five a month now.

Joanna: *[resigned, good-humoured]* Fourteen ninety-five. Okay. Still a lot cheaper than running my own car.

Craig: *[businesslike]* Definitely. Now, we'll need a scan of your driver's licence, front and back, and something showing your address. A bank statement's fine...

Joanna: *[awkward]* I don't get paper statements any more. It's all online, and the screenshots don't actually show my address.

Craig: *[thinking]* Right. We used to take mobile phone bills, but we can't accept those any more, head office changed the rules. Have you got a gas or an electricity bill?

Joanna: *[relieved]* The gas is in my flatmate's name, but I can send you my electricity bill, that's got my name and address on it.

Craig: Perfect. Just email it to us with the licence scan.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 8 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Joanna: *[slightly anxious]* Can I ask about the rules? What happens if I'm late bringing a car back? The traffic coming down from the mountains can be awful on a Sunday night.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Craig: *[reassuring]* It happens. If you can, extend the booking in the app before it runs out. If you don't, there is a charge. It used to be a flat twenty-five dollars, whatever happened, which people thought was a bit harsh if they were only five minutes over.

Joanna: *[wry]* I can imagine.

Craig: *[clear, explaining]* So now it's worked out in blocks of fifteen minutes. You pay a small fee for each block you're over. *[emphatic]* We don't charge you for a whole extra hour, which is what some of the other clubs do.

Joanna: *[curious]* That sounds fairer. And is there anything I have to do before I drive off? Do I need to ring you?

Craig: *[casual]* You don't need to call us. That's what we used to ask, but the app does all that now. Some members check the petrol gauge, but honestly, our staff refuel the cars, and there's a fuel card in the glovebox if you do run low, so that's not something you need to worry about.

Joanna: Oh, right.

Craig: *[more serious, emphatic]* The one thing we do insist on is that you walk around the car and take pictures of any scratches or dents in the app. Otherwise you could end up getting blamed for them.

Joanna: *[serious]* Good to know. I'll make sure I do that.

Craig: *[upbeat]* So, would you like to make your first booking now? Your membership card takes about five days to come in the post.

Joanna: *[hesitant]* Oh, so I'd have to wait for that anyway?

Craig: *[quickly]* No, no, you don't need the card. Once your documents are approved, you can unlock the cars with your phone. That's usually the same day.

Joanna: *[pleased]* Oh, good. I was hoping to go up this Saturday.

Craig: *[checking, murmuring]* Let me see... *[normal voice]* yep, the hatchback behind the pool is free all day Saturday.

Joanna: *[thinking aloud, hesitant]* Actually... I'd better not book it yet. My grandmother sometimes goes to her bridge club on a Saturday, and I don't want to drive all that way if she isn't going to be home. I'll ring her tonight and then book it in the app.

Craig: *[easy-going]* No problem at all. I'll email you a link to the app in the next few minutes.

Joanna: *[warmly]* Great. Thanks so much for your help, Craig.

Craig: *[cheerful]* My pleasure, Joanna. Enjoy the drive.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-7

Complete the form below. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

HARBOUR CAR SHARE — NEW MEMBER DETAILS

- 1 Name: Joanna _____
- 2 Postcode: _____
- 3 Main use of cars: trips to see her _____
- 4 Preferred car bay: the one behind the _____
- 5 Membership plan: _____
- 6 Monthly fee: \$ _____
- 7 Proof of address to be emailed: _____

Questions 8-10

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B** or **C**.

- 8 What happens now if a member returns a car late?
 - A They pay a fixed penalty.
 - B They are charged for an additional hour.
 - C They pay for each quarter of an hour.
- 9 What must members do before driving off?
 - A Record any damage to the vehicle
 - B Make sure there is enough fuel
 - C Phone the club's office
- 10 Why doesn't Joanna make a booking during the call?
 - A She hasn't received her membership card.
 - B The car she wants is unavailable.
 - C She needs to check a relative's plans.

The Ashcombe Heritage Trail

Monologue in an everyday social context (local radio talk, with short introduction by a presenter) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A local radio presenter introduces the council's heritage officer, who describes a new heritage trail in the town.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (presenter introduction + main speaker; one voice per label) (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.55 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Presenter	Local radio presenter — male, 40s, warm, upbeat, polished; British accent
Voice: Ruth	Council heritage officer — female, 50s, enthusiastic, articulate, occasionally wry; British (southern English) accent
Script length	5,604 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 2. You will hear a local radio presenter introducing a heritage officer, who is talking about a new heritage trail in her town. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 16. [post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Presenter: *[radio studio, a short jingle fading out] [warm, lively]* Good morning, and welcome back to Ashcombe Today. Now, those small metal discs that have appeared in the town centre pavements are part of the new Ashcombe Heritage Trail, which opens this Saturday, and here to tell us all about it is the council's heritage officer, Ruth Penhale. Morning, Ruth.

Ruth: *[cheerful]* Morning, Steve, and thanks for having me. *[settling in, enthusiastic]* Well, the trail links fourteen places of interest in the old town, but this morning I'll just pick out six of the main ones.

Ruth: *[informative]* Let's start at the Corn Exchange on the High Street. A lot of people still think of it as the place to get a coffee, and there was a café on the ground floor for years, but it closed last spring and the space is empty for now. What you will find just inside the entrance hall is a model of the town as it looked in about eighteen fifty. *[warm]* It was built by pupils from Ashcombe Primary as a class project last term, and it's remarkably detailed. They even put tiny sheep in the market square.

Ruth: *[slightly regretful]* From there, the trail goes down Well Lane to St Bride's Well. This is one of the oldest sites in the town; there's been a spring there since medieval times. We'd originally planned to put one of our audio posts there, where you press a button and hear a short recording, but the budget didn't stretch that far, sadly.

Ruth: *[careful, serious]* And I should warn listeners: the well sits at the bottom of a flight of very narrow, uneven steps. We did look into putting in a ramp, but because the stonework is protected, we weren't given permission. So I'm afraid it isn't a stop that anyone in a wheelchair will be able to get down to.

Ruth: *[brighter]* Just past the well, you come to the Tannery Bridge over the river. Now, generations of Ashcombe people have called it the black bridge, because that's the colour it's been for as long as anyone can remember. But when our conservation team scraped back the layers of paint last year, they discovered the ironwork had first been painted a deep green, and that's the shade you'll see there now. *[light laugh]* It's caused a few complaints, actually.

Ruth: *[informative]* Then it's back up the hill to the Market Cross. You'll see people climbing the steps around the base hoping for a view, but to be honest, you can't see much from there; the buildings are too close. What makes the cross special is the bell at the top. The original was stolen in the nineteen seventies and never recovered. The one hanging there now was cast last year by a foundry in Devon, copied exactly from old photographs.

Ruth: *[informative, slightly apologetic]* Round the corner from the cross are the Weavers' Cottages, a row of five little houses where cloth used to be made by hand. People are often disappointed to learn that they're all private homes now, so you can't just wander in. But the owners of the end cottage have very kindly agreed to let us in once a month, which means the only way to see inside is to book a place on one of our guided walks.

Ruth: *[enthusiastic]* And finally, there's the old Railway Goods Shed, down by the station car park. There's one of our audio posts inside, and if you press the button, you'll hear recordings we made with men and women who worked on the railway in the nineteen fifties and sixties.

Ruth: *[matter-of-fact]* A lot of people ask me whether there's somewhere to eat in the shed. There isn't, I'm afraid, though the Signal Box Café is just over the road. And if you're after a view over the whole town, the best place is really the old water tower behind the station, but that's not part of the trail, because it isn't open to the public.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 17 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Presenter: *[interested]* Ruth, tell us about those discs in the pavement.

Ruth: *[chuckles]* Ah, the markers. Well, there was quite a debate about those. Some councillors wanted them made from recycled plastic, to be environmentally friendly, but in the end we went for bronze, because it lasts so much longer. *[warm]* They were designed by Ellen Marsh, a sculptor who's lived in Ashcombe all her life. They shouldn't need replacing for a very long time; we're hoping they'll still be there in fifty years.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Ruth: *[practical]* As for how long it takes, the leaflet says forty-five minutes, but that's if you walk briskly and don't stop at all. If you actually read the information boards, I'd allow about an hour and a half. Some people make a whole morning of it and have lunch at the end, but that's up to you.

Ruth: *[advisory]* There's also a free app to go with the trail. Some people tell me they prefer it to the printed leaflet, but personally I find the map in the leaflet much easier to follow. There's a paid version of the app with extra content, too, but honestly, the free one has everything most visitors would need.

Ruth: *[emphatic, slowing down]* My main piece of advice is this: the mobile signal in the old streets is terrible. So if you want to use the app, make sure you've got it on your phone before you leave home.

Presenter: *[curious]* And is there any way listeners can get involved?

Ruth: *[grateful]* Well, we've had a wonderful response to our appeal for volunteer guides. In fact, we've got all the guides we need for this year, so thank you to everyone who came forward. Last year we asked people to suggest buildings to include, and that went well, too.

Ruth: *[eager, warm]* What we're short of now is pictures. If you've got old photographs of the town in a drawer at home, shops, street parties, anything, we'd love to scan them for the trail website. You can drop them at the library, and we'll return them within a week.

Presenter: *[wrapping up, cheerful]* Lovely. Ruth Penhale, thank you very much.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-16

What does the speaker say about each of the following places on the heritage trail? Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 11-16.

A	has an interactive audio feature
B	can only be entered as part of an organised group
C	has a display made by local children
D	has been returned to its original colour
E	offers a view across the town
F	has a café on site
G	is inaccessible to wheelchair users
H	contains a reproduction of a missing object

11 The Corn Exchange

12 St Bride's Well

13 The Tannery Bridge

14 The Market Cross

15 The Weavers' Cottages

16 The Railway Goods Shed

Questions 17-20

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

17 What does the speaker say about the trail markers?

- A** They are made of recycled material.
- B** They were created by someone from the town.
- C** They are likely to need replacing soon.

18 How long does the speaker suggest allowing for the trail?

- A** under an hour
- B** around ninety minutes
- C** half a day

19 What is the speaker's main advice about the app?

- A** Install it before setting out.
- B** Use it instead of the printed map.
- C** Pay for the full version.

20 What are listeners asked to do?

- A** lend images of the town's past
- B** volunteer to lead walks
- C** propose buildings to be added to the trail

Seminar Presentation: How Young Children Acquire Language

Academic discussion (2 students) · British (en-GB) and New Zealand (en-NZ)

Scenario: Two students, Hannah and Liam, prepare a seminar presentation on how young children acquire language.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.45 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB) and New Zealand (en-NZ)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Hannah	Student — female, early 20s, organised, a little anxious, quick; British (southern English) accent
Voice: Liam	Student — male, early 20s, relaxed, confident, persuasive; New Zealand accent
Script length	6,707 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear two students, Hannah and Liam, preparing a seminar presentation on how young children acquire language. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 24. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Hannah: *[quiet study room] [brisk, a little stressed]* Okay, Liam, we've got twenty minutes for the whole presentation, including questions, so we really need to decide what goes in and what comes out.

Liam: *[relaxed]* Yeah, fair enough. I made a list last night. Shall we go through it?

Hannah: Go on.

Liam: *[reading from notes]* Right, first, Chomsky, and the idea that we're born with some kind of built-in grammar.

Hannah: *[doubtful]* Hmm. I mean, it's important, obviously, but everyone in the group did that to death in first year. If we spend five minutes on it, people will just switch off.

Liam: *[agreeing]* True. So we cut it, then. We can mention his name in passing, but not give it a section. *[short pause]* Next, kids who grow up with two languages.

Hannah: *[hesitant]* I was wondering about dropping that, actually. It's such a huge area.

Liam: *[firm but friendly]* Ah, no, I really think we need it. Half the people in our seminar group grew up speaking more than one language at home. They'll want to hear about it.

Hannah: *[conceding]* Fair point. Keep it, but keep it short. What's next?

Liam: *[enthusiastic]* Children learning sign language. There's that brilliant study from Nicaragua.

Hannah: *[regretful]* I'd love to include that, but realistically, we'd have to explain how sign languages work first, and we just haven't got the time.

Liam: *[sighs]* Yeah, you're right. It'd need a whole presentation of its own. And what about screen time, whether toddlers pick up words from the television?

Hannah: *[dismissive]* I'd have said drop that, to be honest. The research is pretty thin.

Liam: *[persuasive]* But that's kind of the point, isn't it? Everyone assumes educational programmes help, and the evidence says they mostly don't, not unless an adult is watching and talking about it with the child. That's a nice surprising finding. Just a minute or two.

Hannah: *[laughs]* All right, you win. And then babbling, which obviously stays. It's where everything starts.

Liam: Definitely.

Hannah: *[moving on]* Okay. Then the main section: child-directed speech. You know, the way adults talk to babies, with the high pitch and the exaggerated tune. Did anything in the reading surprise you?

Liam: *[thoughtful]* A couple of things. I'd always assumed it was mainly mothers who did it, and that dads sort of talked to babies the same way they talk to anyone else. But that study showed fathers change their voices just as much. That really surprised me.

Hannah: *[interested]* Mm. What about the bit showing that newborns would rather listen to it than to normal adult speech? I thought that was amazing, at only a few days old.

Liam: *[unimpressed, easy]* Honestly, that didn't really surprise me. Babies like anything that sounds a bit musical. *[more animated]* What did get me was that it isn't universal. I'd taken it for granted that every culture does it, but there are communities where adults hardly speak directly to babies at all, and the kids still learn to talk perfectly well.

Hannah: *[agreeing]* Yes, that was striking. And older brothers and sisters doing it to toddlers, I found that quite unexpected.

Liam: *[chuckles]* Not me. I've got a four-year-old niece, and she talks to her baby brother exactly like that.

Hannah: *[laughs]* Fair enough. And the old claim that it holds back vocabulary?

Liam: *[matter-of-fact]* Well, nobody really believes that any more. The studies show the opposite, which is pretty much what I'd have expected.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 25 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Hannah: *[hesitant]* Now, about the video. I was planning to show that clip of my cousin's little boy, the one where he's naming everything in the garden.

Liam: *[mildly sceptical]* It's lovely, but it's nearly ten minutes long, isn't it?

Hannah: Oh, I'd only play a minute of it, I can cut it down easily. And the sound's fine, I recorded it on a decent microphone. *[short pause]* *[sighs]* But I've decided not to use it after all. I mentioned it to my cousin, and she wasn't keen on her son being shown to a room full of strangers.

Liam: *[understanding]* No, absolutely, that's her call. We'll find something online instead.

Liam: *[enthusiastic]* Then I want to do the 'wug' experiment. You know, the one where kids are shown a drawing of a made-up creature called a wug, and then two of them, and they have to finish the sentence: 'There are two...'

Hannah: *[doubtful]* Isn't it a bit old, though? It was done in the nineteen fifties.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Liam: *[firm]* It's old, but it hasn't dated at all. I don't think there's anything that shows more clearly that kids aren't just copying what they hear. They've never heard the word 'wugs', so they must be applying a rule.

Hannah: *[hesitant]* Some people say the results were overstated, though. That a lot of the kids were just guessing.

Liam: *[polite but dismissive]* I've read that critique, and I don't buy it. The results have been repeated loads of times.

Hannah: *[thinking]* Okay. That leads nicely into mistakes like 'I goed' or 'two mouses'.

Liam: Yeah. Parents get really worried about those.

Hannah: *[amused]* And they correct them constantly, which, according to everything we read, makes almost no difference.

Liam: *[agreeing]* Right. And people think they've stopped by about four, but actually some kids carry on making them till they're six or seven.

Hannah: *[emphatic]* The point we need to get across is that they're not a sign that anything's wrong. It's the reverse, really: the child has worked out the rule and is just using it too widely. That's a step forward.

Liam: Agreed. That's our key message for that section.

Liam: *[practical]* What about a handout? Last time the tutor said ours was far too long.

Hannah: *[thinking]* I'd rather not give anything out at the start. People just read it instead of listening.

Liam: We could put all the references on the final slide...

Hannah: *[doubtful]* Nobody can copy down twenty references in the thirty seconds it's up.

Liam: *[decisive]* Okay, so let's email a one-page summary to everyone once the session's over.

Hannah: Yes, that's the best option.

Hannah: *[anxious]* I'm a bit worried about questions at the end, though. What if someone asks something we can't answer?

Liam: *[relaxed]* That doesn't bother me. We just say we'll look into it. And we've left five minutes, which is plenty. *[more serious]* What I'm more concerned about is what happened last term, when we asked for questions and there was total silence. It was so awkward.

Hannah: *[laughs]* Oh, I remember. So should we get a friend to ask something?

Liam: *[chuckles]* Better than that, we'll finish with a question for them to discuss in pairs. That'll get them talking.

Hannah: *[businesslike]* Right. So what next? Should we book a meeting with Dr Morgan to check the plan?

Liam: *[hesitant]* I don't think we need to. She said she's happy as long as we stick to the outline. And we can't really run through it properly till the slides are finished.

Hannah: *[agreeing]* True. The problem is, most of our sources are from the nineties. We need some recent research, especially on bilingualism.

Liam: *[decisive]* Okay, let's both spend tomorrow in the library looking for studies from the last five years, and then meet up again on Thursday.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-22

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

21-22 Which TWO topics do the students decide to leave out of their presentation?

- A** the theory that grammar is innate
- B** bilingual children
- C** the acquisition of sign language
- D** the influence of television
- E** babbling

Questions 23-24

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

23-24 Which TWO findings about child-directed speech surprised Liam?

- A** Men adapt their speech to babies as much as women do.
- B** Newborn babies prefer it to ordinary adult speech.
- C** It is not used in all societies.
- D** Young children use it with younger siblings.
- E** It does not slow down vocabulary development.

Questions 25-30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

25 Why has Hannah decided not to show the video clip?

- A** It would take up too much time.
- B** The sound quality is poor.
- C** A family member has objected.

26 What is Liam's opinion of the 'wug' experiment?

- A** It is too old to be relevant now.
- B** It is convincing evidence that children learn rules.
- C** Its findings have been exaggerated.

27 What do the students agree about errors such as 'I goed'?

- A** They show that a child is making progress.
- B** Parents should point them out to the child.
- C** They have usually disappeared by the age of four.

28 What do the students decide to do about the handout?

- A** give it out before they begin
- B** include the references on a slide
- C** send it to people afterwards

29 What is Liam worried about regarding the question session?

- A** not knowing the answers
- B** not having enough time
- C** the audience not responding

30 What will the students do next?

- A** arrange to see their tutor
- B** rehearse the presentation
- C** look for more up-to-date studies

Urban Heat Islands

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · Canadian (en-CA)

Scenario: A lecturer in urban geography gives a talk on the causes and effects of urban heat islands and on ways of reducing them.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	Canadian (en-CA)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	University lecturer in urban geography — female, 40s, energetic, clear, engaging; Canadian accent
Script length	5,746 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about urban heat islands. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. [post: 45 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture hall, a low murmur fading] [warm, energetic]* Okay, good afternoon, everyone.

Today we're turning to a topic that's become increasingly urgent for city planners, and that's what's known as the urban heat island: the simple fact that cities are often a great deal hotter than the countryside around them.

Lecturer: *[explanatory]* The difference can be dramatic. In extreme cases, a large city can be as much as twelve degrees warmer than the farmland that surrounds it. *[emphatic, slowing down]* And here's what surprises most people. The gap isn't at its greatest in the middle of the afternoon, when the sun is strongest. It's widest at night, because the city keeps releasing the heat it has soaked up during the day for hours after sunset, while the countryside cools down quite quickly.

Lecturer: *[measured]* So what causes it? Well, the first factor is the materials we build with. Dark surfaces like asphalt and roofing tar absorb most of the sunlight that hits them, rather than bouncing it back. Scientists describe this property using the term albedo, that's A... L... B... E... D... O, which is simply a measure of how much light a surface reflects.

Lecturer: *[light, illustrative]* Fresh snow, for example, has a very high albedo; it sends most of the light back into the sky. Asphalt, on the other hand, has an extremely low albedo, which is why a parking lot in July can burn your feet.

Lecturer: *[informative]* The second factor is the shape of the city. Tall buildings placed close together form what are called urban canyons. Heat bounces back and forth between the walls and gets trapped, and the buildings also block the wind that would otherwise carry that warm air away.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* And third, there's what we call waste heat: the heat given off by human activity. You'd probably guess that traffic is the main source, and in a lot of cities, that's true. But in the case study I'll be referring to throughout today, which looked at a mid-sized city in Ontario, it wasn't vehicles that produced the most waste heat. It was industry, largely because of a cluster of factories right next to downtown. Air conditioning units came a fairly distant third.

Lecturer: *[serious]* Now, the effects. The most obvious one is on health. Heat waves kill more people in North America each year than any other type of weather event, and the elderly are especially at risk, because the body's ability to cool itself declines with age.

Lecturer: *[informative]* But there's an economic side, too. When a city heats up, demand for electricity rises sharply, mainly because of all those air conditioners running at once, and utilities

sometimes struggle to keep up. Natural gas use, by contrast, hardly changes at all in summer, so that isn't really where the costs come from.

Lecturer: *[engaged]* There's also an effect on water that's often overlooked. When rain falls on hot pavement and rooftops, the water warms up before it drains into streams and rivers. And that's a real problem for fish that depend on cold water. In the Ontario study, researchers recorded a sharp decline in trout in the streams below the city. *[aside]* Not salmon, interestingly; they'd disappeared from that river long before the city expanded, so it's trout that are now under pressure.

Lecturer: *[brisk, transitioning]* So, what can be done? Let's look at four approaches. The first is the cool roof. People tend to picture white roof tiles, but in fact most cool roofs are just ordinary roofs with a reflective coating applied on top, usually white or pale grey. It's cheap, it can go onto an existing building, and it can lower the surface temperature of a roof by thirty degrees or more.

Lecturer: *[balanced]* The second approach is the green roof, a roof planted with vegetation. Green roofs cool the air through evaporation, and they soak up rainwater, which helps reduce flooding. They're a lot more expensive than cool roofs, though, and many older buildings simply aren't strong enough to support the weight of wet soil.

Lecturer: *[enthusiastic]* The third approach, and probably the one residents like best, is planting street trees. But not all trees are equally useful. The key thing isn't how tall a tree grows. What really matters is having wide canopies, that's the spreading layer of branches and leaves that actually throws shade onto the street. A tall, narrow tree like a poplar does surprisingly little.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[informative]* In the Ontario city, the tree-planting program was interesting because of where it was targeted. You might expect planners to start with the oldest neighbourhoods, or with the downtown core, where it's hottest. Instead, they focused on districts where people had a low income, because those areas had the fewest trees to begin with, and residents there were the least likely to own air conditioners.

Lecturer: *[measured]* The fourth approach is the cool pavement: road and sidewalk surfaces that are made lighter in colour. These do work, but they've turned out to have an unexpected drawback. On bright days, the light reflected off them creates glare, which pedestrians find really uncomfortable, and some studies suggest they can actually make people walking on them feel hotter, not cooler.

Lecturer: *[reflective]* So why haven't these measures been adopted everywhere? You'd assume the main obstacle is the initial cost, and that's certainly an issue. But the city officials interviewed in the Ontario study said that wasn't really what held them back. The bigger problem, they said, was maintenance. Reflective coatings get dirty and gradually lose their effect, and young trees need regular watering for several years. The money for that kind of upkeep just isn't there in most budgets.

Lecturer: *[wrapping up, brisk]* Okay. Next week we'll look at how heat islands are measured, using satellite images and sensors mounted on buses. Please read chapter seven before then.

Narrator: *That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.*
[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

URBAN HEAT ISLANDS

- 31** Causes — The temperature difference between a city and the surrounding area is largest at _____
- 32** Dark materials such as asphalt reflect little light: they have a low _____
- 33** In the Ontario study, most waste heat came from _____
- 34** Effects — Hot weather sharply increases the need for _____
- 35** Warm runoff has led to a fall in numbers of _____ in nearby streams
- 36** Solutions — Cool roofs: usually a reflective _____ is added to a normal roof
- 37** Street trees: the best species have broad _____
- 38** Ontario planting programme aimed at areas where residents' _____ was low
- 39** Cool pavements: reflected light can cause _____, which people on foot dislike
- 40** Officials see _____, not set-up costs, as the main barrier

FT02 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Pellowe / PELLOWE	Craig reads it back without the final E, and the caller has to add it again.
2	2037 / two-oh-three-seven	She first gives 2039, which is her office postcode.
3	grandmother	Her sister (airport trips) was the past reason; work is ruled out.
4	swimming pool / pool	The light rail stop bay is always booked and the library bay is closed for roadworks.
5	Plus / Plus plan	She first wants Casual, and Premium is also mentioned and rejected.
6	14.95 / \$14.95 / 14,95	The website's out-of-date figure of \$12.50 is said first.
7	electricity bill	A bank statement is acceptable but she can't supply one, phone bills are no longer accepted, and the gas bill isn't in her name.
8	C (They pay for each quarter of an hour.)	A was the old system (\$25 flat); B is what other clubs do, which Craig says they don't.
9	A (Record any damage to the vehicle)	Phoning was the old rule ('You don't need to call us'); checking fuel is something some members do but is unnecessary.
10	C (She needs to check a relative's plans.)	She thinks she must wait for the card but Craig says it isn't needed; the hatchback is free on Saturday.
11	C (has a display made by local children)	F: there used to be a café here, but it closed last spring.
12	G (is inaccessible to wheelchair users)	A: an audio post was planned here but never installed.
13	D (has been returned to its original colour)	Black is the colour people remember, not the original colour.
14	H (contains a reproduction of a missing object)	E: people climb the steps for a view, but the speaker says you can't see much.
15	B (can only be entered as part of an organised group)	Listeners may think they can't be visited at all because they are private homes.
16	A (has an interactive audio feature)	F and E: a café is across the road and the best view is from the water tower, neither of which is part of the shed.
17	B (They were created by someone from the town.)	A: recycled plastic was proposed but bronze was chosen; C: they 'shouldn't need replacing for a very long time'.
18	B (around ninety minutes)	A is the leaflet's figure (45 minutes); C is what some people choose to do, with lunch.
19	A (Install it before setting out.)	B: she personally prefers the leaflet map; C: the free version is enough.
20	A (lend images of the town's past)	B: enough guides have already been found; C: building suggestions were requested last year.
21-22	A + C (any order)	B and D are each suggested for cutting by Hannah but Liam persuades her to keep them; E stays.
23-24	A + C (any order)	B and D surprised Hannah, not Liam; E is what Liam expected.
25	C (A family member has objected.)	A is Liam's worry, but Hannah can cut it down; B is denied ('the sound's fine').
26	B (It is convincing evidence that children learn rules.)	A and C are Hannah's reservations, both rejected by Liam.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
27	A (They show that a child is making progress.)	B: correcting 'makes almost no difference'; C: some children continue until six or seven.
28	C (send it to people afterwards)	A and B are both suggested and rejected by Hannah.
29	C (the audience not responding)	A is Hannah's worry ('That doesn't bother me!'); B is dismissed ('five minutes, which is plenty').
30	C (look for more up-to-date studies)	A is suggested but Liam says it isn't necessary; B can't happen until the slides are finished.
31	night	Listeners may expect the afternoon, which the lecturer explicitly rejects.
32	albedo	The prompt paraphrases 'absorb most of the sunlight'; fresh snow is an example of the opposite.
33	industry	Traffic is the usual main source and air conditioning is mentioned as third.
34	electricity	Natural gas is mentioned but its use hardly changes.
35	trout	Salmon is mentioned but had disappeared long before.
36	coating	White roof tiles are what people imagine, not what is usually used.
37	canopies	Height is mentioned first and rejected; the plural form is spoken.
38	income	The oldest neighbourhoods and the downtown core are suggested and rejected.
39	glare	Heat is also mentioned as a possible problem, but the gap requires what reflected light creates.
40	maintenance / upkeep	Initial cost is the expected answer but officials say it wasn't the main problem; 'upkeep' is a synonym but the spoken word is maintenance.

Listening Full Test 3

FT03 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Booking a Canal Narrowboat Holiday	British (en-GB)
2	Induction for Volunteer Theatre Ushers	British (en-GB)
3	River Erosion Field-Trip Report	British (en-GB); one student Scottish-accented (en-GB)
4	The Economics of the Medieval English Wool Trade	British (en-GB)

Booking a Canal Narrowboat Holiday

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A man phones a holiday company to book a week on a canal narrowboat for his family.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lorna	Booking adviser at a canal holiday company — female, 40s, warm, efficient, candid; British accent (southern English)
Voice: Martin	Caller — male, late 30s, friendly, a little unsure, good-humoured; British accent (Midlands)
Script length	5,654 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a man phoning a holiday company to book a canal narrowboat holiday.

First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 5. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 1 to 5.

— **Chunk 1 of 2** —

Lorna: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [bright, professional]* Good morning, Hartwell Waterways, Lorna speaking. How can I help?

Martin: *[friendly, slightly unsure]* Oh, hello. I'm hoping to book a narrowboat for a week this summer. I've never done anything like this before, so, er, bear with me.

Lorna: *[warm, reassuring]* Not at all, most of our customers are first-timers. Let me just take a few details first. Could I have your name?

Martin: Yes, it's Martin Wardrop.

Lorna: *[careful, checking]* Is that spelt like the furniture? W-A-R-D-R-O-B-E?

Martin: *[light laugh]* Everybody says that. No, it's W... A... R... D... R... O... P. There's no E on the end.

Lorna: *[repeating slowly, as if typing]* W... A... R... D... R... O... P. Lovely. And how many of you will be on the boat?

Martin: *[sighs]* Well, it was going to be six. My sister and her husband were coming, but they've had to pull out because of work. So it's just me, my wife and our two boys now.

Lorna: *[noting it down]* So that's four of you altogether, then.

Martin: That's right.

Lorna: *[practical]* And how old are the boys? We put life jackets on board, so I need to know which sizes to give you.

Martin: *[thinking]* Nine and twelve. Well, the younger one's nine now, but he'll be ten by August.

Lorna: *[noting it down]* Two junior sizes, then. And they'll need to wear them on deck at all times, I'm afraid, even if they're strong swimmers.

Martin: *[chuckles]* They won't like that, but fair enough.

Lorna: *[practical]* And when were you thinking of going? Our hire weeks run Saturday to Saturday.

Martin: *[thinking aloud]* Some time in August. We'd set off on Saturday the twenty-third, I think... *[short pause]* no, hang on, that's the day we'd have to be home. So we'd set off on the sixteenth.

Lorna: *[checking her screen]* Departing the sixteenth of August, back on the twenty-third. Yes, I've got boats available that week. Now, which of our bases would suit you? There are three on this stretch of the canal.

Martin: *[hopeful]* The website mentioned Stoke Lock. That's the nearest one to us.

Lorna: *[apologetic]* I'm afraid Stoke Lock is fully booked for the whole of August. And Abbey Basin isn't really an option either, because the canal's closed there until September while they replace the lock gates. *[brighter]* But we do have boats at Orchard Wharf, which is only about twenty minutes further on.

Martin: *[agreeable]* Orchard Wharf. That's fine, we're driving anyway.

Lorna: *[informative]* Speaking of which, you can leave your car at the wharf while you're away. It's twelve pounds a day...

Martin: *[doing the sum aloud, slightly alarmed]* Twelve a day? So that'd be, er, eighty-four for the week?

Lorna: *[reassuring]* No, no. If you pay for the whole week up front, it's a flat rate of forty-five pounds. *[slightly apologetic]* It used to be free, but the landowner started charging last year.

Martin: *[relieved]* Forty-five. That's not bad at all. *[hesitant]* Er, one other thing that worries me. Do we need any experience? I've only ever rowed a dinghy on a boating lake.

Lorna: *[chuckles]* You'd be surprised how many people say that. No experience needed. Before you leave, one of our staff spends about an hour on the boat with you, showing you how to steer and work the locks. Right, shall I tell you about the boats that are free that week?

Martin: Yes, please.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 6 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 6 to 10.*

Lorna: *[reading from her screen]* OK, there are three. The first is Kingfisher. She sleeps four, and she's the shortest of the three, which makes her much easier to handle. We often recommend her to beginners.

Martin: *[interested]* That sounds ideal, actually.

Lorna: *[candid]* The one thing people do comment on is the space. The bedroom's fine, it's got a proper double bed, and the kitchen's very well equipped, but the shower is really tiny. *[light laugh]* If you're tall, you'll notice.

Martin: *[wry]* I'm six foot two, so... noted. And what does she cost?

Lorna: *[clearly]* In June she'd be nine hundred and eighty pounds, but August is peak season, so for your week it's one thousand, one hundred and sixty.

Martin: *[repeating, writing it down]* One thousand one hundred and sixty. OK.

Lorna: *[moving on]* The second is Moorhen, which sleeps six, so you'd all have more room to spread out. We used to provide a couple of kayaks with her, but there were rather too many, er, accidents, so these days she comes with two bicycles instead. They're handy for riding along the towpath to the village shops.

Martin: *[enthusiastic]* Oh, the boys would love that. Is there a catch?

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Lorna: *[honest, measured]* She's one of our older boats. I wouldn't say the engine's unreliable, because it was fully serviced in the spring, but it is quite loud, so whoever's steering at the back will hear it all day.

Martin: *[chuckles]* Fair enough. And the price for Moorhen?

Lorna: One thousand, three hundred and twenty-five for the week.

Martin: Right.

Lorna: *[brightly]* And the third is Heron, our newest boat. She was only launched in March, and she also sleeps six. People tend to assume she's got a washing machine, which she hasn't, but she does have a dishwasher, and that always goes down well.

Martin: *[laughs]* My wife would be thrilled. What's the downside?

Lorna: *[slightly apologetic]* She's the longest boat in the fleet, so she can't turn round in some of the narrower sections, and you'd have to plan your route much more carefully. She's one thousand, four hundred and ninety.

Martin: *[thinking aloud]* Hmm. *[short pause]* I was leaning towards Kingfisher, but with my height... I think it'll be Moorhen. The bikes swing it, really.

Lorna: *[pleased]* Lovely, I'll reserve her for you now. We'll need a deposit of a quarter of the total within seven days, and I'll email you the paperwork this afternoon.

Martin: *[warmly]* Brilliant. Can I pay the deposit by card over the phone?

Lorna: *[helpful]* You can, or by bank transfer if you prefer. The details are on the confirmation email. The balance is then due six weeks before you travel.

Martin: *[pleased]* Card's easiest. Thanks so much for your help, Lorna.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-5

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

HARTWELL WATERWAYS — NARROWBOAT BOOKING

- 1 Customer: Martin _____
2 Size of party: _____ people
3 Start of holiday: Saturday _____ August
4 Base where boat is picked up: _____ Wharf
5 Car park: £ _____ if paying in advance for seven days

Questions 6-10

Complete the table below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Boats available: 16-23 August

Boat	Sleeps	Advantage	Disadvantage	Price for the week
Kingfisher	4	easy to steer — suitable for beginners	very small (6) _____	£(7) _____
Moorhen	6	two (8) _____ included	(9) _____ engine	£1,325
Heron	6	newest boat; has a (10) _____	unable to turn in narrow places	£1,490

- 6 Kingfisher — disadvantage: very small _____
7 Kingfisher — price for the week: £ _____
8 Moorhen — advantage: two _____ included
9 Moorhen — disadvantage: _____ engine
10 Heron — advantage: has a _____

Induction for Volunteer Theatre Ushers

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: The front-of-house manager at a theatre gives an induction talk to a group of new volunteer ushers.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.55 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Diane	Front-of-house manager — female, 50s, energetic, organised, friendly but firm, occasionally wry; British accent (northern English, light)
Script length	5,284 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 2. You will hear the front-of-house manager at a theatre giving an induction talk to some new volunteer ushers. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 15. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 11 to 15.

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Diane: *[large echoey foyer, a few voices settling] [warm, projecting to a group]* Right, good evening, everyone, and welcome to the Corran Theatre. I'm Diane, I run front of house, which means that for the next few months you'll be seeing rather a lot of me. *[light laugh]* Thank you all for volunteering.

Diane: *[brisk, practical]* We'll start with a quick tour of the ground floor, because the first thing audiences do is ask you where things are. So, we're standing just inside the main entrance, facing into the building. The box office is right here on your right, and the bar runs along the whole of the left-hand wall.

Diane: *[explaining, a little wry]* Now, the cloakroom. Regular visitors will tell you it's next to the box office, because that's where it used to be. It isn't any more; that space is now the shop, selling programmes and souvenirs. The cloakroom has moved to the opposite side, in the corner immediately to your left as you come through the doors, just before the bar begins.

Diane: *[pointing the way verbally, clear]* Straight ahead of us is the grand staircase, which takes you up to the circle, and on either side of it there's a set of double doors into the stalls. To the left of the staircase, a corridor runs all the way along the side of the auditorium, and there's a matching one on the right.

Diane: *[friendly, informative]* Let's take the left-hand corridor first. The first door you come to, on your left, says Technical Store. *[firm]* That's not ours, please don't go in there. Keep walking right to the far end, and the door facing you is the volunteers' room. That's where you'll leave your bags, sign in and get your briefing before each show.

Diane: *[slightly amused]* People are always surprised by where we've put the lift. You'd expect it beside the main staircase, wouldn't you? But it isn't. It's tucked away in the alcove at the far end of the bar, in the back left-hand corner of the foyer, so if someone in a wheelchair asks, send them past the bar, not towards the stairs.

Diane: *[serious, measured]* Now the right-hand corridor. About halfway along, on your right, is the first-aid room. *[emphatic]* Don't confuse it with the door at the very end of that corridor. That leads backstage to the stage door, and it's strictly for cast and crew.

Diane: *[warmly]* And finally, something we're rather proud of. The little room underneath the grand staircase, which you get into from the foyer, used to be a storage cupboard. We've turned it into a quiet room, for anyone, child or adult, who finds a performance overwhelming and needs a few minutes somewhere calm.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 16 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 16 to 20.*

Diane: *[practical, brisk]* Right, a few things about the job itself. First, what you wear. We'll issue each of you with a burgundy waistcoat and a name badge. We used to hand out jackets, but under the stage lights they were far too hot. What you wear underneath is up to you, within reason: a plain white shirt, and dark trousers or a skirt.

Diane: *[correcting a common assumption]* Some of you may have heard that shirts must be black. That was the old rule, and it's gone. *[firm but kind]* Shoes, though: I know you're on your feet for three hours, but trainers aren't acceptable, I'm afraid. They need to be black and polished.

Diane: *[thoughtful, slightly rueful]* Latecomers. In the past, we'd simply take them in with a torch during the first scene, and it caused absolute chaos in the rows. So that's stopped. Now they wait until the stage manager radios through to say there's a suitable break, and until then they can follow the show on the monitor in the foyer.

Diane: *[warning tone]* And whatever you do, don't tell a latecomer they'll get their money back. Refunds aren't your decision; that's entirely up to the box office.

Diane: *[conversational, then emphatic]* The interval. People think the interval is all about ice creams, and yes, some of you will have a tray to sell from. But what I really need is for you to stay in your section and keep the aisles and exits clear, because that's when bags and coats start piling up and someone trips. *[lighter]* We did ask ushers to count the audience at one time, but that's done electronically from the tickets now.

Diane: *[very serious, slowing down]* Fire procedures. Our alarm has two stages. The first is an intermittent tone, and that's an alert only. You don't move anyone, and you don't say a word to the audience. You go straight to the exit you've been allocated on your rota and wait there.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Diane: *[firm, clear]* If the tone becomes continuous, that's when you evacuate your section. And you don't need to ring nine-nine-nine, because the system contacts the fire service automatically. Your job is people, not phone calls.

Diane: *[encouraging, warmer]* One last thing. I'd really encourage you all to come to the dress rehearsal on the twelfth. Now, it isn't so that you can see the show for nothing, although of course you will. And it's not really a chance to meet the actors either; they're far too busy and nervous to chat.

Diane: *[earnest]* The point is that you'll find out exactly when the sudden blackouts and the very loud effects happen. There's a gunshot in act two, for instance. If you know it's coming, you won't be caught out, and you can reassure anyone in your section who's startled.

Diane: *[bright, wrapping up]* Right, that's the talking done. Let's go and find those waistcoats, and then I'll walk you round so you can see it all for yourselves.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-15

Label the plan below. Write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 11-15.

Corran Theatre — Ground Floor

Plan (for the designer): Plan of the theatre ground floor, oriented with the MAIN ENTRANCE in the middle of the bottom (south) edge. The bottom half of the plan is the FOYER, a wide rectangle. Fixed labelled landmarks: BOX OFFICE immediately inside the entrance on the right (south-east part of foyer); BAR running along the whole left (west) wall of the foyer; GRAND STAIRCASE in the centre of the back (north) side of the foyer; two sets of DOUBLE DOORS into the STALLS, one either side of the staircase; the AUDITORIUM fills the top (north) half, with the STAGE at its far north end; a LEFT CORRIDOR runs north from the foyer's back-left corner along the west side of the auditorium; a RIGHT CORRIDOR runs north from the foyer's back-right corner along the east side of the auditorium. Lettered rooms: A — in the foyer, south-west corner, immediately left of the main entrance, just south of where the bar begins. B — left corridor, first door on the left (west) side near the corridor's start. C — left corridor, at its far north end, the door facing you as you walk along it. D — foyer, against the east wall directly beside (north of) the box office. E — right corridor, a door on the right (east) side about halfway along. F — a small room underneath the grand staircase, entered from the foyer. G — right corridor, the door at its far north end, beside the stage. H — foyer, alcove in the back-left (north-west) corner, at the far end of the bar.

A	A
B	B
C	C
D	D
E	E
F	F
G	G
H	H

11 Cloakroom

12 Volunteers' room

13 Lift

14 First-aid room

15 Quiet room

Questions 16-20

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

16 What does Diane say about the ushers' clothing?

- A** Volunteers must supply a dark-coloured shirt.
- B** Volunteers will be given a garment to wear over their shirt.
- C** Volunteers may wear any footwear that is comfortable.

17 What should ushers do when people arrive after a performance has started?

- A** lead them to their seats immediately using a light
- B** explain how they can obtain a refund
- C** direct them to a screen until they can be admitted

18 According to Diane, what is the ushers' main responsibility during the interval?

- A** making sure routes through the auditorium are unobstructed
- B** selling refreshments
- C** keeping a record of audience numbers

19 What should ushers do when they first hear the fire alarm?

- A** start moving the audience out of the building
- B** go to a specific exit and remain there
- C** call the emergency services

20 Why does Diane want the volunteers to attend the dress rehearsal?

- A** so that they can watch the production free of charge
- B** so that they can be introduced to the cast
- C** so that they know when to expect sudden changes in sound and lighting

River Erosion Field-Trip Report

Academic discussion: 2 students + lecturer (3 speakers) · British (en-GB); one student Scottish-accented (en-GB)

Scenario: Two geography students, Hannah and Callum, discuss the draft of their field-trip report on river bank erosion with their lecturer, Dr Mercer.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB); one student Scottish-accented (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Dr Mercer	Geography lecturer — female, 50s, direct, dry humour, supportive but exacting; British RP accent
Voice: Hannah	Student — female, early 20s, keen, quick, a little anxious; British accent (southern English)
Voice: Callum	Student — male, early 20s, laid-back, frank, sceptical; clearly Scottish accent (en-GB)
Script length	6,317 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear two geography students, Hannah and Callum, talking to their lecturer, Dr Mercer, about their field-trip report on river erosion. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 25. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 21 to 25.

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Dr Mercer: *[small office, a door closing softly]* *[friendly, brisk]* Come in, both of you, sit down. So, I've read your draft on the erosion fieldwork at Ashcombe. There's a lot of good material in it, but structurally it needs some work, so let's go through it section by section.

Hannah: *[keen, slightly nervous]* Great, thanks. We were a bit worried about the length, actually.

Dr Mercer: *[dry]* Rightly so. Let's start with the site description.

Callum: *[frank, relaxed]* I did wonder if we could just cut that altogether. Everyone on the module knows the site. We all went there on the same day.

Dr Mercer: *[patient, a touch dry]* Your external examiner didn't, though. No, it needs to stay. But at the moment it's sitting on its own and repeating half of what's already in your introduction. I'd fold the two together into a single section.

Hannah: *[agreeing]* That makes sense. One tidy section rather than two half-empty ones.

Callum: *[conceding, good-humoured]* Fair enough.

Dr Mercer: *[moving on]* Then the methods. Now, this is very thorough...

Hannah: *[anxious, cutting in]* Too thorough? Should we shorten it?

Dr Mercer: *[reassuring]* I wouldn't cut a word of it, actually. It's accurate, and someone could repeat your study from it. The trouble is that three pages on calibrating a flow meter interrupt the reader just when they want your argument. Keep a short summary in the main text, and put the step-by-step detail at the back, after the references.

Callum: *[making a note]* Right, so the full procedure gets tucked in at the end as supplementary material.

Dr Mercer: *[more serious]* Next, your velocity and discharge results. *[short pause]* This is where I have real concerns. Your discharge figures are roughly a hundred times too big.

Callum: [*slightly defensive*] Aye, we wondered about that. Hannah thought the flow meter might've been faulty. Could we get one of the technicians to look at it?

Hannah: [*quickly*] I did think that at first, but...

Dr Mercer: [*firm but kind*] There's nothing wrong with the meter. I've checked the log, and it was calibrated the day before you went out. The problem is that you measured the channel width in centimetres and the depth in metres and then multiplied them. So it's the working-out that has to be done again, from scratch.

Hannah: [*groans*] Oh no. That's embarrassing.

Dr Mercer: [*lightly*] It happens every year. Sediment analysis, now. The sieving results look plausible, but the weights for samples four, five and six are oddly identical, which makes me wonder whether the balance was misbehaving that day.

Hannah: [*thinking aloud*] Could we add some close-up photos of the samples? Then people could see the difference in grain size for themselves.

Dr Mercer: [*doubtful*] Pictures won't tell anyone what anything weighs. Before you change a single number, take your raw data to Julia, the technician in the soils lab. She looks after the balances, and she'll tell you whether those readings can be trusted.

Callum: [*agreeing*] I'll email her today.

Hannah: [*practical*] And should we wait to hear from her before we touch the discussion? Because if those weights change, our whole argument about grain size changes too.

Dr Mercer: [*approving*] Exactly. Don't rewrite anything that depends on those samples until she's had a look.

Hannah: [*hesitant*] And the evaluation? We're well over the word limit, so I was thinking we could just drop it.

Dr Mercer: [*firm*] Absolutely not. It's a required section, and you'd lose marks. But it's currently longer than your results, which is the wrong way round. Bring it down to about half its present length, and focus on the two or three limitations that really matter.

Callum: [*wry chuckle*] So halve it, don't bin it.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 26 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 26 to 30.*

Dr Mercer: [*curious*] Remind me why you chose that stretch of river. It's not the most obvious site.

Callum: [*thoughtful*] Partly access. There's a footpath right down to the bank, so carrying all the kit was easy. But honestly, if that'd been the only thing, we'd have gone to the bridge site, which is even easier to get to.

Hannah: [*enthusiastic*] What actually decided it was that the department has records from exactly that stretch going back to the nineteen-nineties, so we could set our results against theirs. The meanders are lovely and pronounced as well, but that wasn't really why.

Dr Mercer: [*measured*] Good. Now, your erosion pins. You put twelve into the outer bank in March and measured them again in September.

Hannah: [*defensive*] We know twelve isn't many.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Dr Mercer: [*reassuring, then serious*] Actually, I don't think the number's the issue; twelve is perfectly respectable for a project this size. And you mention cattle possibly knocking them, but you said yourselves the field was fenced off. What worries me is that March to September misses the winter floods, and that's when most bank erosion takes place.

Hannah: [*quietly*] Right. We hadn't thought of that.

Dr Mercer: [*kindly*] Don't panic. You can't go back and measure in January now, but you must acknowledge it, and say what you'd expect a winter record to show.

Dr Mercer: [*turning to him*] Callum, how did you feel when you saw the outer bank figures?

Callum: *[candid]* Honestly? I'd expected the bank to have retreated by tens of centimetres, from everything in the textbooks, and it had hardly moved at all. *[short pause]* It's not that I doubted the readings. We measured every pin twice. And they're nothing like the department's older figures either, which showed much faster retreat.

Dr Mercer: *[probing]* So how are you going to explain that difference from the earlier data?

Hannah: *[confident]* I think it's the stone wall the landowner built upstream about ten years ago. It's protecting the bank, so there's less energy reaching our site.

Callum: *[politely disagreeing]* I'm not convinced. The wall's three hundred metres upstream. I'd say it's simply been a run of drier years, so there's been lower discharge.

Hannah: *[sighs, half-laughing]* We've been going round in circles on that for a week.

Dr Mercer: *[amused]* Well, at least you agree on everything else. You're both happy with scatter graphs for the results?

Callum: Aye, no argument there.

Hannah: *[warmly]* And we both want to keep the bits from our conversation with the farmer. That was really useful.

Dr Mercer: *[thoughtful]* Then present both explanations and weigh them up. And before you submit... I'd normally suggest swapping drafts with another group, but nobody else worked on your stretch, so that won't help much. Your reference list is fine; don't touch it. What I'd like you to do is read Pearson's article on artificial bank protection. It'll give you the evidence to judge Hannah's theory properly.

Callum: *[good-humoured, Scottish lilt]* Great. More reading. *[chuckles]* No, fair enough. Thanks, Dr Mercer.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-25

What do the students decide to do with each section of their report? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-G, next to Questions 21-25.

Actions

A	remove it completely
B	reduce its length
C	transfer it to an appendix
D	include more images
E	repeat the calculations
F	ask a member of staff to verify it
G	merge it with another section

21 Site description

22 Methods

23 Velocity and discharge results

24 Sediment analysis

25 Evaluation

Questions 26-30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

26 What was the main reason the students selected their section of the river?

- A** It was convenient for transporting equipment.
- B** Earlier data from the same location was available.
- C** The river bends there where the views were especially clear.

27 What is Dr Mercer's main criticism of the erosion pin data?

- A** Too few pins were used to give reliable results.
- B** Animals may have moved some of the pins.
- C** The period of measurement left out the key time of year.

28 How did Callum react to the results from the outer bank?

- A** He was surprised that erosion was lower than he had predicted.
- B** He was pleased that they matched previous findings.
- C** He suspected that some measurements were inaccurate.

29 What do Hannah and Callum disagree about?

- A** the best way to display their results
- B** whether to use material from an interview
- C** the reason for the change in the rate of erosion

30 What does Dr Mercer advise the students to do before submitting the report?

- A** update their bibliography
- B** consult a particular piece of published research
- C** compare drafts with fellow students

The Economics of the Medieval English Wool Trade

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A lecturer in economic history gives a talk on the economics of the English wool trade in the Middle Ages.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.55 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	Economic history lecturer — male, 50s, articulate, measured, engaging with dry wit; British RP accent
Script length	6,073 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about the economics of the medieval English wool trade. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. *[post: 45 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 31 to 40.

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture theatre, a faint murmur fading] [clear, engaging]* Good morning. Today we're turning to what was, for several centuries, the backbone of the English economy: wool. One historian remarked that England in this period was little more than a sheep farm with a government attached. *[wry]* An exaggeration, certainly, but not a huge one.

Lecturer: *[explaining, steady]* So why was English wool so sought after? It wasn't a question of volume; later on, Spain produced considerably more. Nor was it the colour, which actually varied a good deal from region to region. What buyers in Flanders and Italy were paying for was its fineness, by which I mean how thin and soft the individual fibres were, because that determined the quality of the cloth they could weave.

Lecturer: *[measured]* Now, you might assume that the great flocks belonged to the aristocracy, to earls and barons with vast estates. Some did, of course. But the really large-scale producers were monasteries, particularly those of the Cistercian order, some of which kept ten or fifteen thousand sheep on the uplands of Yorkshire and the Welsh borders.

Lecturer: *[informative, giving figures]* Wool was traded by the sack, a standard unit of about three hundred and sixty-four pounds in weight, or roughly the fleeces of two hundred and fifty sheep. At its peak, in the early fourteenth century, England was exporting somewhere in the region of thirty-five thousand sacks a year.

Lecturer: *[interested, building]* What's economically fascinating is how these monasteries sold their wool. Italian and Flemish merchants would pay for it in advance, sometimes for the next ten or even twenty years' production. *[short pause]* Now, this wasn't strictly a loan, and it wasn't really investment in the modern sense either. Economic historians generally describe it as a form of credit: the abbeys were, in effect, borrowing against wool that hadn't yet grown.

Lecturer: *[cautionary]* And this was a risky arrangement. If an epidemic swept through a flock, an abbey could find itself owing years of wool that it simply couldn't deliver. The term contemporaries used for these outbreaks was murrain. That's M... U... double R... A... I... N. It was a rather vague word, covering almost any disease of cattle or sheep, and several abbeys were left heavily in debt by murrain in the late thirteenth century.

Lecturer: *[signposting, shifting topic]* Let's turn now to the Crown, because English kings were very quick to see wool as a source of revenue. Export duties on wool became one of the largest items of royal income. *[sceptical]* It's often said that this money went into building castles, but in fact remarkably little did. Overwhelmingly, it paid for military campaigns, above all Edward the Third's campaigns in France during the Hundred Years' War.

Lecturer: *[informative]* To manage all this, the Crown created what was called the Staple: a single designated town through which all wool exports had to pass. The Staple moved around a great deal at first, between Bruges, Antwerp and a number of English ports, but from thirteen sixty-three it was fixed at Calais, then an English possession, and it remained there for almost two hundred years.

Lecturer: *[analytical, emphasising the contrast]* Officially, the Staple existed to guarantee quality, so that foreign buyers could trust what they were getting. That was the justification. *[slight emphasis]* But the real motive was far more practical. With all the wool passing through one place, collection of the tax became much simpler, and far harder to evade.

Lecturer: *[dry, amused]* The merchants who ran the Staple became extremely wealthy, and they regularly lent money to the king, sometimes in return for reductions in the very duties they were supposed to be paying. So the relationship between the Crown and the wool merchants was, shall we say, rather cosy.

Lecturer: *[transitional]* Now, these heavy duties on raw wool had an important side effect. Finished cloth was taxed much more lightly, so it increasingly made sense to weave the cloth in England and export that instead. And this shift was helped along by a change in a process called fulling. Fulling means beating woven cloth in water to thicken and clean it, and traditionally it was done by workers trampling it with their feet.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[explaining]* By the fourteenth century, fulling was increasingly mechanised. Wind power was tried in some flatter areas, but it proved too unreliable. The mills that succeeded were driven by water, which is why the cloth industry gradually drifted away from the old towns towards hilly districts with fast-flowing streams, such as the Cotswolds and the Pennine valleys.

Lecturer: *[warmer, anecdotal]* You can still see the profits of all this today. Wealthy wool and cloth merchants spent lavishly on their parish churches, and the so-called wool churches of Suffolk and the Cotswolds are strikingly large for such small villages. If you visit, notice that it isn't spires that dominate; spires are actually quite rare in these areas. What you see are tall, elaborately decorated towers, often paid for by a single merchant family.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* One more factor deserves a mention. After the Black Death in thirteen forty-eight, labour became scarce and expensive, and many landowners turned their fields over from crops to sheep, since a single shepherd could look after land that had once needed dozens of farm workers. That kept wool production high, even as exports of raw wool began to fall.

Lecturer: *[reflective]* Finally, decline. By the sixteenth century, English raw wool no longer dominated European markets. Partly that was because English weavers were now using so much of it themselves. But there was also serious competition from Spain, where a breed with an exceptionally fine fleece had been developed. Spanish merino wool gradually took over the luxury end of the market.

Lecturer: *[lighter, wrapping up]* The legacy of the trade survives in some odd places. The Lord Speaker in the House of Lords still sits on the Woolsack, a large cushion stuffed with wool, as a reminder of where England's wealth once came from. *[brisk]* Next week, we'll look at how the cloth industry developed in its own right.

Narrator: *That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.*
[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

The Medieval English Wool Trade

- 31 Demand: valued by foreign weavers mainly because of its _____
- 32 Many of the biggest flocks were owned by _____, not by the nobility
- 33 Payment years ahead by overseas merchants = a kind of _____
- 34 Risk: epidemics, called _____, could cause abbey's serious debt
- 35 Royal finance: wool export duties mostly funded military _____ (e.g. in France)
- 36 The Staple: permanently based in _____ after 1363
- 37 Actual aim of the Staple: easier _____ of duties
- 38 Rise of cloth: fulling mills were powered by _____
- 39 'Wool churches': notable for their tall _____
- 40 Decline: competition from wool produced by Spain's _____ sheep

FT03 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Wardrop	The adviser first suggests the spelling WARDROBE, which the caller rejects.
2	4 / four	Six is mentioned as the original number, and 'two boys' gives another tempting number.
3	16th / 16 / sixteenth	The caller first says the twenty-third, then realises that is the return date.
4	Orchard	Stoke Lock (fully booked) and Abbey Basin (canal closed) are both mentioned and rejected.
5	45 / forty-five	The daily rate of twelve pounds and the caller's calculation of eighty-four are both heard first; it also 'used to be free'.
6	shower	The bedroom and the kitchen are both mentioned first but described positively.
7	1,160 / 1160	The June price of £980 is given first.
8	bicycles / bikes	Kayaks used to be supplied with this boat but no longer are.
9	loud	'Unreliable' is mentioned but negated with wouldn't; 'older' describes the boat, not the engine's problem.
10	dishwasher	A washing machine is mentioned first but Heron does not have one.
11	A (A)	D (beside the box office) is where the cloakroom used to be; it is now the shop.
12	C (C)	B, the first door in the same corridor, is the technical store.
13	H (H)	Listeners expect it beside the staircase (F), which the speaker explicitly rejects.
14	E (E)	G, the door at the very end of the same corridor, leads to the stage door.
15	F (F)	'Storage cupboard' describes its former use, and the staircase was earlier rejected as the lift location.
16	B (Volunteers will be given a garment to wear over their shirt.)	A was the old rule (black shirts) and is now dropped; C is contradicted because trainers aren't acceptable.
17	C (direct them to a screen until they can be admitted)	A was the past practice, now stopped; B is explicitly forbidden — refunds are the box office's decision.
18	A (making sure routes through the auditorium are unobstructed)	Some ushers do sell ice creams but it is not the main point; counting the audience was done in the past.
19	B (go to a specific exit and remain there)	A happens only at the second (continuous) stage; C is unnecessary because the system calls the fire service.
20	C (so that they know when to expect sudden changes in sound and lighting)	A is true but 'isn't so that'; B is rejected — the actors are too busy to chat.
21	G (merge it with another section)	Callum suggests cutting it altogether (A), but the lecturer says it must stay.
22	C (transfer it to an appendix)	Hannah asks about shortening it (B), but the lecturer wouldn't cut a word.
23	E (repeat the calculations)	Callum suggests getting a technician to check the flow meter (F), which the lecturer rejects.
24	F (ask a member of staff to verify it)	Hannah suggests adding photos (D), which the lecturer dismisses.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
25	B (reduce its length)	Hannah wants to drop it entirely (A); 'absolutely not'.
26	B (Earlier data from the same location was available.)	A was 'partly' a reason but not the deciding one; C is true but 'wasn't really why'.
27	C (The period of measurement left out the key time of year.)	A is raised by Hannah but the lecturer says twelve is respectable; B is dismissed because the field was fenced.
28	A (He was surprised that erosion was lower than he had predicted.)	C is negated ('It's not that I doubted the readings'); B is contradicted ('nothing like the department's older figures').
29	C (the reason for the change in the rate of erosion)	Both agree on scatter graphs (A) and on keeping the farmer conversation (B).
30	B (consult a particular piece of published research)	C is what she'd normally suggest but it won't help here; A is rejected ('don't touch it').
31	fineness	Volume and colour are both mentioned and rejected first.
32	monasteries	The aristocracy (earls and barons) is suggested first as the expected answer.
33	credit	'Loan' and 'investment' are both mentioned and negated.
34	murrain	Generic words 'epidemic' and 'disease' are heard but are not the name asked for; spelling with double R must be caught.
35	campaigns	Castle-building is mentioned as a common belief but rejected.
36	Calais	Bruges, Antwerp and English ports were earlier, temporary locations.
37	collection	Guaranteeing quality is given as the official justification, not the real motive.
38	water	Wind power was tried but proved too unreliable; feet were the traditional method.
39	towers	Spires are mentioned but negated ('it isn't spires that dominate').
40	merino	'Fine fleece' and 'breed' are nearby distractor words; the singular-only answer must be the breed name.

Listening Full Test 4

FT04 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Reporting a Lost Bag	British (en-GB)
2	The Mill Lane Allotment Scheme	British (en-GB)
3	A Sleep and Memory Experiment	American (en-US) and British (en-GB)
4	Bioluminescence in Deep-Sea Animals	Australian (en-AU)

Reporting a Lost Bag

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A woman phones a railway company's lost property office to report a bag she left on a train the previous evening.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Gareth	Lost property clerk — male, 40s, calm, patient, methodical; British accent (light Midlands)
Voice: Helen	Caller — female, late 40s, articulate but tired and slightly flustered; British accent (southern English)
Script length	5,483 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a woman phoning a railway company's lost property office about a bag she left on a train. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 5. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 1 to 5. *[post: 2 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Gareth: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [polite, professional]* Good afternoon, Westmere Railways lost property office, Gareth speaking. How can I help?

Helen: *[slightly anxious, speaking quickly]* Oh, hello. Um, I think I left a bag on one of your trains, and I'm really hoping someone's handed it in.

Gareth: *[calm, reassuring]* Right, well, you've come to the right place. I'll take a few details first, and then I'll have a look at what's come in. Can I start with your name?

Helen: Yes, it's Helen Prothero.

Gareth: *[careful]* And could you spell the surname for me?

Helen: *[slowly, spelling each letter clearly]* P... R... O... T... H... E... R... O.

Gareth: *[reading back as he types]* P... R... O... T... H... E... R... O... E?

Helen: *[correcting him politely, a little weary]* No, there's no E at the end. Everyone adds one. It just finishes with the O.

Gareth: *[light laugh]* Sorry about that. I've taken it off. And a contact number?

Helen: My mobile's best. It's oh-seven-seven-one-two... *[short pause]* six-four-eight, three-oh-nine.

Gareth: *[repeating slowly]* Oh-seven-seven-one-two, six-four-eight, three-oh-nine. Lovely. Now, when did you travel?

Helen: *[thinking aloud]* It was Wednesday evening... so that would be the seventh.

Gareth: *[double-checking]* The seventh. So that's two days ago?

Helen: *[short pause] [flustered, correcting herself]* Oh, no, hang on, I'm muddling it up. Wednesday was when I travelled up for the conference. I came back yesterday, on Thursday, so it was the eighth. Sorry, it's been a long week.

Gareth: *[kindly]* Not a problem. Thursday the eighth. And do you know which train it was?

Helen: *[explaining]* It was from Redbourne to Kingsford. I was booked on the six-fifteen, but the last session overran and I missed it by about a minute, *[sighs]* so I ended up getting the next one, the

six forty-five.

Gareth: *[typing]* The eighteen forty-five from Redbourne. That's the slow one, isn't it? Stops at every station.

Helen: *[wry]* It certainly felt like it.

Gareth: *[checking]* And was it a direct train, or did you have to change anywhere along the way? Sometimes bags end up being handed in at a different station.

Helen: *[confident]* No, it was direct, thank goodness. I don't think I could have coped with a change. I just sat there with my eyes closed until Kingsford, and then, well... *[sighs]* I got off without it.

Gareth: *[businesslike]* Do you remember which part of the train you were in? It helps the cleaning teams know where to look.

Helen: *[light laugh]* Well, after the week I'd had, I'd have loved to be in first class, but I wasn't. The standard carriages were absolutely packed, so I went and found a seat in the quiet coach, right at the front.

Gareth: *[pleased]* The quiet coach, that's useful. They're usually less cluttered, so things get spotted. And where did you put the bag? Under the seat?

Helen: *[firm]* No, it's too bulky, it wouldn't fit under the seat. I put it up on the luggage rack, right above my head. *[ruefully]* That's exactly why I forgot it. I couldn't see it.

Gareth: *[sympathetic]* That's the most common one, honestly. Out of sight, out of mind.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 6 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 6 to 10. [post: 2 s pause]*

Gareth: *[methodical]* Right, now I need a description of the bag itself. What sort of bag is it? A suitcase, a rucksack...?

Helen: *[thinking]* It's a holdall. *[short pause]* My son calls it my gym bag, but it isn't really, I've never taken it near a gym. It's a proper holdall, with two handles and a long shoulder strap.

Gareth: A holdall. And what colour is it?

Helen: *[hesitant, then definite]* Well, it looks black in some lights, and the man at the station desk last night wrote down black, but it definitely isn't. It's navy blue, with a cream strap.

Gareth: *[noting it down]* Navy blue, cream strap. Is there anything that makes it stand out? A name tag, a label?

Helen: *[apologetic]* There used to be a name tag, but it tore off ages ago and I never replaced it. *[brightening]* But there's a little metal key ring on the zip. It's shaped like a lighthouse. *[chuckles]* My husband says it looks more like a rocket, but it's a lighthouse. We bought it on holiday in Cornwall.

Gareth: *[amused]* A lighthouse. That's actually really helpful. It's those little details that let us match an item to the right person.

Gareth: *[more serious]* And what was inside it? Anything valuable?

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Helen: *[relieved, then worried]* Well, luckily my laptop wasn't in it, I'd put that in my backpack, and my purse was in my coat pocket. But my camera was in there, and that's what I'm really upset about. All the photos from the week are on it. The rest is just clothes and a paperback.

Gareth: *[reassuring]* I'll mark the camera as the main item of value. Let me just check the system for yesterday evening... *[short pause]* Nothing matching yet, I'm afraid, but please don't worry. Anything found on the late trains is collected at the end of the line, and it usually reaches us here a day or two later.

Helen: *[hopeful]* Oh, that's good to know. And if it does turn up, how do I get it back?

Gareth: *[clear, explaining]* You can either come and collect it from this office, at Kingsford station, or we can post it to you. There is a fee, I'm afraid, either way.

Helen: *[cautious]* How much are we talking about?

Gareth: *[slightly apologetic]* To collect it in person, it's twelve pounds. It used to be ten, but it went up in April. If you'd rather we posted it, it's the twelve plus postage, and for a bag that size you'd be looking at another fifteen or so on top.

Helen: *[resigned, good-humoured]* In that case I'll definitely come and pick it up myself. I only live twenty minutes away. Twelve pounds it is.

Gareth: *[helpful]* Just bring some photo ID with you, a driving licence or a passport, and we're open eight till six, Monday to Saturday. And I'll ring your mobile the moment anything comes in.

Helen: *[warm, grateful]* Thank you so much, Gareth. You've been really kind.

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-10

Complete the form below. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

WESTMERE RAILWAYS — LOST PROPERTY REPORT

- 1 Name: Helen (1) _____
- 2 Date of journey: (2) _____
- 3 Train: the (3) _____ service from Redbourne to Kingsford
- 4 Seat: in the (4) _____ coach
- 5 Bag was placed on the (5) _____
- 6 Type of bag: (6) _____
- 7 Colour: (7) _____ (strap is cream)
- 8 Identifying feature: metal key ring in the form of a (8) _____
- 9 Main valuable item inside: (9) _____
- 10 Charge for collecting from the office: £(10) _____

The Mill Lane Allotment Scheme

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A council officer speaks to residents at a public meeting about a new community allotment scheme on a former plant nursery site.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Joanna	Council community projects officer — female, 40s, warm, organised, confident public speaker; British accent (neutral southern English)
Script length	5,579 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 2. You will hear a council officer talking to local residents about a new community allotment scheme. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 14. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 11 to 14. *[post: 2 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Joanna: *[small community hall, a few chairs scraping, then quiet] [warm, projecting to a room]* Good evening, everyone, and thank you for coming out on such a wet night. My name's Joanna Pike, and I'm the community projects officer at Ashworth District Council. I'm here to tell you about our new allotment scheme at Mill Lane, which opens to plot holders in March.

Joanna: *[conversational]* For those of you who don't know it, the site used to be a commercial plant nursery. It closed about six years ago, and it's been empty ever since. *[light laugh]* Well, empty apart from a lot of brambles.

Joanna: *[measured]* Now, quite a few of you have asked why we went for Mill Lane rather than the field behind the leisure centre, so let me deal with that first. I know some people were hoping the new site would be easy to get to by bus, and I have to be honest, it isn't ideal from that point of view. The nearest stop is a good fifteen minutes' walk away.

Joanna: *[slightly amused, correcting a misconception]* There's also a rumour going round that the land was given to the council free of charge. That's not quite right, I'm afraid. We lease it from the Haddon Estate, although, admittedly, the rent is very modest.

Joanna: *[emphatic, clear]* What actually decided it was, first of all, the ground itself. When we had samples analysed, the soil came back as being of exceptionally high quality, which I suppose is the result of decades of the nursery digging in compost. *[short pause]* And the second thing, which saved us a great deal of money, is that because it was a nursery, there's already a mains water connection on site. So we haven't had to pay to bring a supply in from the road.

Joanna: *[candid]* One thing Mill Lane is not, though, is sheltered. The northern edge is very exposed, and the winds there can be fierce, so we'll be planting a native hedge along that side over the winter.

Joanna: *[practical, moving on]* Right, the money. A full plot will cost sixty pounds a year, and a half plot thirty-five. So what do you get for that? Well, people often assume that water is included. It isn't, I'm afraid. Each row of plots has its own meter, and the cost is divided between the plot holders in that row, so it's charged separately.

Joanna: *[upbeat]* What the fee does cover is unlimited use of everything in the communal tool store: spades, forks, wheelbarrows, even a rotavator. *[short pause]* And every autumn, the council will

drop off a load of well-rotted manure at every plot, which, if you've ever tried to buy the stuff, you'll know is well worth having.

Joanna: *[apologetic]* In our pilot scheme at Brook Street, we also gave out free packets of seeds to new tenants, but sadly the budget won't stretch to that this time round. *[encouraging]* And there's a gardeners' association, which I'd really urge you to join. But that's run by the volunteers themselves and it has its own small subscription, so it isn't part of what you pay us.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 15 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 15 to 20. [post: 2 s pause]*

Joanna: *[clear, signposting]* Now, you should all have a copy of the site plan, so let me take you round the different areas, because each one has its own arrangements.

Joanna: *[firm but friendly]* Starting at the main gate on Mill Lane itself. You don't need to book a time to visit; you can come whenever you like between dawn and dusk. At Brook Street, people got into the habit of leaving the gate open during the day while they were working, and we had several thefts. So at Mill Lane, it has to be kept locked at all times, even when you're on site. You'll each be given the code.

Joanna: *[warm]* Just inside the gate is the orchard: twelve apple and plum trees that the nursery left behind. We did consider allocating the trees to individual plot holders, but we decided against it. When the fruit's ripe, anyone who has a plot is welcome to help themselves. *[light laugh]* Within reason, please. The volunteers prune the trees on Saturday mornings, but that doesn't mean you can only go in at weekends; it's open every day.

Joanna: *[thoughtful]* In the middle of the site there's a wildlife pond. You might expect us to have banned strimmers and mowers around it, to protect the frogs and newts, but in fact our ecologist says occasional cutting is perfectly fine. What we do insist on is that young children never go near the water on their own. If you bring your kids, an adult must be with them there at all times.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Joanna: *[clear, informative]* Next to the car park, you'll see eight raised beds, built at waist height. These aren't for general use. They're set aside for gardeners who use a wheelchair, or who find kneeling and bending difficult. There's a set of long-handled tools stored right beside them, too, so nobody has to carry heavy equipment across the site.

Joanna: *[brisk]* Beyond those is the polytunnel, which is for raising seedlings in spring. It's unlocked all week, but space on the benches is limited, so you can't just turn up with your trays. You'll need to reserve a bench in advance through the online system.

Joanna: *[explaining]* And finally, at the far end, by the back gate, are the compost bays. A volunteer has to be there to check what goes in, otherwise we end up with plastic and goodness knows what else, so they're only open on Saturdays and Sundays.

Joanna: *[serious, slowing down]* And while we're down at that end: some of you will remember the bonfires at Brook Street. Please be aware that they're not permitted anywhere at Mill Lane, and that includes the compost area. The houses are just too close.

Joanna: *[wrapping up, warm]* Application forms are on the table by the door. There's an open day on the first Saturday in February if you'd like to look round before you sign up. Right, I think I've talked for long enough. Are there any questions?

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-12

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

11-12 Which TWO reasons does the speaker give for choosing the Mill Lane site?

- A** It can easily be reached by public transport.
- B** The ground is very fertile.
- C** There is an existing water supply.
- D** The council obtained the land at no cost.
- E** It is well protected from the wind.

Questions 13-14

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

13-14 Which TWO things are included in the annual plot fee?

- A** the cost of the water used
- B** access to shared equipment
- C** a yearly supply of fertiliser
- D** seeds for new plot holders
- E** membership of a gardening club

Questions 15-20

What does the speaker say about each of the following areas of the site? Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 15-20.

A	can only be used at weekends
B	intended for people with limited mobility
C	children must be accompanied
D	must be reserved beforehand
E	fires are allowed
F	power tools are not permitted
G	produce may be taken by any plot holder
H	must never be left open

15 main gate

16 orchard

17 wildlife pond

18 raised beds

19 polytunnel

20 compost bays

A Sleep and Memory Experiment

Academic discussion between two students (2 speakers) · American (en-US) and British (en-GB)

Scenario: Two psychology students review the procedure and results of an experiment they ran on the effect of sleep on memory, and plan their report and presentation.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.45 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	American (en-US) and British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Maya	Psychology student — female, early 20s, relaxed, direct, quick to challenge; American accent (General American)
Voice: Josh	Psychology student — male, early 20s, thoughtful, slightly anxious, open to persuasion; British accent (southern English)
Script length	6,103 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear two psychology students, Maya and Josh, discussing an experiment they carried out on sleep and memory. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 24. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 21 to 24. *[post: 2 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Josh: *[quiet study room] [friendly, a little rushed]* Right, Maya, shall we go through the procedure section first? Dr Hollis said it has to be clear enough for someone else to repeat the study exactly.

Maya: *[easygoing]* Sure. So, recruitment. We were originally going to put posters up all over campus, remember?

Josh: *[dry]* And we got precisely three volunteers out of that.

Maya: *[laughs]* Right. And the emails to the first-year class lists didn't do much better. It was really the item in the department's newsletter that got us most of our people. Something like thirty of the forty came through that.

Josh: *[thoughtful]* Yeah, and I think we should be upfront about it, because it might affect who took part. People who actually read the newsletter are probably more motivated than average.

Maya: *[agreeing]* Good point. Okay, then the learning session. Everyone studied the same sixty pairs of unrelated words. Where do we say that happened? Because it changed, didn't it?

Josh: *[recalling]* It did. We'd booked the lab, but then the postgrads needed it for their own testing. And you suggested letting people learn the words in their own rooms...

Maya: *[wincing slightly]* Which would've been a disaster. No control over noise or anything. So in the end we used that quiet room in the library, the one on the second floor.

Josh: *[noting it]* Yes. Okay. And then the sleep group went home to bed, and we measured their sleep. *[hesitant]* I still wish we'd been able to borrow the EEG headset from the sleep lab.

Maya: *[pragmatic]* Josh, we weren't trained to use it, and it would've cost a fortune. The wristband was fine. Everyone in the sleep group wore one overnight, and it gave us total sleep time.

Josh: *[unconvinced]* And the sleep diaries?

Maya: *[firm]* We asked them to fill one in, sure, but half of them didn't bother, so they really weren't our main measure. I'd mention them in a footnote at most.

Josh: *[accepting]* Fair enough. Then, twelve hours after learning, everyone came back. And before the actual memory test, we did the alertness check.

Maya: *[clarifying]* Which ended up being just the questionnaire. We'd planned a reaction-time task as well, but it took fifteen minutes per person and we didn't have the time. So it was the questionnaire on its own, rating how awake they felt. And then the recall test.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 25 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 25 to 30. [post: 2 s pause]*

Josh: *[more animated]* Okay, results. So the sleep group did better, as we predicted. But honestly, what I didn't see coming was how big the gap was.

Maya: *[sceptical]* Really? The studies we read found roughly a twenty percent advantage for sleep, and ours was eighteen. That's pretty standard. *[short pause]* No, what got me was where the advantage came from. Nearly all of it was on the pairs that people had rated as the hardest to learn. On the easy ones, the two groups were almost level.

Josh: *[conceding]* Hmm. Yeah, when you put it like that, the overall difference is in line with the literature. It's the hard-pair thing that's odd. *[short pause]* And the wake group did about as badly as we expected, so there's nothing strange there.

Maya: *[thinking aloud]* Speaking of the wake group, I was worried that some of them might have had a nap during the day, which would mess everything up.

Josh: *[doubtful]* I don't think napping was the problem. We asked every one of them, and nobody said they'd slept. And they were all tested within ten minutes of the right time, so the timing's fine too. What does bother me is the two who said they'd gone over the words in their heads on the bus.

Maya: *[groaning]* Oh, yeah. They were actually practising them on purpose. That's a real issue. We should have told everyone not to do that.

Josh: *[agreeing]* Definitely. We'll mention it.

Maya: *[half joking]* In the limitations section, or as some kind of confession?

Josh: *[laughs]* Limitations. Hollis appreciates honesty, as long as it's in the right place.

Maya: *[shifting to a more critical tone]* Now, limitations. I think the obvious criticism Hollis will make is the sample size. Forty people isn't many.

Josh: *[measured]* Everyone says that, but forty's not unusual for this kind of study. What worries me far more is that the sleep group learned the words in the evening and the wake group learned them in the morning. So time of day is mixed up with sleep. We can't separate the two.

Maya: *[adding]* And they were all undergraduates, aged eighteen to twenty-two.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Josh: *[dismissive but polite]* That's a limitation, sure, but it's not specific to us. Most memory research uses students. It's the timing that's our own fault.

Maya: *[firm, reasoning it through]* Okay, but I don't think the timing thing makes the whole study worthless. Far from it. And we couldn't have tested everybody in the evening; the whole design needs a night's sleep for one group and a day awake for the other. *[short pause]* But look, the questionnaire showed both groups felt equally alert when they were tested. We can use that to argue the time of day probably didn't make much difference.

Josh: *[slowly persuaded]* That's true. It doesn't solve it completely, but it helps. Okay. *[short pause]* What about participant seventeen? Fifty-nine out of sixty. My instinct is just to take them out.

Maya: *[shocked]* Josh! We can't just delete data because it's inconvenient. Hollis would go through the roof.

Josh: *[tentative]* Well, could we email them and ask whether they'd seen the list before?

Maya: *[patient]* We promised everyone anonymity. We don't even have their names linked to the numbers.

Josh: *[sighs]* Fair point. So we leave them in and flag it up when we discuss the results.

Maya: *[decisive]* Exactly. *[changing topic]* And then the presentation. I thought we'd spend most of it on the wristbands, since no other group measured sleep that way.

Josh: *[gently disagreeing]* Hmm, it's only ten minutes, though, and the method's the least exciting part. I'd rather build it around the hard-pair result. That's what people will actually remember.

Maya: *[conceding, good-humoured]* Yeah, okay, you've convinced me. And ideas for future studies?

Josh: *[practical]* Just one slide, right at the end. Nothing more.

Maya: *[wrapping up, businesslike]* Great. So I'll draft the procedure tonight, you take the results, and we swap on Thursday and check each other's sections?

Josh: *[relieved]* Deal. And we can put all the wristband details in an appendix, so that work still gets some credit.

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-24

Complete the flow chart below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

PROCEDURE

- 21** Most of the 40 participants were recruited through a (21) _____
- 22** ↓ All participants studied 60 word pairs in a quiet room in the (22) _____
- 23** ↓ The sleep group's sleep was measured by a (23) _____ worn overnight
- 24** ↓ 12 hours later, alertness was assessed with a (24) _____ only, before the recall test

Questions 25-30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 25** What do the students agree was unexpected about their results?
- A** the overall size of the sleep group's advantage
 - B** how poorly the wake group performed
 - C** the type of items on which sleep made a difference
- 26** Which problem with the wake group do they both regard as serious?
- A** Some participants slept during the day.
 - B** Some participants deliberately rehearsed the material.
 - C** Some participants were tested at the wrong time.
- 27** What does Josh consider the main weakness of the study?
- A** the number of people who took part
 - B** the times at which the groups learned the words
 - C** the narrow age range of the participants
- 28** What is Maya's view of the time-of-day problem?
- A** Some of the data they collected can be used to reduce its importance.
 - B** It makes the findings of the study meaningless.
 - C** It could have been avoided by testing everyone at the same time of day.
- 29** What do they decide to do about participant seventeen?
- A** exclude the scores from the analysis
 - B** keep the scores and comment on them
 - C** ask the participant for more information
- 30** What will be the main focus of their presentation?
- A** the way sleep was measured
 - B** the finding about difficult word pairs
 - C** possible directions for further research

Bioluminescence in Deep-Sea Animals

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · Australian (en-AU)

Scenario: A marine biology lecturer explains how deep-sea animals produce light, the different functions this light serves, and some applications of the research.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	Australian (en-AU)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	Marine biology lecturer — male, 50s, enthusiastic, articulate, dry sense of humour; Australian accent (educated, moderate)
Script length	5,897 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about bioluminescence in deep-sea animals.

First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. [post: 45 s pause]

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 31 to 40. [post: 2 s pause]

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: [lecture theatre, faint murmur fading] [warm, clear] Morning, everyone. Today we're heading down into the deep ocean, below about two hundred metres, where sunlight barely reaches, to look at bioluminescence: the production of light by living organisms. [wry] It's not a rare curiosity, by the way. Down there, it's thought that roughly three-quarters of all animals can make their own light.

Lecturer: [measured, explaining carefully] So, how is it done? In most cases the light comes from a chemical reaction. A light-emitting compound, known generally as a luciferin, reacts with oxygen, and that reaction is speeded up by an enzyme called luciferase. [short pause] In some jellyfish, the reaction is set off by calcium, and students often write that calcium is what the luciferin combines with. It isn't. Calcium is only the trigger.

Lecturer: [enthusiastic] What's remarkable is how efficient this is. An old-fashioned light bulb loses most of its energy as heat. Bioluminescence loses almost none that way, which is why it's often described as cold light. For an animal that may go weeks between meals, that efficiency really matters.

Lecturer: [informative] Then there's colour. In shallow coastal waters, you'll find quite a lot of green light, and a handful of species produce yellow. But in the deep ocean, the light is overwhelmingly blue, and that's because blue wavelengths travel the furthest through seawater. Most deep-sea animals, in fact, can't even see other colours.

Lecturer: [curious, engaging] And how do animals switch the light on and off? Well, that varies. Many species control it directly through their nervous system, so a flash can last a fraction of a second. Others, which have glowing tissue that's permanently lit, cover it with folds of skin, rather like shutters, or rotate the light organ inwards. Either way, the light is under the animal's control, and that's important for everything I'm going to describe.

Lecturer: [clarifying] I should add that not every glowing animal makes its own chemicals. Some appear to get their luciferin from their diet, from the food they eat. And others, the anglerfish being the classic example, don't produce the light themselves at all. Instead, they house bacteria inside specialised organs, and it's those that glow. The fish supplies nutrients; the bacteria supply light. A neat arrangement.

Lecturer: *[signposting]* Right. So that's the how. Now for the more interesting question: why? Why would an animal spend energy, however little, on making light, when doing so might also reveal it to something hungry? Biologists generally group the functions into three: hiding, defending and hunting. Plus one more I'll come to at the end.

Lecturer: *[explaining, slowing down]* Let's start with hiding. In the upper part of the deep sea, there's still a faint glow coming from the surface. Now, to a predator looking up from below, it isn't an animal's colour, or even its size, that gives it away. It's its silhouette, that dark outline against the dim light above. So many fish and squid have light organs along their bellies, and they adjust the brightness to match the light from above. The outline simply disappears. This is called counter-illumination.

Lecturer: *[lively]* Defence next. In shallow water, a squid that's under attack squirts out ink. But think about it: in complete darkness, a cloud of black ink is pretty useless. So some deep-sea squid, and certain shrimps too, release a glowing mucus instead. The predator is left lunging at a bright, sticky cloud while its prey slips away into the dark.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* And then there's a rather clever strategy that's been nicknamed the burglar alarm. Some jellyfish, when they're grabbed, produce a spinning display of flashing light. You'd assume the aim is to frighten the attacker. Well, it's not so much about scaring it off as attracting attention. The flashes can be seen a long way off, and they bring in a larger predator, which may well go after whatever's attacking the jellyfish.

Lecturer: *[animated]* Now, hunting. The anglerfish I mentioned dangles its glowing lure in front of its mouth, and curious prey swim straight towards it. But my favourite example is the dragonfish. *[short pause]* Remember I said most deep-sea animals only see blue? Well, the dragonfish has organs under its eyes that give out red light. Its prey can't detect it, so the dragonfish is effectively using a private searchlight.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[measured]* And the fourth function: communication. Lanternfish have rows of light organs called photophores, and the pattern differs from one species to another. For a long time, people assumed these patterns mainly helped the fish to stay together in shoals. More recent work, though, suggests that their real purpose is to help individuals recognise potential mates of their own species in the dark.

Lecturer: *[candid]* I should say that studying all this is extremely difficult. Many of these animals are fragile, and when they're hauled up in nets from several kilometres down, they rarely survive the journey, and their light organs are often damaged. What's more, the moment you shine a torch at them to take a photograph, you swamp their own light completely. *[short pause]* So a lot of what we now know comes from cameras on remotely operated vehicles, which can sit quietly in the dark for hours and record extremely faint flashes.

Lecturer: *[upbeat, wrapping up]* Finally, a word on why this research matters outside marine biology. The genes for luciferase have been put to use well beyond the sea. One early application was in tests to detect bacteria in food, and that still goes on. But by far their most important use today is in medical research, especially on cancer. Scientists insert the gene into cancer cells, so that they can watch, in a living animal, how tumours grow and spread. So, from the bottom of the ocean to the hospital, which is quite a journey.

Lecturer: *[brisk]* Right, next week, we'll look at sound in the deep sea. Please read chapter seven before then.

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

BIOLUMINESCENCE IN DEEP-SEA ANIMALS

- 31** How light is produced: a luciferin combines with (31) _____; the enzyme luciferase accelerates this
- 32** Called 'cold light' because hardly any energy is wasted as (32) _____
- 33** Colour: mostly (33) _____, which travels furthest in seawater
- 34** Some species (e.g. anglerfish) depend on (34) _____ kept in special organs to produce light
- 35** Hiding (counter-illumination): lights on the underside hide the animal's (35) _____ from predators below
- 36** Defence: some squid and shrimps release a luminous (36) _____ to distract predators
- 37** 'Burglar alarm': a jellyfish's flashes draw in a bigger (37) _____ that may attack its attacker
- 38** Hunting: dragonfish emit (38) _____ light that their prey cannot see
- 39** Communication: lanternfish light patterns now thought to help them identify (39) _____
- 40** Medical use: luciferase genes allow scientists to observe how (40) _____ develop

FT04 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Prothero / PROTHERO	The clerk reads the name back with a final E, which the caller rejects.
2	8th / 8 / eighth / the 8th / Thursday 8th	She first gives Wednesday the seventh, the day of her outward journey.
3	6.45 / 6:45 / 18.45 / 18:45 / 6.45 pm / six forty-five	She was booked on the 6.15 but missed it.
4	quiet / quiet coach	First class is mentioned but she says she wasn't in it.
5	luggage rack / rack	The clerk suggests under the seat, which she rules out.
6	holdall / a holdall	'Gym bag' (her son's name for it) and suitcase/rucksack are mentioned but rejected.
7	navy blue / navy	Black is what the station staff wrote down, but she says it isn't black.
8	lighthouse	Her husband thinks it resembles a rocket; the name tag no longer exists.
9	camera / a camera / her camera	The laptop and purse are mentioned but were not in the bag.
10	12 / £12 / twelve	The old charge was £10, and postage would add about £15.
11-12	B + C (any order)	Bus access (A) is admitted to be poor, the free-land idea (D) is called a rumour (the land is leased), and the site is described as exposed, not sheltered (E).
13-14	B + C (any order)	Water (A) is charged separately, free seeds (D) were only given in the pilot scheme, and the association (E) has its own subscription.
15	H (must never be left open)	Booking (D) is mentioned and rejected; the gate used to be left open at Brook Street.
16	G (produce may be taken by any plot holder)	Saturday pruning suggests weekends (A), but the speaker says it is open every day.
17	C (children must be accompanied)	A ban on strimmers and mowers (F) is expected but denied.
18	B (intended for people with limited mobility)	The raised beds are next to the car park and have their own tools, which may suggest other options, but only B matches the stated restriction.
19	D (must be reserved beforehand)	It is described as unlocked all week, which may tempt A or H.
20	A (can only be used at weekends)	Bonfires (E) are mentioned in connection with this area but are not permitted.
21	newsletter	Posters and class-list emails were tried but produced few volunteers.
22	library	The lab was booked but became unavailable, and participants' own rooms were suggested and rejected.
23	wristband / wrist band	An EEG headset was wanted but not used, and sleep diaries were not the main measure.
24	questionnaire	A reaction-time task was planned but dropped.
25	C (the type of items on which sleep made a difference)	Josh first says the size of the gap surprised him (A) but concedes it matches the literature; the wake group did as expected (B).
26	B (Some participants deliberately rehearsed the material.)	Maya worries about naps (A) but nobody reported sleeping; testing times (C) were within ten minutes.
27	B (the times at which the groups learned the words)	Maya raises sample size (A) and age (C), but Josh dismisses both as less important.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
28	A (Some of the data they collected can be used to reduce its importance.)	She explicitly rejects B ('far from it') and explains why C was impossible.
29	B (keep the scores and comment on them)	Josh first wants to remove the data (A) and then to email the participant (C); Maya rules out both.
30	B (the finding about difficult word pairs)	Maya proposes focusing on the wristbands (A) but changes her mind; future research (C) gets only one slide at the end.
31	oxygen	Calcium is mentioned as what students wrongly think luciferin combines with; it is only the trigger.
32	heat	Listeners must link 'none that way' back to heat; the light bulb comparison invites confusion.
33	blue	Green and yellow are mentioned for shallow coastal waters.
34	bacteria	Obtaining luciferin from the diet is a different method mentioned just before.
35	silhouette	Colour and size are mentioned and explicitly rejected.
36	mucus	Ink is what shallow-water squid use and is described as useless in the dark.
37	predator	Frightening the attacker is suggested and rejected ('not so much about scaring it off').
38	red	Blue, the usual colour, is recalled in the sentence just before.
39	mates	Staying together in shoals was the earlier, now doubted explanation.
40	tumours / tumors	Detecting bacteria in food is an earlier, less important use.

Listening Full Test 5

FT05 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	A Home Contents Insurance Quote	British (en-GB)
2	Arriving in Kelmouth	British (en-GB)
3	Case Study: A Failed Product Launch	Tutor British (en-GB); Leah Canadian (en-CA); Owen British (en-GB)
4	The Printing Press and the Spread of Literacy	British (en-GB)

A Home Contents Insurance Quote

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A man who has just moved home phones an insurance company to get a quote for home contents insurance.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Priya	Insurance adviser — female, late 20s, bright, efficient and polite; British accent (southern English)
Voice: Daniel	Caller — male, late 30s, friendly, slightly hurried, good-humoured; British accent (northern English)
Script length	5,644 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a man phoning an insurance company to get a quote for home contents insurance. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 6. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Priya: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [bright, professional]* Good afternoon, Hartwell Home Insurance, you're speaking to Priya. How can I help?

Daniel: *[friendly, a little hurried]* Oh, hello. I'm after a quote for contents insurance. I've just moved into a new place, and my old policy doesn't transfer, apparently. *[light laugh]* Which nobody told me.

Priya: *[warm]* That happens a lot, don't worry. I can do a quote for you now, it'll only take ten minutes or so. Could I start with your name?

Daniel: Yes, it's Daniel Fairleigh.

Priya: *[typing, careful]* Daniel... and the surname, is that F... A... I... R... L... E... Y?

Daniel: *[patient chuckle, used to this]* Everyone does that. No, it's F... A... I... R... L... E... I... G... H.

Priya: *[repeating slowly as she types]* L... E... I... G... H. Sorry about that. And the address of the property you'd like insured?

Daniel: *[clearly]* Twenty-two Meadowcroft Road, in Selby.

Priya: *[friendly]* And when did you move in?

Daniel: *[laughs]* Only last Saturday. There are still boxes absolutely everywhere.

Priya: *[efficient]* Thank you. And what type of property is it? A house, a flat...?

Daniel: *[thinking aloud]* Well, the estate agent advertised it as a flat, but it isn't really, because it's on two floors and it's got its own front door. *[decisive]* It's a maisonette.

Priya: *[typing]* A maisonette, fine. We actually treat those the same as houses. *[short pause]* And could I ask your occupation? It does make a small difference to the price.

Daniel: *[amused]* Does it? Well, I was a teacher for years, chemistry, but I retrained a while back, so I'm a pharmacist now.

Priya: *[pleasant]* Pharmacist, lovely. Now, the total value of your contents. That's basically everything you'd take with you if you moved: furniture, clothes, electrical goods, and so on.

Daniel: *[hesitant]* Er, I did try to work it out last night. I came to about thirty thousand pounds.

Priya: *[gently cautious]* Most people underestimate, I'm afraid. Did that include things like clothes, and all your kitchen equipment?

Daniel: *[sighs]* Ah... no, it didn't. *[short pause]* Let's say thirty-eight thousand, to be on the safe side.

Priya: *[approving]* Thirty-eight thousand. That's probably wiser. And is there any single item worth more than two thousand pounds? We'd need to list those separately.

Daniel: *[thinking]* Hmm. My bike cost a lot, but it was just under two thousand. I used to have quite a good watch, but I sold that last year. *[suddenly remembering]* Oh, the telescope! That was about two thousand four hundred.

Priya: *[typing]* A telescope. I'll put that down as a specified item. Last question in this section: have you made any claims on home insurance in the past five years?

Daniel: *[matter-of-fact]* Just one. About three years ago a pipe burst in the flat upstairs, and it came through my ceiling.

Priya: *[checking]* Ah. And was that recorded as flood damage, or...?

Daniel: *[firm]* No, the insurer was quite clear it wasn't a flood, because that's water coming in from outside. They put it down as water damage.

Priya: *[efficient]* Then that's what I'll put.

Daniel: *[slightly worried]* Will a claim like that push the price up much?

Priya: *[reassuring, honest]* A little, but not a great deal, as it wasn't your fault and it was more than two years ago.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 7 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Priya: *[brisk, explaining]* Right, so based on all that, I can offer you three levels of cover. The first is called Essential.

Daniel: *[wry]* The cheapest, I imagine.

Priya: *[light laugh]* That's right. For your property, Essential would be nine pounds eighty-five a month.

Daniel: *[surprised]* Oh. I'm sure I saw eight ninety-five on your website.

Priya: *[apologetic]* You may well have, that was the price until the end of last month. It went up on the first, I'm afraid, so it's nine eighty-five now. *[clearly]* Essential doesn't include accidental damage, and the excess, which is what you'd pay towards any claim yourself, is two hundred and fifty pounds.

Daniel: *[unimpressed]* Hmm. That's quite a lot.

Priya: *[neutral]* It is. Then there's Standard, at sixteen pounds forty a month. That does cover accidental damage, so if you spilt paint on the carpet, say, or dropped your laptop. And the excess comes down to a hundred.

Daniel: *[interested]* What about things I take out of the house? I carry my laptop to work and back every day.

Priya: Standard covers your belongings away from home as well. Some insurers limit that to a thousand pounds, but ours goes up to fifteen hundred pounds.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Daniel: *[thinking aloud]* Fifteen hundred. Well, the laptop's worth a lot less than that, so that'd be fine.

Priya: *[upbeat]* And finally there's Premium, which is twenty-three pounds ninety a month. That has everything in Standard, plus a couple of extras.

Daniel: Such as?

Priya: *[explaining]* Well, people often assume it includes medical cover, but that's really something for travel insurance. What Premium does give you is legal expenses. So if you ended up in a dispute with a builder, for instance, or a neighbour, we'd help with the solicitor's fees.

Daniel: *[dry chuckle]* Given my last neighbour, that's quite tempting.

Priya: *[laughs softly]* And the other extra is to do with keys. If your house keys are lost or stolen, we won't just pay for new keys, anyone can get those cut. We pay to have all the locks changed.

Daniel: *[approving]* That's sensible, actually. Whoever found them might know the address.

Priya: *[agreeing]* Exactly. Would you like me to email all three quotes so you can compare them properly?

Daniel: *[relieved]* Yes, please. I'm leaning towards Standard, to be honest, but I'd like to talk it over with my partner first. *[short pause]* Is the price fixed if I take a few days?

Priya: *[reassuring]* The quote's valid for thirty days, so there's no rush. And if you pay for the whole year in one go, rather than monthly, it works out about eight per cent cheaper.

Daniel: *[pleased]* Good to know. Thanks very much, Priya, you've been really helpful.

Priya: *[warm]* My pleasure. The email should be with you in the next few minutes. Goodbye!

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-6

Complete the form below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

HARTWELL HOME INSURANCE — CONTENTS QUOTE

- 1 Name: Daniel (1) _____
2 Property: 22 Meadowcroft Road, Selby — a (2) _____
3 Occupation: (3) _____
4 Estimated value of contents: £(4) _____
5 Item worth over £2,000, to be listed separately: (5) _____
6 Claim in last five years: (6) _____ damage

Questions 7-10

Complete the table below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Levels of cover

Level of cover	Cost per month	Accidental damage	Other details
Essential	£(7) _____	not included	excess of £250
Standard	£16.40	included	excess of £100; belongings outside the home covered up to £(8) _____
Premium	£23.90	included	covers (9) _____ expenses; if keys are lost, pays to replace all (10) _____

- 7 Essential — cost per month: £(7) _____
8 Standard — belongings outside the home covered up to £(8) _____
9 Premium — covers (9) _____ expenses
10 Premium — if keys are lost, pays to replace all (10) _____

Arriving in Kelmouth

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A coach-tour guide describes the seaside town of Kelmouth to her passengers as the coach arrives.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Guide	Coach-tour guide — female, 50s, cheerful, chatty and experienced, projecting over a microphone; British accent (south-west England)
Script length	5,481 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 2. You will hear a tour guide talking to a group of passengers on a coach as they arrive in a seaside town. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 16. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Guide: *[soft click of a coach microphone] [cheerful, projecting]* Right, everyone, welcome to Kelmouth! We've just pulled into the coach park, which, as you can see, is right at the western end of the seafront. Before you all rush off, let me give you a quick idea of where everything is. If you've got the little map I handed out this morning, have it ready.

Guide: *[clear, orienting]* On the map the sea is along the bottom, so north is at the top. The long road running east along the seafront is the Promenade, and about halfway along it you'll see the clock tower. That's the easiest place to get your bearings, because Church Street runs straight up the hill from the clock tower to the Market Square.

Guide: *[informative]* So, first of all, the tourist information centre. Those of you who came on this trip a few years ago might remember it up in the Market Square, next to the church. *[short pause]* Well, it isn't there any more. That building's the town library now.

Guide: *[pointing out the route]* The centre moved down to the seafront. Walk along the Promenade with the sea on your right. You'll pass the deckchair hire place on the beach side, and the tourist office is just after the clock tower, on your left, looking out over the sand.

Guide: *[enthusiastic]* Now, if you like art, you're in for a treat. Head up Church Street from the clock tower. There's a bank on the corner on your right, *[dry aside]* which is useful, because a few of the little shops here still won't take cards. But keep going, and about halfway up the hill, on the left, is the Harbour Light Gallery. It's tiny, but it's got some lovely paintings of the coast.

Guide: *[warm, recommending]* At the top of Church Street you come out into the Market Square. The church is straight ahead of you, on the far side, and the building to the right of it is the library I mentioned. For lunch, I'd really recommend The Lobster Pot. People expect it to be on the seafront, but it isn't. It's tucked away in the top left-hand corner of the square, so on the opposite side from the library.

Guide: *[informative]* Back down on the seafront, if you carry on east along the Promenade, you'll come to the harbour. Do visit the lifeboat museum there. *[short pause]* It used to be out at the very end of the jetty, in the old boathouse, but that was badly damaged in a storm, so now it's on the north side of the harbour, right beside the slipway, where the lifeboats were launched in the old days.

Guide: *[encouraging]* A lot of you were asking about the seal-watching trips. You buy your tickets on board, and the boats don't go from the slipway, because the water there is far too shallow at low tide. They leave from the far end of the jetty instead, so allow a few minutes to walk out there.

Guide: *[softer, almost confidential]* And finally, if you want the best view in Kelmouth, and it's my favourite spot, don't go to the harbour at all. Come back here to the coach park and take the steps at the western end, up onto the headland. At the top of the steps there's a little viewpoint with a bench. On a clear day you can see three lighthouses from there.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 17 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Guide: *[practical, friendly]* Now, people always ask me about the beach. It did get one of those national awards for clean beaches, but that was a good few years ago, and it lost it last year. Nothing serious, just a paperwork problem, I'm told.

Guide: *[matter-of-fact]* It's usually packed in the mornings, and it doesn't really empty out until about five, so don't expect much peace and quiet after lunch either. *[serious, slowing down]* What you do need to know is that when the tide's going out, there's a strong current near the rocks. The lifeguards put up red flags then, and nobody should go in the water until they come down.

Guide: *[storytelling, lively]* A little bit of history. Most visitors assume Kelmouth grew rich on fishing. And there were fishing boats, of course, but they only ever really fed the town itself. The money came from slate. It was dug out of the quarries a few miles inland and shipped all over the world from this harbour.

Guide: *[thoughtful]* The railway arrived in the eighteen-seventies and brought the first holidaymakers, but by then the big houses on the hill had already been built. So tourism came later; it wasn't what made the town wealthy.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Guide: *[enthusiastic, then frank]* Now, food. You can't leave Kelmouth without trying a saffron bun. Every café sells them, but, between you and me, the café ones mostly come from a factory up the road. Go to Pengelly's on Church Street instead. They're proper bakers, and they make their own.

Guide: *[light laugh]* People will tell you they have to be eaten warm, but honestly, they're just as good cold. And there's no need to rush over there first thing, either, because they bake all day long.

Guide: *[firmer, important]* Right, now the important bit, so please listen. We'd originally planned to leave at half past five, but the driver has to have the coach back at the depot earlier than we thought, so we'll be leaving at five o'clock sharp instead.

Guide: *[explaining]* We'll go from right here in the coach park, the same spot you're getting off. The driver did think about picking you up by the harbour, but there just isn't room for a coach to turn round there. *[wry]* And please don't try ringing me if you're running late. The phone signal on this bit of coast is hopeless, so I probably wouldn't get the call anyway.

Guide: *[cheerful, wrapping up]* So, five o'clock, here. Have a wonderful afternoon, and mind the seagulls if you're eating outside. *[laughs]* They're bigger than you'd think, and they're not shy!

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-16

Label the map below. Write the correct letter, A-I, next to Questions 11-16.

Kelmouth town centre and seafront

Plan (for the designer): Plan of Kelmouth, north at the top. The sea fills the bottom (south) edge, with a strip of beach along it. The Promenade runs west-east along the seafront just above the beach. The Coach Park is at the far west (left) end of the Promenade. A Clock Tower stands on the Promenade about halfway along. Church Street runs north from the Clock Tower up to Market Square at the top centre of the map; St Anne's Church stands on the north (far) side of Market Square, in the middle. The Harbour is at the far east (right) end of the Promenade; a Slipway runs down into the water on the north side of the harbour, and a long Jetty runs south out to sea from the southern side of the harbour. Steps lead up from the western edge of the Coach Park onto a Headland at the far left of the map. Lettered positions: B — on the beach (south) side of the Promenade, between the Coach Park and the Clock Tower. E — on the land (north) side of the Promenade, immediately east of the Clock Tower. F — on the east side of Church Street, on its bottom corner with the Promenade. C — on the west side of Church Street, halfway up. A — in the north-west corner of Market Square, west of the church. G — on the east side of Market Square, immediately to the right of the church. H — on the north side of the Harbour, beside the Slipway. D — at the far (southern) end of the Jetty. I — on the Headland at the top of the Steps, west of the Coach Park.

A	A
B	B
C	C
D	D
E	E
F	F
G	G
H	H
I	I

- 11** Tourist information centre
- 12** Art gallery
- 13** Recommended restaurant
- 14** Lifeboat museum
- 15** Departure point for boat trips
- 16** Viewpoint

Questions 17-20

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 17** What does the guide say about Kelmouth's beach?
 - A** Bathing is dangerous at certain stages of the tide.
 - B** It has been recognised for its cleanliness this year.
 - C** It becomes much quieter after midday.
- 18** According to the guide, the town's wealth originally came from
 - A** the fishing industry.
 - B** the export of a building material.
 - C** visitors brought by the railway.
- 19** What advice does the guide give about saffron buns?
 - A** Buy them from a shop that produces them on the premises.
 - B** Eat them while they are still hot.
 - C** Go early in the day before they sell out.
- 20** What are passengers told about the return journey?
 - A** The pick-up point has been moved.
 - B** The departure time is earlier than planned.

C Passengers who are delayed should phone her.

Case Study: A Failed Product Launch

Academic discussion (2 students + tutor) · Tutor British (en-GB); Leah Canadian (en-CA); Owen British (en-GB)

Scenario: Two business students, Leah and Owen, discuss with their tutor a case study about a cycle manufacturer's unsuccessful launch of an electric bike.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	Tutor British (en-GB); Leah Canadian (en-CA); Owen British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Dr Morgan	Business tutor — female, 50s, warm but probing, precise; British accent (RP)
Voice: Leah	Student — female, early 20s, thoughtful, articulate, quietly confident; Canadian accent
Voice: Owen	Student — male, early 20s, enthusiastic, quick to jump in, good at conceding; British accent (Midlands)
Script length	6,074 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 3. You will hear two business students, Leah and Owen, talking to their tutor about a case study of a product launch that failed. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 24.*
[post: 30 s pause]

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Dr Morgan: *[a door closes softly] [warm, brisk]* Come in, both of you, have a seat. So, you've been working on the Calder Cycles case. How are you getting on with it? The presentation's in three weeks, so let's use today to check your main arguments.

Owen: *[enthusiastic]* Really well, actually. It's much more interesting than the one we did last term.

Dr Morgan: *[pleased]* Good. Leah, what struck you first when you read it?

Leah: *[thoughtful]* Well, I expected the launch budget to be enormous, and it was, but for a national campaign that's pretty normal. And I knew Calder had done really well with their road bikes, which is presumably why they were so confident. *[emphatic]* What I genuinely didn't see coming was that the Glide was off the market after only eight months.

Dr Morgan: *[agreeing]* Mm. Most firms would give a new product at least two or three years to find its feet.

Owen: *[jumping in]* And that's partly what made us look at their market research.

Dr Morgan: Go on.

Owen: *[confident]* Well, some people in our seminar said it was out of date, but it wasn't, they did it the year before launch, which seems fine. And yes, it cost a fortune, but that's not really the point. *[slightly incredulous]* The problem was who they asked. They surveyed their existing customers, who are mostly serious club cyclists, and they're exactly the people who'd never dream of buying an electric bike.

Leah: *[dry]* Right. They basically asked the wrong crowd.

Dr Morgan: *[measured]* I'd agree with that. What about the price? That's what students usually blame first.

Leah: *[hesitant]* We did wonder about that. Should they have launched it cheaper?

Dr Morgan: *[considered]* Well, let's be accurate. It wasn't priced in line with its rivals; it was about four hundred pounds more than the nearest competitor. So I wouldn't call it a bargain. But would a lower launch price have saved it? I doubt it. In the one month they discounted it heavily, sales hardly moved. *[firm]* So, in my view, it isn't the price that sank it.

Owen: *[conceding]* Fair enough.

Dr Morgan: And the timing of the launch?

Owen: *[slightly sheepish]* I was going to say autumn was the wrong season to launch a bike. Nobody buys one in October.

Leah: *[gently disagreeing]* But the case gives figures for that, Owen. E-bike sales don't really drop in the autumn, because people buy them for commuting, not for fun.

Owen: *[reluctant]* Hmm, okay, true. And the launch had already been put back from June, but a few months' delay isn't unusual, is it?

Leah: *[decisive]* No. What really hurt them was that Voltra brought out its cheaper model just three weeks before.

Owen: *[agreeing]* Yeah, that's what did the damage. I think we're both agreed on that.

Dr Morgan: *[approving]* I'd go along with that. And Calder knew Voltra's model was coming, too; it had been in the trade press for months. They just assumed their brand name would carry them.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 25 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Dr Morgan: *[moving things along]* Right, now your problem analysis. The case lists six main problems. Let's go through what you think caused each one. Start with the late deliveries to the shops.

Owen: *[thinking aloud]* Well, my first thought was that the production schedule was just unrealistic.

Dr Morgan: *[doubtful]* Was it, though? Have a look at the factory figures in the appendix.

Leah: *[realising]* Oh. They actually hit every production target, so the bikes were ready on time. It's just that nobody told the warehouse the launch date had changed, so no transport had been booked. *[short pause]* So really, sales and logistics simply weren't talking to each other.

Owen: *[nodding along]* Fair enough.

Dr Morgan: Next, the complaints about the battery.

Owen: *[confident]* Now this one I'm sure was the supplier. They switched to a different battery maker about six months before launch.

Leah: *[politely disagreeing]* I thought that too at first, but the case says the new batteries actually did better in lab tests than the old ones. The issue was that every trial ride took place in summer. Nobody had ridden one in cold, wet weather, and that's when the range just collapsed.

Dr Morgan: *[wry]* Which, in Britain, is rather a large oversight.

Owen: *[conceding]* Yeah, okay. So they hadn't tried it out properly on actual roads in all seasons.

Dr Morgan: And the online reviews?

Leah: *[dry, wincing]* Those were brutal.

Owen: *[explaining]* You'd expect them to be about the battery again, but most of them weren't, actually. The ads said you could go a hundred kilometres on one charge, and the reviewers were getting about sixty.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Leah: So people felt the marketing had promised far more than the bike could deliver.

Owen: *[wry]* And reviewers don't forgive that. Once a few of those went up, the star rating never recovered.

Dr Morgan: *[probing]* What about the poor sales through independent bike shops?

Owen: *[tentative]* Was it because Calder was pushing people to buy direct from their website, so the shops resented it?

Leah: *[firm]* No, they only started selling online after the shops had given up on it. When customers were interviewed, the main complaint was that shop assistants couldn't answer basic questions,

about charging, the motor, anything. Calder never ran a single session to show them the product.

Dr Morgan: *[approving]* Quite right. And independent shops were supposed to bring in forty per cent of sales, so that really mattered. *[short pause]* Then there's the high rate of returns.

Leah: That was mostly faulty brakes, wasn't it?

Owen: *[explaining]* Right, and that goes back to the factory after all. The board insisted on launching in time for the big trade show, so the assembly line had half the usual time to build the first batch. Things got rushed, and the brakes weren't fitted properly.

Dr Morgan: *[thoughtful]* So the factory did meet the target, but at a price.

Owen: *[emphatic]* Exactly. The date they'd been given was never achievable in the first place.

Dr Morgan: And finally, the launch going over budget.

Owen: *[hesitant]* I assumed the new battery supplier had charged more.

Leah: *[correcting him]* They were cheaper, actually, that was half the reason Calder switched. The overspend was mostly because the motors came from Japan and were priced in yen, and the pound fell sharply that spring, so every motor cost them about fifteen per cent more than they'd budgeted for.

Dr Morgan: *[pleased]* Exactly. Something completely outside their control, which is worth stressing in your presentation. *[brisk]* Right, good work, both of you. Let's meet again next Thursday.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-24

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 21** What did Leah find most surprising about the case?
- A** the amount spent on launching the product
 - B** the company's previous record of success
 - C** how soon the product was withdrawn
- 22** What is Owen's view of Calder's market research?
- A** It focused on an unsuitable group of people.
 - B** It was carried out too long before the launch.
 - C** It cost more than it should have.
- 23** What does the tutor say about the price of the bike?
- A** It was similar to that of competing models.
 - B** It should have been reduced at launch.
 - C** It was not the main reason the bike failed.
- 24** What do the students agree was the problem with the timing of the launch?
- A** It came too soon after a rival product.
 - B** It took place in an unfavourable season.
 - C** It had been postponed for too long.

Questions 25-30

What do the students decide was the main cause of each problem? Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 25-30.

Causes

A	a change of component supplier
B	a lack of staff training
C	an unrealistic deadline
D	exaggerated advertising claims
E	inadequate testing in real-life conditions
F	poor communication between departments
G	a change in exchange rates
H	a decision to focus on online sales

- 25** late deliveries to shops
- 26** complaints about the battery
- 27** negative online reviews
- 28** poor sales in independent shops
- 29** a high rate of returns
- 30** the launch going over budget

The Printing Press and the Spread of Literacy

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A history lecturer gives a talk on the invention of the printing press and how reading spread in early modern Europe.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	History lecturer — male, 50s, engaging, articulate, slightly wry; British accent (RP)
Script length	6,097 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about the printing press and the spread of literacy in early modern Europe. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. [post: 45 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture hall, a faint murmur fading] [engaging, clear]* Good morning. Today we're looking at one of the most celebrated inventions in European history, the printing press, and at a question that's much harder to answer than it looks: did printing actually make people literate?

Lecturer: *[measured]* Let's start with what came before. There's a popular image of books being copied by monks in candlelit monasteries. And that image used to be accurate, say, in the eleventh century. *[short pause]* But by the fifteenth century, most copying had moved out of the monasteries altogether. It was done in commercial workshops, and these were clustered around the universities, because that's where the demand for texts was.

Lecturer: *[brisk]* So there was already a book trade. What Johannes Gutenberg did, in Mainz, around fourteen-fifty, was make it dramatically faster. But it's worth being precise about what he invented, because it wasn't the press. Presses had been used for centuries to squeeze grapes for wine and olives for oil, and he simply adapted one.

Lecturer: *[explaining carefully]* Nor was movable type entirely new: it had been used in Korea and China long before. His real breakthrough was the hand mould. This was a small, adjustable device that allowed a worker to cast thousands of identical metal letters very quickly, all exactly the same height, so they could be locked together into a page.

Lecturer: *[emphatic, slowing down]* The effect on speed was staggering. A skilled scribe might need several months to copy a single book. In the same time, a small print shop with three or four workers could produce several hundred copies, and every one of them would be identical, errors included.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* He also had to solve a problem with ink. The water-based inks that scribes had always used simply ran off metal type. So he turned instead to an oil-based ink, much closer to the varnishes that painters were using at the time. *[light, aside]* The Flemish painters had been experimenting with oils for a generation, so the knowledge was there.

Lecturer: *[wry]* Now, you might assume the Bible was the bread and butter of the early printers. It wasn't. The famous Gutenberg Bible was a prestige project, and it very nearly bankrupted him. *[emphatic]* The steady money came from indulgences. These were single printed sheets, certificates sold by the Church that promised forgiveness of sins, and printers turned them out by the tens of thousands.

Lecturer: *[informative]* Printing spread remarkably fast. By fifteen hundred there were presses in more than two hundred and fifty towns. But it didn't spread evenly. Printers needed customers, so they followed the money, along the main trade routes, and above all to cities that held the great annual fairs, like Frankfurt and Lyon, where they could sell their stock to dealers from all over Europe.

Lecturer: *[slightly amused]* Interestingly, university towns weren't nearly as attractive to printers as you'd expect. Their demand was steady, but it was small.

Lecturer: *[informative]* Venice is the classic example. It had no great university to speak of, but it was the commercial capital of the Mediterranean, and by fifteen hundred it had more printers than any other city in Europe.

Lecturer: *[building, more animated]* The real test of printing's power came in fifteen-seventeen, with Martin Luther. His arguments against the Church spread faster than anything had spread before, and one reason is the language he chose. Scholarly debate was conducted in Latin, but Luther wrote his pamphlets in the vernacular. *[clarifying]* That's the ordinary language people actually spoke at home, in his case German.

Lecturer: *[measured]* And these pamphlets were short, cheap and often illustrated, so even people who couldn't read could have them read aloud to them. Which brings us to literacy itself.

Lecturer: *[posing a problem]* How do historians actually measure literacy in a period with no censuses and no exams? School records barely survive, so they can't be used. Instead, historians count signatures, mostly in marriage registers, where the bride and groom either wrote their names or simply made a mark.

Lecturer: *[cautionary]* But there's a serious flaw in this method. In this period, reading was taught first, and writing only later, if at all. Plenty of people could read perfectly well but never learned to write. So signature counts almost certainly underestimate how many people could read.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[measured]* Even so, the trend is clear. In England, perhaps one man in ten could sign his name around fifteen hundred. By seventeen hundred it was closer to one in two, though the figure was much higher in towns than in the countryside.

Lecturer: *[emphatic]* This is especially true for women. Girls were rarely kept at school for long. Most learned to read at home, and generally not from a priest or a private tutor, as is sometimes claimed, but from their mothers. So female reading ability is almost invisible in the records.

Lecturer: *[conversational]* So what did ordinary people read? Not the classics, I'm afraid. In many households the most widely owned printed book wasn't even the Bible. It was the almanac, a cheap booklet bought every year, with a calendar, the dates of markets, weather predictions and advice on farming.

Lecturer: *[light laugh]* Its predictions were often wildly wrong, of course, but people kept buying it, and for many families it was the first thing they ever learned to read.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* Ballads and chapbooks, which were little paper-covered storybooks, were enormously popular too, but they tended to be passed around and read until they fell apart, rather than kept on a shelf.

Lecturer: *[concluding, reflective]* Finally, the long-term effect on language itself. Printing is often credited with fixing English grammar. In fact, grammar changed rather little because of it. What printers did gradually standardise was spelling. A printer selling books across a whole country needed consistent forms, and over a couple of centuries, the endless local variations slowly disappeared.

Lecturer: *[wrapping up]* So, did printing make people literate? Not on its own. It made reading matter cheap and plentiful, but schooling, religion and trade did much of the rest. We'll pick that up next week.

Narrator: *That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.*
[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

The printing press and literacy in early modern Europe

- 31** Before printing: by the 15th century, most books were copied in commercial workshops located near (31) _____
- 32** Gutenberg's key innovation: a hand (32) _____ used to produce identical metal letters
- 33** Ink: oil-based, similar to substances used by (33) _____
- 34** Main source of regular income for early printers: (34) _____
- 35** Spread of printing: especially to cities holding major (35) _____
- 36** Luther's pamphlets: written in the (36) _____ (= everyday spoken language), not Latin
- 37** Literacy is usually measured by counting (37) _____ in marriage records
- 38** Women: most were taught to read at home by their (38) _____
- 39** In many homes, the commonest printed book was the (39) _____
- 40** Long-term effect: printing made (40) _____ more uniform

FT05 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Fairleigh	The adviser first spells the more common form 'Fairley', which Daniel corrects.
2	maisonette	'Flat' (the estate agent's description) and 'house' (the category it is treated as) are both mentioned.
3	pharmacist	He was a (chemistry) teacher for years before retraining.
4	38,000 / 38000 / £38,000 / £38000	He first gives thirty thousand, which excluded clothes and kitchen equipment.
5	telescope	The bike was just under the limit and the watch has been sold.
6	water	The adviser suggests 'flood' damage, which Daniel rejects.
7	9.85 / £9.85	Daniel quotes the old website price of £8.95.
8	1,500 / 1500 / £1,500 / £1500	£1,000 is the limit used by other insurers.
9	legal	Medical cover is mentioned but rejected as belonging to travel insurance.
10	locks	'Keys' is mentioned first, but she says the policy won't just pay for new keys.
11	E (E)	G (its old site next to the church, now the library) and B (deckchair hire on the beach side) are both mentioned.
12	C (C)	F is the bank on the right-hand corner of Church Street.
13	A (A)	Listeners may expect the seafront, which is rejected, or confuse it with G, the library beside the church.
14	H (H)	D, the end of the jetty, was its previous location.
15	D (D)	The slipway (H) is mentioned and rejected as too shallow.
16	I (I)	The harbour is mentioned and rejected ('don't go to the harbour at all').
17	A (Bathing is dangerous at certain stages of the tide.)	B: the award was won years ago and lost last year; C: it doesn't empty out until about five.
18	B (the export of a building material.)	Fishing 'only ever really fed the town' and tourism came after the town was already wealthy.
19	A (Buy them from a shop that produces them on the premises.)	B: she says they're just as good cold; C: there's no need to rush because they bake all day.
20	B (The departure time is earlier than planned.)	A: the harbour pick-up was considered but rejected; C: she asks them not to ring her.
21	C (how soon the product was withdrawn)	A: she expected the big budget; B: she already knew about the road bikes' success.
22	A (It focused on an unsuitable group of people.)	B: he says it wasn't out of date; C: he admits it was expensive but says that's not the point.
23	C (It was not the main reason the bike failed.)	A: it 'wasn't priced in line with its rivals'; B: she doubts a lower launch price would have helped.
24	A (It came too soon after a rival product.)	B: Owen's autumn idea is contradicted by the sales figures; C: they agree the delay wasn't unusual.
25	F (poor communication between departments)	Owen suggests C (an unrealistic schedule), but the factory hit its targets.
26	E (inadequate testing in real-life conditions)	Owen suggests A (the new battery supplier), but the new batteries did better in lab tests.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
27	D (exaggerated advertising claims)	The battery (E) is expected but rejected: 'most of them weren't'.
28	B (a lack of staff training)	Owen suggests H (online selling), but online sales only began after the shops had given up.
29	C (an unrealistic deadline)	C was rejected for late deliveries, so listeners may not expect it to be used here.
30	G (a change in exchange rates)	Owen suggests A (the new supplier charged more), but they were cheaper.
31	universities	Monasteries were the main copying centres earlier, but not by the fifteenth century.
32	mould / mold	The press itself and movable type are both mentioned and rejected as his invention.
33	painters	Scribes are mentioned, but their water-based ink was unsuitable.
34	indulgences	The Bible is the expected answer but is rejected: 'It wasn't'.
35	fairs	University towns are mentioned but were less attractive to printers.
36	vernacular	Latin and German are both mentioned; the gap requires the general term.
37	signatures	School records are mentioned but rejected because they barely survive.
38	mothers	Priests and private tutors are mentioned and rejected.
39	almanac / almanack	The Bible is mentioned and rejected ('wasn't even the Bible').
40	spelling	Grammar is mentioned first but the lecturer says it changed rather little.

Listening Full Test 6

FT06 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Joining a Running Club	Australian (en-AU) secretary · British (en-GB) caller
2	Outdoor Education Week	British (en-GB)
3	Commuting Survey Data	British (en-GB) · Irish-accented English (en-GB)
4	How Suspension Bridges Carry Loads	American (en-US)

Joining a Running Club

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · Australian (en-AU) secretary · British (en-GB) caller

Scenario: A man who has recently moved to Australia phones a running club about becoming a member and entering its charity ten-kilometre race.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	Australian (en-AU) secretary · British (en-GB) caller
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Jodie	Club secretary — female, 40s, cheerful, relaxed and chatty; Australian accent
Voice: Ben	Caller — male, early 30s, polite, slightly hesitant, newly arrived; northern English (Manchester) accent
Script length	5,775 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a man phoning a running club to ask about joining the club and entering a race. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 4. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 1 to 4. *[post: 2 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Jodie: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [bright, friendly]* Wattle Bay Runners, Jodie speaking.

Ben: *[polite, slightly unsure]* Oh, hello. Um, I got this number from your website. I'm thinking about joining the club, and I was also hoping to find out about the ten-kilometre race you're organising.

Jodie: *[warm]* Lovely, you've come to the right person. I'm the club secretary, so I can help you with both. Can I grab your name first?

Ben: Ben. Ben Thursby. *[short pause] [a little self-conscious]* I've only just moved here from Manchester, so I don't really know anyone yet.

Jodie: *[laughing]* Well, a running club's a great way to fix that. Have you been running long?

Ben: *[modest]* A few years, on and off. I did a couple of half marathons back home, but I've been a bit lazy since the move, to be honest.

Jodie: *[encouraging]* No dramas. Right, so the club runs twice a week, Tuesday and Thursday evenings, and we start at six thirty.

Ben: *[checking]* And where do you all meet? The website mentioned the library car park, I think.

Jodie: *[apologetic]* Ah, yeah, sorry, the website's a bit out of date. We did use to meet at the library, but then the council started charging for parking there in the evenings. *[brighter]* So these days we meet at the pavilion in Norfolk Park. It's the building right next to the cricket nets, you can't miss it.

Ben: *[writing it down]* The pavilion, next to the nets. Got it. And is there a membership fee?

Jodie: *[matter-of-fact]* There is, it's an annual fee. *[short pause]* It was sixty-five dollars last year, but we've had to put it up to seventy-two, mostly because our insurance went up.

Ben: *[easygoing]* Seventy-two. That's still very reasonable. Is there anything on top of that?

Jodie: Only if you want a club singlet, and they're fifteen dollars. But that's entirely optional. Nobody makes you wear one to training.

Ben: *[thinking aloud]* Right... And what do I need to bring when I sign up? Do you need, um, a doctor's certificate or something? I know some clubs back in England ask for one.

Jodie: *[reassuring]* We used to, actually, but not any more. Now you just fill in a short health questionnaire on the night. What you will need to bring is a photo, because we print everyone a membership card, and the card gets you ten per cent off at the sports shop on the high street.

Ben: *[pleased]* A photo, fine, I can sort that out. *[short pause]* *[slightly anxious]* Is there a group for people who are, er, getting back into it? I don't want to be left behind on my first night.

Jodie: *[chuckles]* Everyone says that. Yes, there's a beginners' group on Tuesdays. It's run by one of our coaches, Gail Kerridge.

Ben: Sorry, was that Kerrigan?

Jodie: *[clearly, spelling each letter]* No, Kerridge. K... E... double R... I... D... G... E.

Ben: *[repeating slowly, as if writing]* K, E, double R, I, D, G, E. Thanks. And she always takes the beginners?

Jodie: *[warm]* She does now. She used to coach the juniors, but she swapped over this year, and honestly, she's brilliant with people who are nervous.

Narrator: Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 5 to 10. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen and answer Questions 5 to 10. *[post: 2 s pause]*

Ben: *[moving on, brisk]* Now, the race. The charity ten K. When is it exactly? I saw a poster in a café that said the second of November.

Jodie: *[sighs]* Yeah, a lot of those posters went up before we had to change it. It was going to be Sunday the second, but the council's resurfacing the coast road that weekend, so we've moved it back a week. It's now Sunday the ninth.

Ben: The ninth of November. *[relieved]* That actually suits me better. And where does it start? Somebody at work told me it starts at the surf club.

Jodie: *[explaining]* It always has done, but the surf club's being rebuilt at the moment, so this year we're starting from the lighthouse, right at the north end of the beach. The finish is still in Norfolk Park, though, so it's a point-to-point course rather than a loop.

Ben: *[pleased]* The lighthouse. That should be a nice view, at least. And how much does it cost to enter?

Jodie: *[careful]* That depends. For the general public it's forty-five dollars, but club members get a decent discount, so for members it's thirty.

Ben: *[checking, unsure he heard]* Sorry, thirteen?

Jodie: *[laughing]* I wish! No, thirty, three-oh. So if you join before you enter, you save fifteen dollars straight away.

Ben: *[laughs]* Well, that's another good reason to join. And which charity does the money go to?

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Jodie: *[warm, a bit more serious]* Last year it was the animal shelter, and the year before that it went to the surf lifesaving club. This year the committee voted for the local hospice. A few of our members have had family there, so it means a lot to people.

Ben: *[sincere]* That's a really good cause. *[short pause]* And, er, how does it work on the day? Do I pick up my number at the start?

Jodie: *[practical]* That's how we used to do it, but the queues were terrible and people were missing the start. So now you collect your race pack the day before, on the Saturday, from the marina office, down by the boat ramp. It's open from nine till four.

Ben: The marina office. So nothing's given out on the Sunday morning?

Jodie: *[firm but friendly]* Nothing at all, so don't leave it till the last minute. There is a bag drop at the lighthouse, though, and we drive all the bags back to the park for you.

Ben: *[noting it down]* Great. And is there anything for people who finish? A medal, or...?

Jodie: *[enthusiastic]* Everyone gets a medal, yes. We used to hand out T-shirts as well, but to be honest, hardly anybody wore them, so this year every finisher gets a towel instead. A proper beach towel, with the race logo on it.

Ben: *[amused]* A towel. That's actually useful, especially round here.

Jodie: *[laughing]* That was the idea. Oh, and there are two water stations on the course, at three and seven kilometres, so you won't need to carry a bottle.

Ben: *[decisive, cheerful]* Brilliant. Right, I'll come along to the pavilion on Tuesday, then, and join properly.

Jodie: *[warmly]* Perfect. Don't forget your photo, and say hello to Gail. She'll look after you.

Ben: *[smiling]* I will. Thanks very much, Jodie. Bye.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-10

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

WATTLE BAY RUNNERS

- 1 Membership — Training: Tuesdays and Thursdays, 6.30 pm. Meeting point: the (1) _____ in Norfolk Park
- 2 Yearly fee: \$(2) _____ (club singlet costs extra)
- 3 Bring a (3) _____ when signing up (needed for membership card)
- 4 Beginners' group (Tuesdays) — coach: Gail (4) _____
- 5 Charity 10K race — Date: Sunday (5) _____ November
- 6 Starting point: the (6) _____ (finish in Norfolk Park)
- 7 Entry fee for club members: \$(7) _____
- 8 Money raised will go to the local (8) _____
- 9 Race pack: pick up on Saturday at the (9) _____ office (9 am – 4 pm)
- 10 Every runner who completes the course gets a medal and a (10) _____

Outdoor Education Week

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A primary school head teacher briefs parents at an evening meeting about the Year Six outdoor education week.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Mrs Hallam	Head teacher — female, 50s, warm, organised, gently humorous; standard southern British accent
Script length	5,323 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 2. You will hear a head teacher talking to parents about a school outdoor education week. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 14. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 11 to 14. *[post: 2 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Mrs Hallam: *[school hall, a few chairs scraping, then quiet] [warm, welcoming]* Good evening, everyone, and thank you for coming out on such a wet night. I know some of you have come straight from work, so I'll try to keep this brisk. As you know, we're here to talk about the Year Six outdoor education week, which takes place in the first week of June.

Mrs Hallam: *[reflective]* Some of you will remember that when the school first started these trips, about ten years ago, the main idea was simply to get children more active. And fitness is still a very welcome side effect, of course. *[short pause]* Other parents have said to me that it's a useful step towards secondary school, and I'd agree that it helps with that.

Mrs Hallam: *[earnest, slowing down]* But what the staff and I really want from the week this year is for the children to learn to manage without us. To pack their own bags, keep track of their own kit, and make decisions in their groups without an adult jumping in to sort everything out. *[light laugh]* That's harder than it sounds, for them and for us.

Mrs Hallam: *[informative]* Now, some practical details. We're going back to Brackenside, the centre in mid-Wales that we used last year, so a lot of the staff already know the site well. The children will again be in activity groups of eight, each with its own instructor. *[slightly apologetic]* We did ask whether the groups could be cut to six, but the centre simply couldn't staff that.

Mrs Hallam: *[upbeat]* What has changed is that, rather than coming home on the Wednesday as they did last year, the children will stay a second night and come back on the Thursday afternoon. The feedback we had was that one night was over almost before it had begun.

Mrs Hallam: *[careful, businesslike]* The cost this year is two hundred and ten pounds. I know several families asked whether there's a reduction when brothers and sisters, or twins, go together. I'm afraid the centre doesn't offer one. The coach isn't part of that figure, either. The parents' association has very generously agreed to pay for it this year.

Mrs Hallam: *[reassuring]* What we can do is let you split the payment into three equal parts, in March, April and May, rather than paying it all at once. Just let the office know which you'd prefer. And if the cost is a real difficulty for any family, please come and talk to me privately. Nobody will miss out for that reason.

Mrs Hallam: *[slightly firmer]* Mobile phones. Last year, as some of you will recall, we let the children bring them. They were collected when we arrived and handed back for half an hour each evening. *[sighs]* Honestly, it caused far more homesickness than it cured. So this year, please don't pack a phone at all. If you need to reach your child, ring the centre, and we'll put photos on the school blog every evening.

Narrator: Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 15 to 20. *[post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen and answer Questions 15 to 20. *[post: 2 s pause]*

Mrs Hallam: *[clear, organised]* Let me run through the activities now, because each one needs something slightly different from you. On the first full day there's cycling, in the morning. Helmets and bikes are provided by the centre, and the children will be back in plenty of time for lunch. *[emphatic]* However, part of the route goes along a quiet public lane, so this is the one activity the centre won't let a child take part in without your signature on the permission slip.

Mrs Hallam: *[light, practical]* Then canoeing, on the lake. Everyone is given a wetsuit and a buoyancy aid, so they don't need extra clothes for that. *[chuckles]* But their feet will get soaked, without exception, so they'll need a second pair of trainers or old shoes to change into afterwards, otherwise they'll be squelching about all day.

Mrs Hallam: *[amused]* The pond and stream study comes next. Some parents asked if the children should bring a torch, for looking under rocks and so on. They don't need one. *[warning tone]* What I would say is that the mud at Brackenside is a peculiar shade of orange, and it does not wash out. Please send them in something old that you won't mind putting straight in the bin afterwards.

Mrs Hallam: *[enthusiastic]* On the second evening, there's a night walk up through the woods, which the children always love. The centre used to lend out lamps for this, but they've stopped doing that now. So every child must bring a torch of their own. It doesn't need to be anything fancy, and please, not one that flashes.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Mrs Hallam: *[informative]* The orienteering day is the longest one. The groups are out in Gwern Forest from morning until late afternoon, which is too far to come back to the centre, so for once the kitchen won't be providing a hot lunch. Please make sure your child has sandwiches and a drink with them that morning. *[short pause]* You might think they'd need sun cream, being out all day, but the centre has huge supplies, so please don't send any.

Mrs Hallam: *[serious, measured]* And finally, climbing, on the indoor wall. The children's harnesses are all checked by the instructors, so you needn't worry about equipment. But the climbing centre insists, and this is their rule rather than ours, on having a list of any medicines a child takes, especially inhalers, before that session. If that applies to your child, please write it on the form that's going home tonight.

Mrs Hallam: *[light, wrapping up]* One last thing. There's a small shop at Brackenside, and in the past children have taken pocket money. This year the shop will be closed for refurbishment, so they won't need any money at all. *[warmly]* Right, I'll stop there. Are there any questions?

Narrator: That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. *[post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-14

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 11** According to the head teacher, the main aim of the week this year is to
- A** improve the children's physical fitness.
 - B** help the children become more self-reliant.
 - C** prepare the children for their move to a new school.
- 12** What is different about the week compared with last year?
- A** the length of time the children are away
 - B** the number of children in each activity group
 - C** the outdoor centre that the school is using
- 13** What does the head teacher say about the cost of the week?
- A** Parents may pay in stages.
 - B** It is reduced for families sending more than one child.
 - C** It includes transport to the centre.
- 14** What is the school's policy on mobile phones this year?
- A** They will be handed to staff on arrival.
 - B** They may be used for a short time each evening.
 - C** Children should not bring them.

Questions 15-20

What do parents need to provide or note for each activity? Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 15-20.

A	a signed consent form
B	a packed lunch
C	clothing that can be thrown away
D	a change of footwear
E	a torch
F	sun protection
G	spending money
H	information about any medication

- 15** cycling
16 canoeing
17 pond and stream study
18 night walk
19 orienteering
20 climbing

Commuting Survey Data

Academic discussion (2 postgraduate students) · British (en-GB) · Irish-accented English (en-GB)

Scenario: Two postgraduate students discuss the results of their survey into how people in the city commute and use public transport.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.45 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB) · Irish-accented English (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Niamh	Postgraduate student — female, mid-20s, quick, direct, good-humoured; Irish accent (Dublin)
Voice: Marcus	Postgraduate student — male, late 20s, careful, slightly cautious, thinks aloud; British accent (southern English)
Script length	5,945 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear two postgraduate students, Niamh "/ni:v/" and Marcus, discussing the results of a survey they carried out on commuting and public transport. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 25. [post: 30 s pause]

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 21 to 25. [post: 2 s pause]

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Marcus: [quiet study room, papers shuffling] [tired but friendly] Right, Niamh "/ni:v/", I've finally got all the responses into one spreadsheet. Four hundred and twelve in total.

Niamh: [pleased] Not bad at all. Fewer than we hoped, mind you. I think the questionnaire was just too long. Twelve pages was asking a lot of people. So, where did most of them come from in the end? Online?

Marcus: [slightly surprised] That's what I assumed too, given how much we pushed the link on social media. But no, the online version only got about a hundred and thirty. The paper copies did far better, and nearly all of those came from libraries.

Niamh: [thinking] Really? Not the doctors' surgeries?

Marcus: [dry] We got a grand total of nineteen from the surgeries. And the supermarkets wouldn't let us leave any in the first place, if you remember.

Niamh: [laughs] Oh yes, I remember the manager's face. [wry] And to think we spent a whole weekend designing that online version. [short pause] Still, at least the paper ones were properly filled in. Half the online people gave up after page three.

Marcus: [agreeing] Yeah, the completion rate on paper was much better. Anyway.

Niamh: OK. So, the big question. Why do the drivers say they don't use the buses? I'd have bet money it'd be the fares.

Marcus: [measured] So would I. But cost only came third. It isn't the price that puts them off, and it isn't really the journey time, which was second. By some distance, the thing drivers kept coming back to was reliability. Buses not turning up, or two arriving at once.

Niamh: [nodding, half to herself] That fits with the comments section, actually. People were furious about the number seven route. [short pause] What about the cyclists? I was expecting pages about dangerous traffic.

Marcus: *[considering]* There was some of that, and a fair few mentioned showers at work. But the real complaint wasn't safety on the roads at all. It was that there's nowhere to leave a bike. They want secure storage, at the station and at work, because so many of them have had bikes stolen.

Niamh: *[interested]* Right. And the over-sixties? I suppose price doesn't matter much to them, since most of them travel free.

Marcus: *[agreeing]* Exactly, cost hardly featured. And interestingly, speed wasn't a big deal either. When we asked them to rank things, they put comfort above journey time almost every time. Getting a seat, a smooth ride, that sort of thing. *[short pause] [thoughtful]* Which surprised me a bit, actually. I'd assumed reliability would top their list as well, the same as it did for the drivers, but it only came third for them.

Niamh: *[thoughtful]* That's a nice finding. Now, presentation. Doctor Ellis said tables, didn't she?

Marcus: *[hesitant]* She did say tables were fine for the appendix. And I'd started doing bar charts for everything.

Niamh: *[firm, enthusiastic]* But so much of this is about where people live. I really think the main findings should go on maps. You'd see the gaps in the bus network straight away.

Marcus: *[conceding]* Yeah... you're right. Maps for the main results, then. I'll ditch the bar charts.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 26 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Narrator: *Now listen and answer Questions 26 to 30. [post: 2 s pause]*

Niamh: *[more serious]* We need to be honest about the sample, though. Doctor Ellis will go straight for it.

Marcus: *[worried]* I know. My worry's the young people. I thought we'd hardly have any under twenty-five.

Niamh: *[reassuring]* We're actually fine there, they're about twenty-two per cent, which is close to the city as a whole. And before you say it, students aren't a problem either. There were only about forty of them.

Marcus: *[sighs]* No, you're right. The thing that does bother me is the postcodes. Nearly two thirds of the responses are from the eastern side of the city, because that's where the libraries we used are.

Niamh: *[agreeing]* That's the real weakness, isn't it? We can't say much about the west at all.

Marcus: *[moving on]* Agreed. What about the working-from-home question? A lot of people have said that's the most surprising part of the data.

Niamh: *[sceptical]* I don't think it surprised anyone, to be honest. It's what every report's been saying for years. My problem with it is the wording. We asked how often people work remotely, and half of them didn't know whether to count a morning at home as a day or not. You can see they've interpreted it in completely different ways.

Marcus: *[suggesting]* Would it have helped if it had come earlier, before people got tired?

Niamh: *[firm]* I don't think where it was made any difference. It's the way we phrased it.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Marcus: *[thinking aloud]* Fair enough. Now, the follow-up interviews. You know I was against putting them in at first.

Niamh: *[teasing]* You said eight interviews weren't worth the paper.

Marcus: *[light laugh]* I did. And it wasn't Doctor Ellis who changed my mind, either, although she did suggest them. And they certainly don't fix the response rate, eight people isn't going to do that. *[more animated]* It's that they make sense of those odd figures for the occasional bus users, the ones who say they hate the buses and use them anyway. The interviews show why.

Niamh: *[pleased]* Great, so they're in. And the national census figures? I'd love to use them to back up our main argument.

Marcus: *[cautious]* The trouble is their categories don't match ours. They lump cycling and walking together, for one thing. And they're from four years ago, before all the changes to the bus routes, so any comparison would be a bit misleading.

Niamh: *[reluctant]* Hmm. I don't want to bin them completely, though. They took ages to find.

Marcus: *[proposing]* How about we stick them at the back, as supporting material, but don't build anything on them?

Niamh: *[agreeing]* OK, an appendix it is. So, before we see Doctor Ellis on Friday... should we email the bus company for their passenger numbers?

Marcus: *[doubtful]* They'd take weeks to reply. And there's no time to set up more interviews either.

Niamh: *[decisive]* Then let's go back through the written comments. I noticed we've coded some of them differently from each other, so we should sort that out first.

Marcus: *[relieved]* Good idea. I'll take the first half, you take the second, and we can compare notes on Thursday evening. *[light laugh]* Then at least we'll walk in on Friday agreeing with each other.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-25

Complete the summary below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

Commuting survey: initial findings

- 21** Most of the completed questionnaires were paper copies collected from (21) _____, rather than online responses.
- 22** The main reason car drivers gave for avoiding buses was (22) _____.
- 23** Cyclists were most concerned about the shortage of secure (23) _____.
- 24** Older respondents valued (24) _____ more highly than speed.
- 25** The key results will be shown on (25) _____.

Questions 26-30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 26** The students agree that the main weakness of their sample is that
- A** young adults are under-represented.
 - B** most respondents live in one area of the city.
 - C** it contains too many students.
- 27** What is Niamh's view of the question about working from home?
- A** It was open to more than one interpretation.
 - B** It was placed too late in the questionnaire.
 - C** It produced the most unexpected results.
- 28** Why does Marcus now support including the follow-up interviews?
- A** They help to explain some puzzling data.
 - B** Their supervisor advised them to use them.
 - C** They compensate for the small number of survey responses.
- 29** What do the students decide to do with the national census figures?
- A** omit them from the report
 - B** include them in an appendix
 - C** use them as evidence for their main argument
- 30** What will the students do before meeting their supervisor?
- A** check how they have categorised the open responses
 - B** request data from a transport company
 - C** carry out some additional interviews

How Suspension Bridges Carry Loads

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · American (en-US)

Scenario: An engineering lecturer explains how suspension bridges are built, how they carry loads, and the problems caused by wind, pedestrians and corrosion.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.55 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	American (en-US)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	Engineering lecturer — male, 50s, clear, enthusiastic, slightly wry; General American accent
Script length	5,557 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about the engineering of suspension bridges.

First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. *[post: 45 s pause]*

Narrator: Now listen carefully and answer Questions 31 to 40. *[post: 2 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture hall, a faint murmur fading] [lively, clear]* Okay, let's get started. Today we're looking at suspension bridges, which, for the longest spans, are still pretty much the only option we have. I want to focus on how they actually carry loads, and then on what can go wrong.

Lecturer: *[conversational]* Just to put that in context: a good concrete beam bridge might span a couple of hundred meters between supports, and a cable-stayed bridge perhaps a thousand. The longest suspension bridges now cross more than two kilometers in a single span. *[short pause]* So whatever they're doing, they're doing it very efficiently, and the reason comes down to how each part shares the work.

Lecturer: *[measured, explaining]* The basic idea is simple. The deck, the part you drive on, hangs from vertical cables, and those vertical cables hang from two main cables that run over the tops of the towers. Now, a lot of students assume the main cables are being squeezed by all that weight. *[short pause]* They aren't. A cable can't resist being squeezed at all. The main cables are only ever in tension. They're being pulled. It's the towers that work in compression, pushing the load straight down into the foundations.

Lecturer: *[informative]* So where does the pull in the cables end up? At each end of the bridge, the cables are tied into anchorages. These are enormous blocks, and their whole job is to be heavy enough not to be dragged toward the river. On older bridges, they were built of masonry, cut stone, and in a few places the cables were simply anchored into solid rock. But today, almost without exception, anchorages are made of concrete, sometimes hundreds of thousands of tons of it.

Lecturer: *[enthusiastic]* The main cables themselves are fascinating. You might picture a giant twisted rope, like a ship's hawser. That's not how it's done. Each cable is made of thousands of thin, parallel steel wires, and they're laid in place one at a time, high above the water, by a wheel running backward and forward between the anchorages. *[light laugh]* The process looks a bit like weaving, but engineers call it spinning, and it can take more than a year.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful, careful]* Let's think about the shape of the cable. If you hang a chain between two points, with nothing attached, it forms a curve called a catenary. You'll see that word in older textbooks applied to bridges. But a suspension bridge cable isn't just hanging under its own

weight. Once the deck is attached, and the load is spread evenly along the span, the curve is much closer to a parabola. And that's the shape designers actually work with.

Lecturer: *[amused, conversational]* Here's a detail I love. On the very longest bridges, the towers aren't exactly parallel. They're a few centimeters farther apart at the top than at the bottom. It's not a construction error, and it's not the cables pulling them outward either. *[slowing down]* It's because each tower points toward the center of the Earth, so the curvature of the planet means they lean very slightly away from each other.

Lecturer: *[more serious]* Now, what can go wrong? The big enemy is wind. You've probably all seen the film of the Tacoma Narrows Bridge in nineteen forty, twisting until it fell apart. You'll often read that it was destroyed by resonance, like a singer shattering a glass. *[firmly]* That's not really accurate. Engineers now agree the cause was flutter, a self-feeding twisting motion, where the movement of the deck changes the airflow, which then makes the movement bigger.

Lecturer: *[informative]* After Tacoma, the first response was to make decks far stiffer. Designers didn't change the shape much at first. Instead, they hung deep trusses underneath the road, a kind of open steel framework, which stopped the deck from twisting. *[short pause]* Later, especially in Europe, engineers went the other way, with slim box decks shaped rather like an aircraft wing, which they test in wind tunnels before anything is built. Both approaches work, but the wing-shaped decks use far less steel.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[wry]* Wind isn't the only problem, though. People can be one too. When London's Millennium Bridge opened in two thousand, which is a very shallow suspension bridge, it started swaying from side to side. Pedestrians unconsciously fell into step with the movement, which made it worse. The bridge was closed, and there was talk of closing it for good, or rebuilding it entirely. *[short pause]* In the end, the fix was to install dampers, devices that absorb the energy of the motion, a bit like the shock absorbers in a car.

Lecturer: *[serious, emphatic]* Finally, maintenance. You might expect the biggest long-term worry to be metal fatigue, the gradual weakening from millions of loading cycles. In fact, for main cables, that's a relatively minor issue. The real threat is corrosion. Water gets in between the wires, and once they start to rust, they snap, one at a time, deep inside the cable where nobody can see them.

Lecturer: *[explaining]* So how do you find a broken wire you can't see? One method is to unwrap sections of cable and inspect them by eye, but that's slow and very expensive. X-rays have been tried, but the cables are just too thick. *[interested]* What many bridges use now is acoustic monitoring. Microphones are clamped along the cable, and when a wire breaks, it gives off a sharp crack, and the system records exactly where and when it happened.

Lecturer: *[practical, wrapping up]* Some bridges go further and blow dry air through the cables to stop corrosion before it starts, and we'll look at those systems next week. For now, I'd like you to read the case study on the reading list before Thursday.

Narrator: *That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.*
[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

Suspension bridges: how they carry loads

31 Structure — Main cables: are stretched, i.e. always in (31) _____ (towers in compression)

32 Anchorages: massive blocks, now generally built of (32) _____

33 Main cables: thousands of parallel steel wires placed individually — this is known as (33) _____

34 With an evenly distributed deck load, the cable forms a (34) _____ (not the curve of a freely hanging chain)

35 Towers on very long spans are slightly further apart at the top because of the Earth's (35) _____

36 Wind — Tacoma Narrows (1940): collapse actually caused by (36) _____

37 First solution: decks stiffened with deep (37) _____ below the road

38 Pedestrians — London's Millennium Bridge: side-to-side movement solved by adding (38) _____

39 Maintenance — Greatest danger to main cables: (39) _____ (fatigue less important)

40 Broken wires detected by attaching (40) _____ to the cable

FT06 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	pavilion	The caller suggests the library car park, which was the old meeting place.
2	72 / seventy-two / \$72	Last year's fee of sixty-five dollars and the fifteen-dollar singlet are also mentioned.
3	photo / photograph	A doctor's certificate is suggested but no longer required, and the health questionnaire is filled in on the night.
4	Kerridge	The caller mishears the name as Kerrigan; the double R must be spelled correctly.
5	9th / 9 / ninth	The poster gives the second, the original date before the road works.
6	lighthouse	The surf club was the start in previous years; Norfolk Park is the finish.
7	30 / thirty / \$30	Forty-five (public price), fifteen (the saving) and the misheard thirteen are all distractors.
8	hospice	The animal shelter and the surf lifesaving club received the money in earlier years.
9	marina	Numbers used to be collected at the start, and there is a bag drop at the lighthouse.
10	towel	T-shirts were given in the past; the medal is already in the notes.
11	B (help the children become more self-reliant.)	Fitness was the original aim and preparing for secondary school is mentioned as a useful side benefit, but neither is the main aim this year.
12	A (the length of time the children are away)	The school considered smaller groups but they stay at eight, and Brackenside was also used last year.
13	A (Parents may pay in stages.)	There is no discount for siblings or twins, and the coach is not included in the price (the parents' association pays for it).
14	C (Children should not bring them.)	A and B describe last year's arrangements, which have now been dropped.
15	A (a signed consent form)	Helmets are provided and the children return for lunch, so B is not needed.
16	D (a change of footwear)	Extra clothes are not needed because wetsuits are provided.
17	C (clothing that can be thrown away)	A torch is suggested by parents for this activity but rejected.
18	E (a torch)	The centre used to lend lamps, so listeners may think nothing is needed.
19	B (a packed lunch)	Sun cream (F) is raised for this activity but parents are told not to send any.
20	H (information about any medication)	Equipment is checked by the instructors, and the form going home is a means of giving the information, not a consent form; money (G) is not needed for anything.
21	libraries	Online/social media was expected to dominate; doctors' surgeries gave very few and supermarkets refused.
22	reliability	Both students expected cost (fares), which came third; journey time came second.
23	storage	Traffic danger and showers at work are mentioned but are not the main complaint.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
24	comfort	Price might seem likely but older people travel free, and speed is ranked lower.
25	maps	Tables are suggested by the supervisor (only for the appendix) and bar charts are abandoned.
26	B (most respondents live in one area of the city.)	Marcus worries about young people and students, but Niamh shows both are adequately represented.
27	A (It was open to more than one interpretation.)	Others found the results surprising and Marcus suggests moving it earlier, but Niamh rejects both.
28	A (They help to explain some puzzling data.)	The supervisor did suggest them but did not persuade him, and he says they don't fix the response rate.
29	B (include them in an appendix)	Niamh wants to support the main argument with them and considers that throwing them away would be a waste, but both are rejected.
30	A (check how they have categorised the open responses)	Contacting the bus company and arranging more interviews are both suggested and ruled out for lack of time.
31	tension	Students assume the cables are squeezed; compression applies to the towers.
32	concrete	Masonry/stone was used on older bridges, and some cables were anchored in rock.
33	spinning	The process is said to look like weaving, but that is not the term used.
34	parabola	Catenary is the shape of a freely hanging chain, used in older textbooks.
35	curvature	A construction error and the pull of the cables are both rejected as explanations.
36	flutter	Resonance is the popular explanation, which the lecturer says is inaccurate.
37	trusses	Wing-shaped box decks and wind tunnels belong to the later, European approach.
38	dampers	Permanent closure and complete rebuilding were discussed but rejected; shock absorbers are only an analogy.
39	corrosion	Metal fatigue is the expected answer but is described as relatively minor.
40	microphones	Visual inspection by unwrapping is too expensive and X-rays don't work on thick cables.

Listening Full Test 7

FT07 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Renting a Flat	British (en-GB)
2	A New Exhibition of Historical Maps	British (en-GB)
3	A Presentation on Bioplastics	Tutor British (en-GB); student Australian (en-AU)
4	The Domestication of the Horse	British (en-GB)

Renting a Flat

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A young woman phones a letting agency to register as a tenant and hear about three flats that might suit her.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Daniel	Letting agent — male, 30s, upbeat, professional, slightly salesy; British accent
Voice: Megan	Caller — female, early 20s, friendly, a little nervous at first, then decisive; British accent
Script length	5,658 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a young woman phoning a letting agency about renting a flat. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 5. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Daniel: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [bright, professional]* Good morning, Calder Lettings, Daniel speaking. How can I help?

Megan: *[a little nervous, friendly]* Oh, hi. Um, I filled in the form on your website last week about renting a one-bedroom flat, but nobody's got back to me, so I thought I'd just ring.

Daniel: *[apologetic]* Ah, sorry about that, we've had a bit of a backlog. *[practical]* Let me take your details again and I'll set you up properly on our system. Can I have your name?

Megan: It's Megan Rennison.

Daniel: *[typing, murmuring]* Megan... and that's R... E... N... I... S... O... N?

Megan: *[correcting him politely]* Nearly. Rennison has a double N. So R... E... double N... I... S... O... N.

Daniel: *[reading it back carefully]* Double N. Got it, thanks. And what do you do, Megan? The landlords always ask about employment.

Megan: *[light laugh]* Sure. Well, until the spring I was a receptionist at a dental surgery, and people still assume I'm a dental nurse, but I've actually just qualified as a paramedic. *[quietly proud]* I started with the ambulance service in May.

Daniel: *[impressed]* Oh, well done. *[brisk]* And when are you hoping to move in?

Megan: *[thinking aloud]* So, my current tenancy ends on the thirty-first of July, but I don't want to rush into anything, so I'll stay with my sister for a bit. Um... she's away herself until the middle of August, so... *[decisive]* I'd say from the twenty-third of August. Not before that.

Daniel: *[noting it down]* The twenty-third. That's good timing, actually. A lot of our flats come free around then. Now, what's your budget per month?

Megan: *[hesitant]* Well, on the online form I put nine hundred pounds...

Daniel: *[knowing]* Mm-hm.

Megan: *[sighs]* ...but I've been looking around, and I don't think I'll find anything decent for that. So I could stretch to nine hundred and fifty. *[firm]* I really can't go any higher than that, though.

Daniel: *[reassuring]* That's realistic for this area. Is that including bills?

Megan: No, that's just the rent. I'll pay the bills on top.

Daniel: *[practical]* Fine. Just so you know, there's a holding deposit of one week's rent when you apply, and then a full deposit of five weeks' rent before you move in. We'll also need a reference from your current landlord.

Megan: *[relaxed]* That's no problem. I've always paid on time, so she's happy to write one.

Daniel: *[businesslike]* Great. And is there anything the landlord would need to agree to? Any special requirements?

Megan: *[slightly anxious]* Yes, er, I've got a pet. *[quickly]* Not a dog. Everyone assumes that. And it isn't a cat either, I know landlords worry about their carpets. It's a rabbit. She lives indoors, in a big cage.

Daniel: *[amused, chuckles]* A rabbit. That shouldn't put most of them off, but I'll make a note so there are no surprises. *[shifting to business]* Right. I've got three flats on my list at the moment that might suit you. Shall I tell you about them?

Megan: *[eager]* Yes, please. Hang on, let me find a pen... OK, go ahead.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 6 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Daniel: *[clear, informative]* OK. The first one's on Mill Lane, near the park. The rent is eight hundred and seventy-five a month, so that's well within your budget.

Megan: *[pleased]* Oh, nice. What floor is it on? I'd rather not be on the ground floor, to be honest.

Daniel: *[checking the screen]* Well, the advert says second floor, but *[correcting himself]* actually, that's wrong. I went round there on Monday, and it's on the third floor. It's the top of the building, so it gets a lot of light.

Megan: *[hopeful]* That sounds lovely. Is there a catch?

Daniel: *[honest, slightly apologetic]* The main thing is that there's no lift, so you'd be climbing three flights of stairs every day. *[quickly, reassuring]* Parking's fine, there's a residents' permit scheme, and the boiler was replaced last year.

Megan: *[wry]* Three flights with the shopping... and the rabbit's cage. Hmm. *[short pause]* OK, what's the second one?

Daniel: *[upbeat]* That's on Carlton Road, just by the station. Nine hundred and thirty a month. It's been completely refurbished, so...

Megan: *[interrupting gently]* Completely?

Daniel: *[qualifying, a little sheepish]* Well... not quite. The bathroom wasn't touched, that's about ten years old, and the carpets are the same. But there's a brand-new kitchen, it was fitted just last month, and it's beautifully designed.

Megan: *[interested]* That's a big plus, I cook a lot. But is it noisy, being so close to the station?

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Daniel: *[knowing]* That's what everyone asks. *[explaining]* Actually, the trains aren't the issue, the windows are all double-glazed. The problem is that the flat is directly above a bakery, and they start work at about four in the morning. *[chuckles]* You'd wake up to the smell of fresh bread, but you'd also hear the ovens and the delivery vans.

Megan: *[laughing]* With my shifts, I'm sometimes up at four anyway. *[thoughtful]* And the third?

Daniel: *[measured]* The third is in Orchard Court, the new development by the river. That's nine hundred and ninety, so a bit over...

Megan: *[firmly]* Yes, that's more than I said I could pay.

Daniel: *[persuasive]* I know, but it might be worth a look, because the landlord's said he may come down a little. It hasn't got a garden. There used to be a shared one, but it's been turned into car parking. But there's a really large balcony, big enough for a table and chairs, and it gets the sun all afternoon.

Megan: *[tempted]* Oh, I'd love some outdoor space. Is there any storage?

Daniel: *[informative]* Plenty. Each flat has its own storeroom in the basement.

Megan: *[deciding]* OK. Could I see all three? Maybe Carlton Road first, because of the kitchen?

Daniel: *[pleased]* Of course. I could do Thursday afternoon, say two o'clock, and then go straight on to the other two.

Megan: *[apologetic]* Ah, I'm on a late shift on Thursday. Friday morning would be better.

Daniel: *[checking]* Friday at ten, then. I'll meet you outside the bakery, and I'll text you the details this afternoon.

Megan: *[warm]* Perfect. Thanks so much, Daniel.

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-5

Complete the form below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

CALDER LETTINGS — TENANT REGISTRATION

- 1 Name: Megan _____
2 Occupation: _____
3 Earliest date to move in: _____ August
4 Maximum rent per month (excluding bills): £ _____
5 Pet (kept indoors): a _____

Questions 6-10

Complete the table below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Flats available

Location	Rent per month	Advantages	Disadvantages
Mill Lane	£875	on the (6) _____ floor; very bright	has no (7) _____
Carlton Road	£930	(8) _____ is new	noise from a (9) _____ _____ underneath
Orchard Court	£990	large (10) _____; storage in basement	more than her budget

- 6 Mill Lane — advantages: on the _____ floor
7 Mill Lane — disadvantages: has no _____
8 Carlton Road — advantages: _____ is new
9 Carlton Road — disadvantages: noise from a _____ underneath
10 Orchard Court — advantages: large _____

A New Exhibition of Historical Maps

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A museum curator introduces a group of visitors to a new exhibition of historical maps and explains the layout of the gallery.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Curator	Museum curator — female, 50s, warm, articulate, enthusiastic with a dry sense of humour; British accent
Script length	5,315 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 2. You will hear a museum curator talking to a group of visitors about a new exhibition. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 15. [post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Curator: *[small gallery, voices settling] [warm, welcoming]* Good afternoon, everyone, and welcome to the Harland Museum. My name's Ruth Calloway, and I'm the curator of our new exhibition, Lines on the Land, which brings together five centuries of maps. Before you go in, I'd like to tell you a little about how it came about, and how the gallery is laid out.

Curator: *[conversational]* A lot of people assume the exhibition was planned to celebrate the museum's two-hundredth anniversary. *[light laugh]* It wasn't. That's not until next year. And while we did receive a very generous gift of sea charts from the Whitlock family last spring, those had already been earmarked for a separate display.

Curator: *[animated]* The real starting point was rather more dramatic. Three years ago, builders were renovating the east wing, and behind some old wooden panelling they found a rolled-up estate map, almost perfectly preserved. *[short pause]* Everything you'll see today grew out of the questions that map raised.

Curator: *[explaining]* Now, most map exhibitions tell the story in date order, from the oldest to the newest, and we did consider doing that. In the end, though, we decided to group the maps according to what they were made for. So there are maps for war, maps for trade, maps for religious pilgrimage, and so on. *[wry]* It means a sixteenth-century chart can hang next to a twentieth-century one, which some visitors find a little disorienting at first.

Curator: *[slightly regretful]* We'd also hoped to have material from every continent, but sadly two of our loans, from Australia and from Brazil, fell through at the last minute, so the collection is more European than I'd have liked.

Curator: *[enthusiastic]* Let me mention one map in particular. The oldest piece in the show is a map of a river valley drawn by a monk called Brother Anselm. *[clarifying]* We're in the unusual position of knowing exactly who made it, because he wrote his name in the corner. You'll notice some water stains, and there's a popular story that it survived a flood at the abbey. In fact, the stains came from a leaking roof in a Victorian library, much more recently.

Curator: *[lowering voice, as if sharing a secret]* What's really exciting is that for decades it was catalogued as a fifteenth-century map. When we analysed the ink last year, it turned out to be nearly two hundred years older than anyone had thought.

Curator: *[practical]* I'd strongly suggest you pick up an audio guide at the desk. It isn't free, I'm afraid, there's a charge of three pounds. We'd planned to include interviews with descendants of some of the mapmakers, but that part hasn't been recorded yet. *[warmly]* What the guide does brilliantly, though, is decode all the little pictures and signs on the maps, which most of us simply can't read today.

Curator: *[gently firm]* Photography is allowed throughout, but please switch off your flash. Some of the inks are extremely sensitive to light, which is also why the gallery is kept rather dim. *[light laugh]* Your eyes will adjust after a minute or two, I promise.

Curator: *[brisk]* And a couple of changes since we first advertised the exhibition. We originally said you'd have to book tickets online in advance, but demand has been manageable, so you can just turn up. Children under twelve still pay a reduced price, by the way. They don't get in free. And the late opening, which was going to be on Thursdays, will now be on Fridays, until nine.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 16 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Curator: *[clear, guiding]* Right, let me explain the layout. If you look at the plan in your leaflet, you'll see the entrance at the bottom, and as you come in, the ticket desk is immediately on your right.

Curator: *[informative]* Go past the desk and right into that corner, and you'll find the Whitlock sea charts. *[explaining]* You might expect them to be along the right-hand wall by the windows, but the light would fade the colours, so they're tucked away in the corner instead.

Curator: *[enthusiastic]* In the centre of the room, you can't miss the giant globe. *[correcting an impression]* The interactive map table was originally going to stand between the entrance and the globe, but it caused queues right at the door. So it's now on the far side of the globe, between the globe and the doorway to the shop.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Curator: *[measured]* Along the left-hand wall there are two large cases. The one nearest the entrance holds our Roman road maps. *[emphatic]* The estate map, the one the builders found, is in the second case along, halfway down that wall.

Curator: *[guiding]* In the top left-hand corner you'll see the staircase up to the library. There's a short film about how maps were engraved and printed, and that's shown on a screen just to the right of the stairs as you face them. *[clarifying]* Not underneath them. That space is only used for storage.

Curator: *[slightly amused]* Just to the left of the shop doorway is where the children's trail begins, and you'll probably hear it before you see it. And halfway along the window wall there's a row of benches, if you need a rest, with a lovely view of the river.

Curator: *[informative]* And finally, our replica printing press. We'd hoped to put it in the middle of the window wall, but the floor there isn't strong enough to take the weight. So it's in the top right-hand corner, to the right of the shop doorway. *[warmly]* Our volunteers give demonstrations every hour. *[short pause]* Right, do enjoy the exhibition, and do come and find me if you have any questions.

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-15

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 11** What led to the idea for the exhibition?
- A** an important date in the museum's history
 - B** a donation from a local family
 - C** an unexpected find in the building
- 12** According to the curator, what is unusual about the exhibition?
- A** It is arranged by the function of the maps.
 - B** It includes maps from all over the world.
 - C** It follows a strict historical sequence.
- 13** What does the curator say about the map by Brother Anselm?
- A** Nobody knows who drew it.
 - B** It was damaged during a flood.
 - C** Its age had been incorrectly recorded.
- 14** The curator recommends the audio guide because it
- A** costs nothing to use.
 - B** contains recordings of mapmakers' relatives.
 - C** explains the meaning of symbols.
- 15** What change has been made to the original arrangements?
- A** Tickets must now be reserved beforehand.
 - B** The museum stays open late on a different day.
 - C** Young children no longer have to pay.

Questions 16-20

Label the plan below. Write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 16-20.

Lines on the Land — Gallery Plan

Plan (for the designer): A rectangular gallery, wider than it is deep, shown with north at the top. The ENTRANCE is in the middle of the bottom (south) wall. The TICKET DESK (labelled) is just inside the entrance, immediately to its right (east). WINDOWS (labelled) run along the whole right-hand (east) wall. A large circular GIANT GLOBE (labelled) stands in the centre of the room. The STAIRCASE (labelled) is in the top left-hand (north-west) corner. The doorway TO SHOP (labelled) is in the middle of the top (north) wall. Letters: A = display case on the left-hand (west) wall nearest the entrance (south end of west wall); B = display case halfway along the left-hand (west) wall; C = on the top (north) wall immediately to the right (east) of the staircase; D = on the top wall immediately to the left (west) of the shop doorway; E = top right-hand (north-east) corner, to the right of the shop doorway; F = middle of the right-hand (east) wall, by the windows; G = bottom right-hand (south-east) corner, beyond the ticket desk; H = between the globe and the shop doorway (north of the globe).

A	(position on the plan)
B	(position on the plan)
C	(position on the plan)
D	(position on the plan)
E	(position on the plan)
F	(position on the plan)
G	(position on the plan)
H	(position on the plan)

- 16** Whitlock sea charts
17 interactive map table
18 estate map
19 film about printing
20 replica printing press

A Presentation on Bioplastics

Academic discussion: student and tutor (2 speakers) · Tutor British (en-GB); student Australian (en-AU)

Scenario: An environmental science student discusses a draft of his presentation on bioplastics with his tutor.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.45 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	Tutor British (en-GB); student Australian (en-AU)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Dr Hollis	Tutor — female, 50s, incisive, dry humour, encouraging but frank; British accent
Voice: Liam	Student — male, early 20s, relaxed, enthusiastic, quick to concede a point; Australian accent
Script length	6,041 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear a student called Liam talking to his tutor about a presentation he is preparing on bioplastics. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 26. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Dr Hollis: *[a knock, a door opening] [warm, brisk]* Come in, Liam, have a seat. So, the bioplastics presentation. How's it coming along?

Liam: *[relaxed, slightly rueful]* Yeah, not bad. I've got a full draft, but I wanted to run through the section on the different sources with you before I finalise the slides.

Dr Hollis: *[encouraging]* Good idea. Go on, then.

Liam: *[explaining]* So I start with corn starch, because it's still the most widely used. And I'd written that the big problem with it is that it's brittle, you know, it cracks easily...

Dr Hollis: *[doubtful]* Hmm, I'd be careful there. That was true of the early versions, but the blends they use now are surprisingly tough. And you've got a line here about toxic by-products. I couldn't find any reliable source for that.

Liam: *[conceding, a little embarrassed]* Fair enough, I think I got that off a blog. *[thinking aloud]* So really it comes down to the fact that every hectare of maize grown for plastic is a hectare that isn't feeding anyone.

Dr Hollis: *[firmly]* Exactly. That's the argument you should lead with.

Liam: *[moving on]* Then sugarcane. Now, I went in thinking this was the worst of the lot, because you hear so much about rainforest being cleared for plantations.

Dr Hollis: *[measured]* And?

Liam: *[animated]* Well, the more I read, the more I realised that's mostly a myth, at least where plastics are concerned. Most of it's made from bagasse, the fibre that's left over once the sugar's been extracted, so it doesn't need any extra land at all. *[emphatic]* I reckon it gets a lot of stick that it really doesn't deserve.

Dr Hollis: *[approving]* I'd go along with that. And it's cheap to process, which helps.

Liam: *[enthusiastic]* Seaweed's my favourite, honestly. I assumed supply would be the sticking point, since wild seaweed can only be harvested at certain times...

Dr Hollis: *[interjecting]* But it's farmed now, isn't it? All year round.

Liam: Yeah, exactly, so that's not an issue. And it's strong enough for most packaging. *[sighs]* The trouble is, it still costs about four times as much to make as ordinary plastic, and until that comes

down, no manufacturer's going to touch it.

Dr Hollis: *[dry]* Sadly, I think you're right.

Liam: *[amused]* Then there's the one made from used cooking oil, collected from restaurants.

Dr Hollis: *[chuckles]* Ah yes. I find that one rather appealing. The oil's a waste product, so it ought to be cheap.

Liam: It is, the cost's fine. But the bags they trialled apparently kept a faint whiff of chips, *[laughs]* which isn't ideal if you're wrapping, I don't know, a birthday cake.

Dr Hollis: *[laughing]* No, quite. Make sure you mention that.

Liam: *[more serious]* Next is chitosan, which comes from shrimp and crab shells. People expect it to smell of fish...

Dr Hollis: *[sceptical]* And doesn't it?

Liam: *[firm]* No, it's completely odourless once it's been processed. And it's tough. The problem is that the shells only come in while the fishing season's open, so for months on end there's nothing to work with.

Dr Hollis: *[thoughtful]* So the factories would be sitting idle half the year. Yes, that's a real limitation.

Liam: *[wrapping up the list]* And the last one is potato peel, from crisp factories.

Dr Hollis: *[interested]* I'd have thought the supply there was enormous.

Liam: It is. They run all year, so there's no shortage, and it isn't expensive either. But the material just doesn't hold up. It tears really easily, so you couldn't use it for anything heavier than, say, a sandwich wrapper.

Dr Hollis: *[agreeing]* That's fair. Just make that point clearly. *[short pause]* Oh, and one more thing before we move on. Are you going to explain the difference between biodegradable and compostable? Because a lot of your audience will assume they're the same.

Liam: *[a bit caught out]* Ah. I hadn't planned to, no. I suppose I could add a slide near the start, saying that compostable means it breaks down within a set time, but usually only in an industrial facility, not a garden heap.

Dr Hollis: *[approving]* Yes, do. Otherwise half your argument won't make sense to them.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 27 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Dr Hollis: *[curious]* Remind me, what made you pick this topic in the first place? Was it your summer job?

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Liam: *[laughs]* At the packaging firm in Brisbane? No, I was only stacking boxes there, I never saw how anything was made. And I'd actually put down ocean plastics as my first choice, and nobody else had chosen it, so I could easily have kept it. *[reflective]* It was a documentary about compostable coffee cups that changed my mind. I watched it one night and just couldn't stop thinking about it.

Dr Hollis: *[practical]* Well, it shows. Now, the slides. You've got twelve for fifteen minutes, which is about right, so don't worry about the number.

Liam: *[uncertain]* I was worried I'd crammed too much writing onto them.

Dr Hollis: *[reassuring]* Actually, no, you've been quite disciplined, it's mostly key words. *[frank]* My concern is the graphs. The labels are tiny and the colours are almost identical, so from the back of a lecture theatre no one will be able to make them out.

Liam: *[rueful]* Right. I'll redo those. *[hesitant]* And for the opening, I was going to hit them with a statistic, like how many million tonnes of plastic get made every year.

Dr Hollis: *[doubtful]* Everyone does that, and the numbers are so huge they don't mean anything to people.

Liam: *[trying again]* Or I could put a question to the audience. Like, who here has used a compostable cup this week?

Dr Hollis: *[cautious]* That can fall rather flat if nobody answers. *[warming up]* What about the thing you told me last week? When you buried a so-called biodegradable cup in your garden and dug it up six months later?

Liam: *[laughing]* And it looked brand new.

Dr Hollis: *[decisive]* Exactly. Start there. It happened to you, it's memorable, and it leads straight into your argument.

Liam: *[convinced]* OK, yeah, I'll do that. And the conclusion? I wondered whether it's a bit short.

Dr Hollis: *[considering]* Short is no bad thing at the end. And you haven't brought in any new material, which is good, because people often do. *[frank]* But you never actually tell us what you think should happen. You list the pros and cons, and then you just stop.

Liam: *[sighs]* So I'm sitting on the fence.

Dr Hollis: *[dry, amused]* Firmly. Give them a clear recommendation, even if it's a cautious one.

Liam: *[decisive]* Right. I'll argue that seaweed deserves the research funding. That's what I actually believe, anyway.

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-26

What do Liam and his tutor conclude about each source of bioplastic? Choose SIX answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-G, next to Questions 21-26.

Evaluation

A	Its production costs remain too high.
B	It is too weak for many uses.
C	It has been unfairly criticised.
D	It may produce harmful by-products.
E	The raw material is only available at certain times of year.
F	It competes with food production for land.
G	It may have an unpleasant smell.

21 corn starch

22 sugarcane

23 seaweed

24 used cooking oil

25 shrimp and crab shells

26 potato peel

Questions 27-30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

27 Why did Liam decide to focus on bioplastics?

- A** His previous employment had given him an interest in it.
- B** He was influenced by a film he had seen.
- C** The topic he wanted first had been taken by someone else.

28 What does the tutor criticise about Liam's slides?

- A** There are too many of them.
- B** They contain too much text.
- C** Some visual information is unclear.

29 How does the tutor suggest Liam should begin his presentation?

- A** by describing a personal experiment
- B** by asking the audience about their habits
- C** by giving some striking figures

30 What does the tutor think is the main weakness of Liam's conclusion?

- A** It is not long enough.
- B** It fails to take a definite position.
- C** It introduces points not covered earlier.

The Domestication of the Horse

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: An archaeology lecturer explains how new evidence has changed ideas about where and when the horse was domesticated.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	University lecturer — male, 40s, clear, engaging, precise, occasionally wry; British accent
Script length	6,083 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about the domestication of the horse. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. *[post: 45 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture theatre, faint murmur fading]* *[clear, engaging]* Good morning. Today I want to look at one of the most consequential partnerships in human history, the one between people and horses. *[measured]* It's a story that has been substantially rewritten in the last decade or so, largely thanks to genetics, so some of what you'll find in older textbooks is, frankly, out of date. *[brisk]* I'll start with the evidence that was traditionally used, then turn to what the DNA tells us, and finish with how the horse spread.

Lecturer: *[informative]* For a long time, the strongest candidate for the first horse-keeping society was the Botai culture, in what is now northern Kazakhstan, around three thousand five hundred BCE. The Botai were clearly obsessed with horses. At some of their settlements, horse bones make up more than ninety per cent of all the animal remains.

Lecturer: *[explaining carefully]* Of course, huge numbers of bones might simply mean very successful hunting. So researchers looked for evidence that the animals were controlled. The first line of evidence came not from the legs or the spine, where you might expect to see signs of heavy work, but from the teeth. Some Botai horses had small areas of wear on their premolars, which was interpreted as damage from a bit, the piece of equipment placed in a horse's mouth to steer it.

Lecturer: *[animated]* The second line of evidence was chemical. Researchers analysed residues left inside Botai pottery. *[emphasising the contrast]* Now, if these people were hunters, you'd expect fats from horse meat, and that wasn't what made the headlines. What was significant was the presence of fats from mare's milk. *[short pause]* And you can't milk a wild horse, or at least, not twice.

Lecturer: *[measured]* Thirdly, there's the question of whether horses were kept in enclosures. Excavators had found rings of post holes, but these were ambiguous, as they could equally be the remains of houses. Much more persuasive were unusually high levels of nitrogen and phosphorus in the soil within certain areas, which is what you'd get from large quantities of dung accumulating in a pen.

Lecturer: *[pivoting, more serious]* So the case for Botai looked strong. Then, in two thousand and eighteen, a genetic study sequenced the DNA of Botai horses, and the results were a real surprise. They were not the ancestors of the horses we ride today. Instead, they were the ancestors of the Przewalski *"/jə'vælski/"* horse, the stocky animal found on the Mongolian steppe.

Lecturer: *[wry]* This had an awkward consequence. Przewalski's horse had always been celebrated as the last truly wild horse on Earth. *[firm]* That description can no longer stand. If its ancestors were kept by the Botai, then Przewalski's horses are feral, that is, descended from domesticated animals that escaped human control and returned to life in the wild. *[aside]* Incidentally, by the late nineteen-sixties they had disappeared from the wild altogether, and every one alive today is descended from a handful of animals kept in zoos.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* That left an obvious question. If modern domestic horses didn't come from Botai, where did they come from? Over the years, various regions had been proposed, including Anatolia, in modern Turkey, and the Iberian Peninsula. *[clear, deliberate]* A very large study published in two thousand and twenty-one, which analysed the genomes of hundreds of ancient horses, finally gave an answer: the western steppe, around the lower reaches of the Volga and Don rivers, in what is now southern Russia, at roughly two thousand two hundred BCE.

Lecturer: *[engaged]* The same study identified genes that seem to have been strongly selected by those early breeders. You might expect speed to have been a priority. *[short pause]* It wasn't, at least not at first. One of the genes is associated with a stronger back, which would have made the animals better able to carry riders and loads.

Lecturer: *[explaining]* Another is linked to more docile behaviour. Wild horses are prey animals and they panic easily. An animal that was less fearful, and therefore less likely to bolt or kick, would have been far more valuable to its owners than one that was simply bigger or faster.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[measured, building the argument]* There's a further clue in how quickly generations succeeded each other. Around this time, the average interval between a horse's birth and the birth of its offspring fell to roughly half its previous length. *[emphatic]* This isn't something that happens naturally. It only really makes sense if people were deliberately controlling breeding, choosing which animals mated, and when.

Lecturer: *[turning to a new point]* Now, the genetic evidence has also forced us to revisit the role of the Yamnaya people, who spread from the steppe into Europe from about three thousand BCE. *[slightly ironic]* There's a dramatic image, which you'll still find in popular books, of Yamnaya warriors galloping westwards on horseback.

Lecturer: *[firm]* Unfortunately for that picture, the horses found at the relevant sites don't belong to the modern domestic lineage at all. *[explaining]* What seems to have made the Yamnaya so mobile was not riding, but heavy wagons, drawn by oxen, which allowed whole families to move with their possessions.

Lecturer: *[picking up pace, animated]* Once the modern domestic horse had emerged, though, it spread extraordinarily fast, reaching Anatolia, central Europe and much of Asia within a few centuries after two thousand BCE. What drove that expansion? Not cavalry. Mounted warfare on any real scale comes considerably later. *[emphatic]* The key development was the chariot, a light, fast vehicle with spoked wheels, which turned the horse into a weapon of enormous prestige.

Lecturer: *[reflective, winding up]* So, to sum up. The Botai story isn't wrong, exactly, because the Botai clearly did manage horses in some way. But they turned out to be a side branch rather than the main trunk of the family tree. *[wry]* It's a useful reminder that archaeological evidence which seems to point clearly in one direction can be overturned very quickly by a new technique. *[brisk]* Next week, we'll look at what happened when horses reached the Americas.

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

The Domestication of the Horse

- 31** Botai culture (N. Kazakhstan, c. 3500 BCE): marks on horses' _____ suggested they were controlled with a bit
- 32** Traces of mare's _____ in pots suggested horses were kept alive
- 33** Chemicals found in the _____ indicated that horses were penned
- 34** Genetic study (2018): Przewalski's horses should now be classed as _____
- 35** Origin of today's domestic horses: area near the lower _____ and Don rivers, c. 2200 BCE
- 36** Early breeders favoured genes for a more powerful _____
- 37** Early breeders also favoured genes for more _____ behaviour
- 38** Shorter time between generations shows humans managed _____
- 39** Yamnaya expansion into Europe (from c. 3000 BCE): depended on ox-drawn _____ rather than horses
- 40** Rapid spread of domestic horses after 2000 BCE: main reason was the _____

FT07 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Rennison	The agent first reads the name back with a single N; Megan corrects it to a double N.
2	paramedic	She was formerly a receptionist, and people wrongly think she is a dental nurse.
3	23 / 23rd / twenty-third	Her tenancy ends on 31 July and her sister is away until mid-August.
4	950 / £950	She first says she put £900 on the online form.
5	rabbit	Dog and cat are both mentioned and denied with negatives ('Not a dog', 'it isn't a cat').
6	third / 3rd	The advert says second floor, which Daniel says is wrong.
7	lift	Parking and the boiler are mentioned straight afterwards but are not problems.
8	kitchen	The flat is said to be 'completely refurbished', but the bathroom and carpets are old.
9	bakery	Megan expects the trains to be noisy, but Daniel says they aren't the issue.
10	balcony	There used to be a shared garden, but it is now car parking.
11	C (an unexpected find in the building)	The anniversary (A) is denied ('It wasn't') and the Whitlock gift (B) was for a separate display.
12	A (It is arranged by the function of the maps.)	Date order (C) was considered and rejected; the loans from other continents (B) fell through.
13	C (Its age had been incorrectly recorded.)	The maker's name is known (A is the reverse), and the flood story (B) is said to be untrue.
14	C (explains the meaning of symbols.)	It isn't free (A), and the interviews with descendants (B) haven't been recorded yet.
15	B (The museum stays open late on a different day.)	Advance booking (A) was the original plan, now dropped; children still pay a reduced price (C).
16	G	Listeners may choose F, the window wall, which is rejected because light would fade the colours.
17	H	It was originally planned for the space between the entrance and the globe.
18	B	A, the case nearest the entrance, holds the Roman road maps.
19	C	The space under the stairs is ruled out, and D, near the shop door, is the children's trail.
20	E	The middle of the window wall (F) was the original plan but the floor isn't strong enough.
21	F (It competes with food production for land.)	Brittleness (B) and toxic by-products (D) are both raised and then dismissed by the tutor.
22	C (It has been unfairly criticised.)	Land clearance (F) is mentioned but called a myth; cost (A) is said to be low.
23	A (Its production costs remain too high.)	Seasonal supply (E) is suggested but rejected because it is farmed all year; strength (B) is fine.
24	G (It may have an unpleasant smell.)	Cost (A) is raised but Liam says 'the cost's fine'.
25	E (The raw material is only available at certain times of year.)	A fishy smell (G) is expected but denied; it is also said to be tough (not B).

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
26	B (It is too weak for many uses.)	Supply (E) and cost (A) are both mentioned and ruled out with negatives.
27	B (He was influenced by a film he had seen.)	The summer job (A) is dismissed, and his first choice (C) was still available.
28	C (Some visual information is unclear.)	The number of slides (A) is said to be about right and Liam's worry about wording (B) is rejected.
29	A (by describing a personal experiment)	Liam proposes both a statistic (C) and a question (B), and the tutor rejects each.
30	B (It fails to take a definite position.)	Liam worries it is too short (A), and the tutor says he hasn't brought in new material (C).
31	teeth / premolars	Legs and spine are mentioned first and ruled out with 'not from'.
32	milk	Fats from horse meat are mentioned first as what hunters would leave.
33	soil	Post holes are mentioned but called ambiguous; dung is the source, not the place the chemicals were found.
34	feral	They were long described as 'the last truly wild horse', a description now rejected.
35	Volga / volga	Anatolia and the Iberian Peninsula are mentioned as earlier, rejected proposals.
36	back	Speed is suggested and then denied ('It wasn't').
37	docile	'Bigger' and 'faster' are mentioned as less valuable qualities.
38	breeding	'Happens naturally' is mentioned and negated ('This isn't something that').
39	wagons / waggons	The popular image of warriors on horseback is rejected ('not riding').
40	chariot	Cavalry is suggested and denied ('Not cavalry') as it came later.

Listening Full Test 8

FT08 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	A Volunteer Conservation Week	Canadian (en-CA) organiser · British (en-GB) caller
2	Ashcombe Botanic Garden	British (en-GB)
3	Placements in a Theatre Costume Department	British (en-GB)
4	Ice Cores and Past Climate	British (en-GB)

A Volunteer Conservation Week

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · Canadian (en-CA) organiser · British (en-GB) caller

Scenario: A British woman phones a Canadian conservation organisation to enquire about a volunteer week of trail repair and wildlife surveys in a national park.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	Canadian (en-CA) organiser · British (en-GB) caller
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Greg	Volunteer coordinator — male, 40s, relaxed, friendly, outdoorsy; Canadian accent (en-CA)
Voice: Helen	Caller — female, early 30s, polite, curious, a little self-deprecating; British accent (en-GB)
Script length	5,968 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a woman phoning an organisation to ask about a volunteer conservation holiday. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 5. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Greg: *[a phone line clicks open] [warm, easy-going]* Good afternoon, Northwood Conservation Volunteers, Greg speaking. How can I help?

Helen: *[polite, slightly hesitant]* Oh, hello. I'm calling from England, actually, so, um, sorry if there's a bit of a delay on the line. I saw your website and I'm interested in one of the volunteer weeks in the national park.

Greg: *[friendly]* No problem at all, you're coming through fine. You'd be looking at Kettle Ridge, then. That's the only park we're working in this summer.

Helen: *[relieved]* Yes, that's the one. Could you tell me a bit about what the volunteers actually do? The website was a little bit vague.

Greg: *[light laugh]* Yeah, we keep meaning to update it. So basically there are two parts to it. Half the time you're out on the trails doing repairs, and the rest of the time you're helping our ecologists with wildlife surveys.

Helen: *[interested]* What kind of wildlife? I read something about birds.

Greg: *[explaining]* Right, that'd be the old page. For years the surveys were all about songbirds, counting nests, that kind of thing. And people still ask about the beavers, because they're kind of famous out there. But this season the funding's come through to study bats, so that's what all the survey work is focused on.

Helen: *[delighted]* Oh, I'd love that, actually. And the trail work, is that very heavy?

Greg: *[reassuring, but honest]* It's physical, I won't pretend it isn't. The park's had a lot of erosion. Last year the volunteers rebuilt the boardwalks across the wetland, so those are done. This year it's mainly the steeper sections up the ridge, where the old wooden steps have rotted, so you'd be pulling those out and putting new ones in.

Helen: *[thoughtful]* Right. OK. *[short pause]* And dates. I'm fairly flexible, but July would suit me best.

Greg: *[typing, murmuring]* July, let me pull that up. *[normal voice]* So each week runs Sunday to Saturday. The week starting the fifth is full, I'm afraid.

Helen: *[hopeful]* What about the twelfth?

Greg: *[checking, then apologetic]* The twelfth... I've got one place left. Oh, no, hang on, somebody reserved that this morning. Sorry about that. But the week beginning the nineteenth has plenty of room.

Helen: *[decisive]* The nineteenth, then. That's better, actually, because I've got a wedding on the twelfth anyway. *[chuckles]* I don't know why I suggested it.

Greg: *[laughs]* Fair enough. Now, cost. The standard fee is five hundred and sixty dollars for the week. That covers your accommodation, all your meals and transport inside the park.

Helen: *[checking]* Is that Canadian dollars?

Greg: *[matter-of-fact]* Canadian, yes. There is a reduced rate of four hundred and twenty for full-time students.

Helen: *[wry]* Ah. I finished university about ten years ago, so I don't think that one applies to me.

Greg: *[good-humoured]* Afraid not. And accommodation: a lot of people assume they'll be camping in tents, but we stopped doing that a few years back after some, ah, encounters with the local bears.

Helen: *[alarmed laugh]* Right!

Greg: *[chuckling]* So now everyone stays in a bunkhouse near the ranger station. There are a couple of log cabins on the site as well, but those are for the staff, unfortunately.

Helen: *[amused]* A bunkhouse. That sounds very Canadian.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 6 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Greg: *[practical]* So, packing. We'll email you a full list, but just so you know, we provide work gloves, hard hats and all the tools. Bedding's provided too, so you won't need a sleeping bag.

Helen: *[making a note]* Good, that saves on luggage. What about equipment for the bat surveys? Do I need anything special?

Greg: *[explaining]* The bat detectors, the electronic gadgets that pick up their calls, we lend you those. They're expensive and pretty delicate. But we've only got a few pairs of binoculars, and they're always in demand, so we do ask volunteers to bring their own.

Helen: *[thinking aloud]* I've got an old pair somewhere in the loft. *[brisk]* And do I need to be especially fit?

Greg: *[candid]* Reasonably. The guidance used to say you had to manage twenty kilometres a day on foot, which put a lot of people off, and frankly most days we weren't doing anything like that. So now we say you need to be comfortable hiking about twelve kilometres a day, with a pack.

Helen: *[confident]* Twelve's fine. I do a lot of walking at home.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Greg: *[businesslike]* Great. And in terms of paperwork, you don't need any first-aid qualification, all our team leaders are trained, but we do need a reference from your employer or a tutor, just saying you're reliable.

Helen: *[cheerful]* I can get one from my manager, no problem. Now, how would I actually get to the park? I'm assuming I'd fly into Toronto?

Greg: *[explaining]* Most people do, yeah. Then you'd take the train north. We used to pick people up at the airport, but it was a five-hour drive each way, so we don't do that any more. Instead there's a free shuttle bus from the train station in Pellatt.

Helen: *[unsure]* Sorry, could you spell that?

Greg: *[slowly, spelling each letter clearly]* Sure. P... E... double L... A... T... T.

Helen: *[repeating slowly, as if writing it down]* P, E, double L, A, double T. Got it.

Greg: *[helpful]* The shuttle leaves at four on the Sunday afternoon, so you'd want to be on the morning train.

Helen: *[thinking]* OK. And is there any free time during the week, or is it all work?

Greg: *[upbeat]* There's free time most evenings, and on the final day there's an optional trip. It used to be a boat cruise on the lake, but the operator went out of business, so now it's a canoe trip with one of the rangers. That's forty dollars extra. Or if you'd prefer, there's a guided hike that's free,

but honestly, most people have had enough of hiking by then.

Helen: *[laughs]* I can imagine. I'll go for the canoe trip, I think. *[short pause]* So what's the next step?

Greg: *[wrapping up, friendly]* I'll send you an application form by email. If I could just take your name and email address?

Helen: *[clearly]* It's Helen Marsh, and the email is helen dot marsh at our mail dot com, all one word.

Greg: *[reading back]* Helen dot marsh at ourmail dot com. Perfect. You should get that within the hour.

Helen: *[warm]* Brilliant. Thanks so much, Greg, you've been really helpful.

Greg: *[cheerful]* My pleasure. Hope we see you in July. Bye now.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-10

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

KETTLE RIDGE NATIONAL PARK — VOLUNTEER WEEKS

- 1 Wildlife surveys: this year's research is on _____
- 2 Trail repairs: replace rotten _____ on the steep slopes of the ridge
- 3 Week chosen: starts on Sunday _____ July
- 4 Fee: \$ _____ (includes all food)
- 5 Volunteers sleep in a _____ (not tents)
- 6 Volunteers must bring their own _____ (detectors are lent)
- 7 Fitness: should be able to walk around _____ km per day carrying a backpack
- 8 Need to provide a _____ (e.g. from a manager)
- 9 Free bus to the park from the railway station in _____
- 10 Last day: optional _____ trip (costs extra)

Ashcombe Botanic Garden

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A volunteer guide welcomes a group of visitors to a botanical garden, explains the map and describes what is happening in each glasshouse.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Marion	Volunteer guide — female, 60s, warm, enthusiastic, slightly projecting to a small group; British accent (en-GB)
Script length	5,915 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 2. You will hear a guide giving a talk to a group of visitors at a botanical garden. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 15. [post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Marion: *[faint chatter of a small group fading] [warm, welcoming, projecting slightly]* Good morning, everyone, and welcome to Ashcombe Botanic Garden. My name's Marion, and I'm one of the volunteer guides here. Before you head off and explore, I'll give you a quick introduction so you can make the most of your visit.

Marion: *[practical]* You should all have a copy of the map, which I'll talk you through in a moment. We're standing in the Visitor Centre, which is just inside the main entrance, on the left as you come in. The shop's in here too, so if you want to buy seeds or gifts, this is the place.

Marion: *[clear, guiding]* Now, if you look straight across the main path, directly opposite us, you'll see a low brick building with a green door. A lot of people assume that's another shop and wander in asking for packets of seeds. *[light laugh]* It isn't. That's our Seed Bank, where we store seeds from over four thousand species. It's open to the public every morning, and there's a small exhibition inside.

Marion: *[brisk]* Next, the café. If you were here a few years ago, you might remember it beside the lake, on the west shore. Well, it isn't there any more. That building was far too small. The new café is on Lime Avenue, which is the long, straight path running east from the lake towards the Walled Garden. As you walk along it, the café's on your right, so on the south side, about halfway along. *[light]* You can't miss it; there's a big terrace.

Marion: *[cheerful, a little louder]* Families, this is for you. The children's trail, which is a sort of treasure hunt with twelve wooden animals to find, used to begin here at the Visitor Centre, and I'm afraid the leaflet still says it does. *[apologetic]* The leaflets were printed before we changed things.

Marion: *[clear]* It now starts from that old café building I mentioned, on the western shore of the lake, right where the woodland begins. The trail then winds through the trees up to the bird hide in the north-west corner. So that's where it finishes, not where it starts.

Marion: *[enthusiastic]* Then there are our bees. We have six hives, and people often expect to find them in the Walled Garden, among all the flowers. *[chuckles]* And they used to be there, but they were a bit too close to the visitors for comfort. So they've moved to a quiet spot behind the Palm House. Go round the back of it and you'll find them right up against the northern boundary wall. There's a viewing screen, so you can watch them safely.

Marion: *[measured, regretful]* The little building right next to the Palm House, on its eastern side, is the Victorian fernery. Sadly, that's closed this year while the roof is repaired, so please don't try to go in.

Marion: *[clear]* And finally on the map, the Herb Garden. It's inside the Walled Garden, at the far end of Lime Avenue. Just before you go through the gate, on your left, there's a fenced area full of bins and heaps. That's our composting demonstration. Don't stop there! Go through the gate and carry on to the far right-hand corner, the north-eastern corner, and that's where the herbs are. *[warm]* It smells wonderful at this time of year.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 16 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Marion: *[shifting to a new topic, brightly]* Now let me tell you about our glasshouses, because each one has something a bit special going on at the moment.

Marion: *[proud]* The biggest, of course, is the Palm House. It's over a hundred and fifty years old, and it's home to some enormous palms and banana plants. *[apologetic laugh]* People always ask if they can try the bananas. I'm afraid you can't. They aren't really grown for eating. What you can do, though, is climb the spiral staircase to the gallery that runs right round the top of the building. From up there you're level with the crowns of the palms. It's quite a view.

Marion: *[lighter, informative]* Much smaller is the Alpine House. Alpine plants are tiny, so they're easy to overlook. We've put hand lenses on chains along the benches, so you can get a really close look at the flowers. Some are only a few millimetres across. *[matter-of-fact]* The Alpine House is also where we used to run our potting classes, but there wasn't enough room, so they've moved. I'll come back to that in a moment.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Marion: *[excited, dropping her voice slightly]* In the Desert House we have something of a celebrity. It's an agave, sometimes called the century plant, which was planted back in nineteen seventy-one and had never flowered. Until this month. It's sent up a flower spike nearly eight metres tall, and it won't happen again, because agaves die after flowering. So don't miss it.

Marion: *[slightly wistful]* Some of you may remember Arthur, the volunteer who used to give talks in the Desert House about the history of the glasshouses. He retired last spring, unfortunately, so if that's what you're interested in, you'll need the guidebook.

Marion: *[informative]* The Orchid House is kept very warm and humid, so you might want to take your coat off. Vanilla is actually an orchid, and visitors sometimes ask whether they can taste the vanilla we grow. *[light laugh]* Sadly not. Our vines are still far too young to produce pods.

Marion: *[engaged, explaining]* But the scientists there are working on some very rare orchids, and because the insects that normally pollinate them don't live in this country, the team has to do that job themselves, with a tiny paintbrush. On weekday mornings you can watch them at work through the window of the laboratory.

Marion: *[warm, amused]* And finally, the Water-lily House, with the giant lilies whose leaves can be two metres across. In Victorian times they used to sit small children on the leaves to show how strong they were. *[chuckles]* We don't do that any more, before anyone asks!

Marion: *[clear, inviting]* But this is now where those potting classes I mentioned take place. Every afternoon at two o'clock there's a free half-hour session where you can learn how to take cuttings and pot up a plant to take home. There's no need to book; just turn up.

Marion: *[wrapping up, friendly]* Right, I think that's everything. Do enjoy your visit!

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-15

Label the map below. Write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 11-15.

Ashcombe Botanic Garden

Plan (for the designer): Plan of a rectangular garden, north at the top. The Main Entrance is in the middle of the south (bottom) edge, with a Car Park outside it to the bottom right. A Main Path runs straight north from the Main Entrance to a large oval Lake in the centre of the garden. Just inside the entrance, on the WEST (left) side of the Main Path, is the labelled Visitor Centre. The western half of the garden north of the Visitor Centre is labelled Woodland. On the north side of the Lake is a large labelled building, the Palm House. Lime Avenue (labelled) is a straight path running east from the east shore of the Lake to the gate of the Walled Garden (labelled), a square enclosure occupying the north-east corner of the garden. Letters: A — a small building on the EAST side of the Main Path, directly opposite the Visitor Centre. B — a small building on the WEST shore of the Lake, at the edge of the Woodland. C — a small area immediately NORTH of (behind) the Palm House, against the northern boundary wall. D — a small building attached to the EAST side of the Palm House. E — inside the Walled Garden, in its far north-east corner. F — on the SOUTH side of Lime Avenue, about halfway along. G — on the NORTH side of Lime Avenue, just outside the Walled Garden gate. H — in the Woodland, in the north-west corner of the garden.

A	A
B	B
C	C
D	D
E	E
F	F
G	G
H	H

11 Seed Bank

12 Café

13 Start of children's trail

14 Beehives

15 Herb Garden

Questions 16-20

What can visitors see or do in each of the following glasshouses? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-G, next to Questions 16-20.

A	watch plants being pollinated by hand
B	sample produce grown there
C	join a short practical session
D	see a plant flowering for the first time since it was planted
E	examine very small flowers with a magnifying glass
F	view the tops of tall plants from a high position
G	listen to a volunteer describe the building's past

16 Palm House

17 Alpine House

18 Desert House

19 Orchid House

20 Water-lily House

Placements in a Theatre Costume Department

Academic/training discussion (2 students) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: Two drama students, Freya and Callum, evaluate the work placements they did in the costume department of a regional theatre and plan a presentation.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.45 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Freya	Student — female, about 21, thoughtful, articulate, quietly decisive; light Southern English accent (en-GB)
Voice: Callum	Student — male, about 22, lively, quick to react, often changes his mind; deeper voice, Northern English accent (en-GB)
Script length	5,707 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear two drama students, Freya and Callum, discussing the work placements they did in the costume department of a theatre. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 25. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Freya: *[friendly, settling in]* So, shall we make a start on this evaluation? It's due on Friday, and I'd quite like to get the presentation sorted out as well.

Callum: *[easy-going]* Yeah, go on. The form says reasons for choosing the placement first.

Freya: *[light laugh]* Well, you'll have to do that bit, because I didn't really have a choice. It was the only one left by the time I applied. Why did you go for costume? I always thought you were set on doing set design.

Callum: *[thinking back]* So did I, to be honest. And Dr Harmon did say costume might suit me better, because of my essay on fashion history, but I didn't take much notice at the time. What actually made up my mind was finding out the Riverside Playhouse was putting on that Restoration comedy. I'm completely obsessed with seventeenth-century clothes.

Freya: *[teasing]* And there was me thinking it was because your nan taught you to sew.

Callum: *[chuckles]* Well, she did, and it came in handy once I was there, but no, that's not why I applied.

Freya: *[brisk]* OK. First impressions next.

Callum: *[animated]* I remember being amazed by how early everything had to be ready. Finished costumes two whole weeks before the first night!

Freya: *[measured]* Mm, that didn't surprise me so much. Our lecturer had warned us about it. And I knew it'd be a small team, so there being only four of them wasn't a shock either. What really took me aback was the store room. I'd assumed they made everything from scratch for each show, but most of what they used had been worn before, in earlier productions, and was just altered and re-trimmed.

Callum: *[agreeing, amused]* Yeah, some of those coats must have been in about thirty plays.

Freya: *[moving on]* And then there's the section on supervision. Lorna, basically.

Callum: *[a little grumbling]* I mean, she's brilliant, but I did think she asked too much of us sometimes. Expecting us to finish a whole bodice in a day...

Freya: *[disagreeing, gently]* I don't think that's fair. She never asked for anything she hadn't shown us first. If anything, I'd say she was better with a needle than with words. She'd just do things rather than explain them.

Callum: *[firm]* No, I can't agree with that. Her explanations were really clear. It's just that she talked incredibly fast.

Freya: *[conceding, laughing]* Fair enough. But one thing we definitely agree on is that she trusted us with far more than I'd expected. I was altering a costume for the lead actor in my second week!

Callum: *[warmly]* Absolutely. I never thought they'd let me anywhere near the main cast.

Freya: *[sighs]* Now, difficulties. For me, the hardest thing at first was the jargon. Toiles, basques, breaking down. I had to keep a glossary in the back of my notebook.

Callum: *[shrugging]* That didn't bother me. I'd picked most of it up from Nan. The evening shifts were what got me... *[correcting himself]* actually, no, they weren't too bad once I'd got used to them. I'm a night owl anyway.

Freya: *[thoughtful]* I didn't mind them at all. I liked being there during the show. But what we both struggled with was the reflective log.

Callum: *[groans]* Oh, don't. I was writing up three days at a time on a Sunday night.

Freya: *[rueful]* Same. There just wasn't a spare moment in the day to sit down and write anything.

Callum: *[moving on]* OK, and the presentation. I wondered about comparing costume for the stage with costume for film.

Freya: *[doubtful]* Neither of us has done any film work, though. We'd just be guessing.

Callum: *[conceding]* True. What about sustainability, then? All that re-using of costumes you were talking about?

Freya: *[hesitant]* I did think about that, but Dr Harmon said last year's group did exactly that topic, and she'd rather we didn't repeat it.

Callum: *[thinking aloud]* Right. Then how about how costume affects the way actors play a part? Remember Daniel saying he couldn't find his character until he'd put on those boots?

Freya: *[enthusiastic]* Yes! We've got loads of examples like that. Let's go with it.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at Questions 26 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Callum: *[upbeat]* Right, the section on tasks. Dyeing and ageing the fabric, the breaking down, was easily my favourite thing.

Freya: *[wry]* Not mine. I came home covered in dye every day. *[short pause]* But it'd be perfect for the final-year project, wouldn't it? Making a costume look as if it's been worn for years.

Callum: *[decisive]* Definitely. Let's put that down. We'll both build it into our projects.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Freya: *[thoughtful]* Fittings next. We'd sort of done measuring on the course, but only on each other, which isn't the same as dealing with a nervous actor at all.

Callum: *[agreeing]* No. And if we end up as wardrobe assistants, which is what we're both aiming for, that's what we'd be doing all day long.

Freya: So it's directly relevant. Yes.

Callum: *[doubtful]* The running repairs during performances... I'd expected that to teach us a lot, you know, quick fixes under pressure.

Freya: *[sighs]* But it was mostly sewing buttons back on. It wasn't nearly as useful as I'd thought it would be.

Callum: Would you want more practice at it?

Freya: *[laughs]* Hardly. I've sewn on enough buttons for a lifetime.

Freya: *[keen]* Pattern cutting, though, that's different. We only ever got to watch Lorna doing it.

Callum: *[eager]* I know. I'd love to do a proper course in it. *[hesitant]* Could we use it in the project?

Freya: *[doubtful]* Not unless we get a lot better at it first. It'd be far too ambitious. But yes, we should both ask the department about extra tuition.

Callum: *[dismissive]* And finally, the inventory. Logging every single costume in the database. I thought that was a complete waste of time.

Freya: *[disagreeing]* At first I did too. But when the director wanted that green cloak from three years ago, it took five minutes to find, purely because of the records.

Callum: *[conceding slowly]* OK, that's true. It's not that it was pointless. It's that nobody ever told us why we were doing it.

Freya: *[decisive]* Exactly. So we should recommend that next year's students get that explained at the start.

Callum: *[relieved]* Agreed. Right, I think that's the form done. Coffee?

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-25

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 21** Why did Callum choose a placement in the costume department?
- A** He already had some sewing skills.
 - B** He wanted to work on a play set in a particular historical period.
 - C** His tutor told him it would match his strengths.
- 22** What surprised Freya when she began her placement?
- A** the small number of staff
 - B** the amount of clothing that had been used before
 - C** the early deadline for completing costumes
- 23** What do the students agree about Lorna, their supervisor?
- A** She made unreasonable demands on students.
 - B** Her practical skills were stronger than her teaching.
 - C** She gave students more responsibility than they had anticipated.
- 24** What difficulty did both students experience?
- A** keeping their placement diary up to date
 - B** working late in the evenings
 - C** learning the specialist vocabulary
- 25** What will the students' presentation be about?
- A** differences between stage and screen costume
 - B** ways of reducing waste in costume departments
 - C** the influence of costume on an actor's performance

Questions 26-30

What do the students decide about each of the following tasks they did on their placement? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A–G, next to Questions 26–30.

A	They will make use of it in their final-year work.
B	They would like further instruction in it.
C	It was less valuable than they had predicted.
D	It is closely linked to the careers they want.
E	They both found it the most enjoyable task.
F	Its purpose should be made clear to future students.
G	They had already covered it fully on their course.

- 26** dyeing and ageing fabric
- 27** fitting costumes on actors
- 28** repairing costumes during performances
- 29** pattern cutting
- 30** recording items in a database

Ice Cores and Past Climate

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A lecturer in physical geography explains how glacier ice forms, how ice cores are dated and analysed, and what they reveal about past climate.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.55 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	University lecturer — male, 50s, authoritative, engaging, dry humour, measured pace; British RP (en-GB)
Script length	5,733 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about how glaciers and ice cores record past climate. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. [post: 45 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture theatre, faint murmur fading] [clear, engaging]* Good morning. Last week we looked at tree rings and lake sediments as records of past climate. Today I want to turn to what is, arguably, the richest archive of all, and that's the ice locked up in glaciers and ice sheets.

Lecturer: *[measured, explaining]* Let's start with how glacier ice actually forms. Snow that survives the summer melt is gradually buried by later falls, and under that weight it's compressed into a dense, granular material. You'll sometimes see the French word *névé* used for it, but the term glaciologists generally prefer is *firn*, that's F-I-R-N. Firn is no longer snow, but it isn't yet ice either.

Lecturer: *[deliberate]* Over decades, as the firn is pressed down further, the gaps between the grains close up, and the air in them is sealed off in tiny bubbles. *[emphatic]* And those bubbles are the key point. People sometimes imagine the old air is somehow dissolved into the ice. It isn't. It's physically trapped, as genuine samples of the ancient atmosphere.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful aside]* One complication, incidentally: while the firn is still porous, air can circulate within it, so the gas in a bubble is always somewhat younger than the ice that surrounds it. We correct for that, but it's worth bearing in mind.

Lecturer: *[brisk]* So, how do we date an ice core? Near the top, we can simply count annual layers, rather like counting tree rings. Now, students often assume the layers show up because of differences in colour. *[slight smile in voice]* It isn't so much colour as dust. Snow that falls in spring and early summer contains a lot more of it, blown in from dry regions, so each year shows up as a slightly cloudier band.

Lecturer: *[serious]* Further down, though, the layers are squeezed so thin that counting becomes impossible. So we look for marker horizons. Large volcanic eruptions are ideal. You might expect us to look for ash, but ash rarely travels that far. What does reach the poles is acid, carried in the atmosphere and then deposited in the snow, and we can detect it by passing an electric current along the core.

Lecturer: *[informative]* If we know the date of the eruption, from historical records for example, we have a fixed point in the core. The eruption of Tambora, in Indonesia, in eighteen fifteen is a classic example. It shows up clearly in cores from both poles, and it's linked in written accounts to the so-called year without a summer, when harvests failed across much of Europe.

Lecturer: *[reflective]* Between these fixed points, we also use computer models of how ice flows and thins with depth. They're not perfect, and you'll find that published ages for the deepest ice can differ by several thousand years, depending on the team. But taken together, these methods give us a timescale we can have reasonable confidence in.

Lecturer: *[clear, slowing slightly]* Now to temperature. Water molecules come in slightly different weights, depending on which isotopes they contain. Isotopes of hydrogen are sometimes measured as a cross-check, but the standard measure is oxygen. Specifically, we look at the ratio of heavy oxygen to the normal, lighter form.

Lecturer: *[explaining]* The colder the air, the fewer heavy molecules make it as far as the ice sheet, so a lower ratio means a colder climate. It's an indirect method, but a remarkably reliable one.

Lecturer: *[emphatic]* Then there are the gases in those bubbles. Two in particular matter. Carbon dioxide, of course, and also methane, which is produced largely by wetlands, so it tells us a great deal about rainfall in the tropics. *[dry]* Nitrogen, by contrast, makes up most of the air in the bubbles, but since its level hardly changes, it's of very little use to us.

Lecturer: *[measured]* What these gas records show, quite strikingly, is that carbon dioxide and temperature have risen and fallen together throughout the last eight hundred thousand years.

Lecturer: *[comparative]* Where do the cores come from? The longest continuous record we have, covering roughly eight hundred thousand years, comes from Antarctica, where snowfall is so light that a great many years are packed into each metre. Greenland is different. Its cores cover a much shorter period, and they can't compete on length. What Greenland offers instead is detail. The heavier snowfall means each year's layer is thick enough to examine individually, even season by season.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[shifting focus]* It isn't only the polar ice sheets that matter. High mountain glaciers, in the Andes and the Himalayas, for instance, preserve their own records. *[qualifying]* These are less useful for temperature than you might think, because local conditions vary so much. Their real value is as a record of rainfall, particularly the strength of the monsoon over past centuries.

Lecturer: *[grave]* Unfortunately, many of these glaciers are melting so fast that their records are being lost before we can study them. In the past, cores were simply sent to laboratory freezers, mostly in Europe and North America. But freezers fail, and funding runs out. So a recent international project has started storing duplicate cores in Antarctica, in a cave dug into the snow, where the temperature stays below minus fifty degrees without any machinery at all.

Lecturer: *[looking ahead, enthusiastic]* Finally, the frontier of the field. Several teams are now drilling in search of ice one and a half million years old. Why? Because at some point around a million years ago, the pattern of ice ages changed. *[deliberate]* They didn't become more frequent. In fact, the reverse is true. They became less frequent, but each one was longer and considerably more severe.

Lecturer: *[thoughtful]* Nobody yet knows why, and ice from that period may well hold the answer. *[wrapping up]* Next week we'll look at the methods used to drill and transport these cores, which is a story in itself.

Narrator: *That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.*
[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

Ice cores as records of past climate

- 31** Formation of glacier ice: compressed snow that has lasted a summer becomes _____ (the preferred scientific term), and later ice
- 32** Samples of ancient air are held in very small _____ within the ice
- 33** Dating — upper ice: annual bands can be seen because seasonal snow contains extra _____
- 34** Dating — deeper ice: volcanic eruptions leave a layer of _____
- 35** Temperature: usual method compares heavy and light isotopes of _____
- 36** Gases: CO₂ and _____ (gives evidence about tropical wetlands)
- 37** Greenland cores: cover fewer years than Antarctic ones but provide more _____
- 38** Mountain glaciers: mainly valuable for information about past _____
- 39** Copies of cores now kept in Antarctica in a _____
- 40** About a million years ago, ice ages became longer and more _____

FT08 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	bats	Birds (the old surveys) and beavers (famous in the park) are both mentioned first.
2	steps	Boardwalks are mentioned, but they were rebuilt last year.
3	19 / 19th / nineteenth	The fifth is full and the last place on the twelfth has just been taken; Helen also has a wedding on the twelfth.
4	560 / \$560	The student rate of 420 is mentioned, but Helen is not a student.
5	bunkhouse	Tents were used in the past; the log cabins are only for staff.
6	binoculars	Gloves, hard hats, tools, bedding and bat detectors are all supplied.
7	12 / twelve	The old guidance said twenty kilometres.
8	reference	A first-aid qualification is mentioned but is not required ('you don't need').
9	Pellatt	Airport pick-ups used to be offered but have stopped; name spelled with two double letters.
10	canoe	The boat cruise no longer runs and the guided hike is free.
11	A (A)	Listeners may think the seed shop is opposite, but the shop is in the Visitor Centre itself.
12	F (F)	The café used to be on the west shore of the lake (B).
13	B (B)	The leaflet says the Visitor Centre, and the bird hide (H) is where the trail finishes.
14	C (C)	The hives used to be in the Walled Garden; the fernery (D) is beside the Palm House, not behind it.
15	E (E)	The composting area (G) is just outside the gate on the left.
16	F (view the tops of tall plants from a high position)	Bananas grow there but visitors cannot try them (B).
17	E (examine very small flowers with a magnifying glass)	Potting classes (C) used to be held here but have moved.
18	D (see a plant flowering for the first time since it was planted)	History talks (G) used to be given here, but the volunteer has retired.
19	A (watch plants being pollinated by hand)	Visitors ask to taste the vanilla (B), but the vines are too young.
20	C (join a short practical session)	Children sitting on the leaves is a Victorian practice that no longer happens; the classes were formerly in the Alpine House.
21	B (He wanted to work on a play set in a particular historical period.)	His tutor's suggestion (C) was ignored at the time, and his sewing (A) helped later but 'that's not why I applied'.
22	B (the amount of clothing that had been used before)	The deadline surprised Callum, not Freya; she expected a small team.
23	C (She gave students more responsibility than they had anticipated.)	A is only Callum's view and Freya rejects it; B is only Freya's view and Callum rejects it.
24	A (keeping their placement diary up to date)	The jargon was hard only for Freya; Callum starts to complain about evening shifts but corrects himself, and Freya liked them.
25	C (the influence of costume on an actor's performance)	Film is rejected for lack of experience; sustainability is rejected because last year's group did it.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
26	A (They will make use of it in their final-year work.)	It was Callum's favourite task, but not Freya's (E).
27	D (It is closely linked to the careers they want.)	They did measuring on the course, but 'only on each other', so G is wrong.
28	C (It was less valuable than they had predicted.)	Callum asks about more practice (B), but Freya says 'Hardly'.
29	B (They would like further instruction in it.)	Callum suggests using it in the project (A), but Freya says it would be too ambitious.
30	F (Its purpose should be made clear to future students.)	Callum first calls it a waste of time (C), then changes his mind.
31	firn	The French word névé is mentioned but is not the preferred term.
32	bubbles	The lecturer rejects the idea that the air is dissolved in the ice.
33	dust	Colour is the common assumption, rejected with 'isn't so much... as'.
34	acid	Ash is expected but 'rarely travels that far'.
35	oxygen	Hydrogen isotopes are mentioned but only as an occasional cross-check.
36	methane	Nitrogen is the most abundant gas but is of little use.
37	detail	Length is Antarctica's advantage, not Greenland's.
38	rainfall	Temperature is mentioned but they are 'less useful for temperature than you might think'.
39	cave	Cores were formerly stored in laboratory freezers in Europe and North America.
40	severe	'They didn't become more frequent' — frequent is the negated distractor.

Listening Full Test 9

FT09 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Ordering Food for a Staff Lunch	British (en-GB)
2	Volunteering at a Community Radio Station	Australian (en-AU)
3	Choosing Archaeology Modules	British (en-GB) tutor and student; South African English student
4	Desalination Technologies	British (en-GB)

Ordering Food for a Staff Lunch

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: An office manager at an architects' practice phones a catering company to order food for a staff lunch.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Gareth	Catering company order-taker — male, 30s, warm, efficient, slightly chatty; British accent
Voice: Helen	Office manager — female, 40s, friendly, organised but busy; British accent
Script length	5,790 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear an office manager phoning a catering company to order food for a staff event. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 4. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Gareth: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [warm, professional]* Good morning, Saffron and Thyme Catering, Gareth speaking. How can I help?

Helen: *[friendly, slightly rushed]* Oh, hello. I'm ringing from Corran Design, the architects' practice on the Quayside. I'm the office manager, and I'd like to order some food for a staff lunch we're holding.

Gareth: *[pleased]* Lovely. I'll just open a new order form, then. *[short pause]* Right. Could I take your name first?

Helen: It's Helen. Helen Dannatt.

Gareth: *[careful]* And how do you spell the surname?

Helen: *[slowly, spelling each letter clearly]* D... A... double N... A... double T. *[light laugh]* People usually put one N and one T, so it's worth checking.

Gareth: *[repeating it as he types]* D... A... double N... A... double T. Got it. And the date of the event?

Helen: *[thinking aloud]* Well, it was going to be Friday the twenty-first of November, but half the team are away at a conference that week, so we've pushed it back by seven days. *[decisive]* So it's Friday the twenty-eighth now.

Gareth: *[typing]* The twenty-eighth. That's fine, we've still got space in the diary for that day. *[casual]* And roughly how many people are we feeding?

Helen: *[hesitant, working it out]* Um, there are sixty of us on the payroll, but eight people are on annual leave that week, so that leaves fifty-two... *[correcting herself]* oh, and I mustn't forget the three trustees from our board. They always come to these things.

Gareth: *[checking]* So fifty-two plus three...

Helen: *[confirming]* Fifty-five, yes. *[wry]* Better to have too much than too little with this lot.

Gareth: *[chuckles]* That's what we always say. Now, timing. When does the lunch actually start?

Helen: *[matter-of-fact]* We'll sit down at half past twelve. *[thinking]* I was going to say bring it at noon, but the meeting room's free from eleven fifteen, and I'd rather have a bit of breathing space to lay everything out. Could the food be with us by quarter to twelve at the very latest?

Gareth: *[reassuring]* Eleven forty-five. No problem at all. Our vans usually leave the kitchen by eleven, so that's very comfortable.

Helen: *[relieved]* Great.

Gareth: *[practical]* And just so I've got it for the driver, is there parking at your building?

Helen: *[apologetic]* Not at the front, I'm afraid, it's all double yellow lines. But there's a loading bay round the back, off Ropewalk Lane, and the driver can stop there for twenty minutes.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 5 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Gareth: *[brisk, helpful]* Right, let's talk about menus. For a group your size we offer three options, and I'll go through each one so you can compare. The first is what we call the Working Lunch.

Helen: *[interested]* Is that sandwiches?

Gareth: *[explaining]* Mostly, yes, sandwiches and wraps, with a fruit platter and crisps. *[slightly amused]* We used to make all the sandwiches on rye bread, but quite a few customers found it a bit heavy, so these days everything's made on sourdough. You can ask for white, but there's a small extra charge.

Helen: *[decisive]* No, the sourdough sounds fine. And the price for that one?

Gareth: *[reading from a list]* That's... nine pounds fifty a head. *[short pause]* *[correcting himself, a little embarrassed]* Oh, hang on, sorry, I'm looking at last year's sheet. It went up in September. It's nine pounds seventy-five now.

Helen: *[good-humoured sigh]* Nine seventy-five. Everything's gone up. What about the second option?

Gareth: *[enthusiastic]* That's our Hot Buffet, which is very popular in winter. The main dish is a Moroccan-style tagine served with couscous and flatbreads. *[clarifying]* Now, if you've seen our website, it'll say it's made with chicken, but that page is out of date. We switched to lamb in the summer, and we do a chickpea version for vegetarians.

Helen: *[thinking aloud]* Lamb... I suppose most people will eat that. Does it need an oven or anything? Because we've only got a tiny kitchenette.

Gareth: *[reassuring]* No, you won't need an oven, and you don't need a sink either, we take all the dishes away dirty. The food arrives in heated trays, but they have to be plugged in to keep warm, so all we'd ask for is a socket close to wherever the serving table is going to be.

Helen: *[considering]* There's one right next to the window, so that's fine. And price?

Gareth: *[clearly]* Eleven pounds a head, and that includes a dessert, usually an apple crumble.

Helen: *[warmly]* Mm, that's tempting. And the third?

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Gareth: *[lively]* The third is our Mezze Platters. It's a big sharing selection: falafel, grilled halloumi, stuffed vine leaves, salads, warm pitta. *[explaining]* It comes with three dips. Hummus isn't one of them, actually, because people expect it and it's always left over. So instead we do a yoghurt and mint dip, a smoky aubergine, and our signature one, which is beetroot with a little horseradish.

Helen: *[surprised]* Beetroot! That sounds different.

Gareth: *[light laugh]* It's the one people ring up to ask for the recipe for.

Helen: *[cautious]* And is that the most expensive option?

Gareth: *[honest]* It is, normally. The standard price is thirteen ninety per person. *[short pause]* But we've got an offer on at the moment: for orders of more than fifty people, we take a flat one pound fifty off each head.

Helen: *[working it out]* So for us that would be...

Gareth: *[confirming]* Twelve pounds forty a head. *[short pause]* I mean, it's not a ten per cent discount, which is what most people assume, but it works out about the same.

Helen: *[concerned]* And whichever we choose, I've got two colleagues who are gluten-free and one who's vegan. Is that going to be a problem?

Gareth: *[reassuring, easy]* Not at all. We just need the numbers a week in advance, and their meals come separately wrapped and labelled with their names, so nobody else helps themselves by mistake.

Helen: *[thinking aloud]* Twelve forty. Hmm. Look, I'll need to run all three past my director before I commit. Could you email me the details?

Gareth: *[obliging]* Of course. I'll send it to the address you give me, and we'll hold the date for a week without a deposit.

Helen: *[relieved, wrapping up]* Perfect. Thanks so much, Gareth, you've been really helpful.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 1. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 1. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-4

Complete the form below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

SAFFRON AND THYME CATERING — ORDER FORM

- 1** Customer: Helen (1) _____ (office manager, Corran Design)
2 Date of event: Friday (2) _____ November
3 Number of guests: (3) _____
4 Food must arrive no later than: (4) _____ a.m.

Questions 5-10

Complete the table below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Menu options

Option	Food	Other information	Price per person
Working Lunch	sandwiches and wraps made with (5) _____ bread	white bread costs extra	£(6) _____
Hot Buffet	(7) _____ tagine with couscous	customer must provide a (8) _____ near the table	£11 (includes dessert)
Mezze Platters	falafel, halloumi, salads etc.	most popular dip: (9) _____ and horseradish	£(10) _____ (more than 50 guests)

- 5** Working Lunch — type of bread
6 Working Lunch — price per person
7 Hot Buffet — main ingredient of the tagine
8 Hot Buffet — what the customer must provide
9 Mezze Platters — main ingredient of the best-known dip
10 Mezze Platters — price per person for the larger group

Volunteering at a Community Radio Station

Monologue in an everyday social context (1 speaker) · Australian (en-AU)

Scenario: The manager of a community radio station talks to people interested in volunteering.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	Australian (en-AU)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Station Manager	Kirsty Lowell, station manager — female, 40s, warm, energetic, down-to-earth; Australian accent
Script length	5,500 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 2. You will hear the manager of a community radio station talking to a group of people who are interested in becoming volunteers. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 15.*
[post: 30 s pause]

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Station Manager: *[small meeting room, chatter settling] [warm, energetic]* G'day, everyone, and thanks so much for coming out on a wet Tuesday night. I'm Kirsty Lowell, and I'm the station manager here at Riverbend FM. I'll give you a bit of background first, and then I'll run through the different volunteer roles, so you can work out where you might fit in.

Station Manager: *[relaxed, storytelling]* Now, a lot of people assume we started out as a sports station, because these days we're probably best known for our Saturday footy commentary. *[light laugh]* But that didn't come along until the mid-nineties. And yes, we run a well-regarded training scheme for young reporters, but that's fairly recent too.

Station Manager: *[sincere, slightly slower]* The station was actually founded back in nineteen eighty-three by a handful of Greek and Vietnamese families in the valley who couldn't hear any news or music in their own languages. That's still at the heart of what we do: we broadcast in eleven languages every week.

Station Manager: *[practical, frank]* People often ask how we pay the bills. *[short pause]* For years we relied on a grant from the local council, but that came to an end three years ago, and it hasn't been replaced. Advertising isn't really an option, because our licence only lets us run a few minutes of sponsorship an hour. So these days, the lion's share of our income comes from our members, the ordinary listeners who pay fifty dollars a year to keep us on air.

Station Manager: *[candid, a little rueful]* So what's our biggest challenge right now? Well, you might have heard that our transmitter is ancient. *[chuckles]* It is, but it was repaired last month and it's running fine. And our audience isn't shrinking either, in fact the latest survey shows it's grown. *[serious]* No, what keeps me awake at night is filling the unpopular slots. The overnight shows and the early weekday mornings are really hard to staff, and that's where we need you most.

Station Manager: *[clear, instructive]* Once you've signed up, there's a set process. You might expect to go straight into a studio and sit in with one of our presenters. That does happen, but not until a bit later. We also have a short online course about broadcasting law, which we used to insist on, but it's optional now, because frankly hardly anyone finished it.

Station Manager: *[firm but friendly]* What isn't optional is the induction evening. Before you touch any equipment, our chief technician takes every single new volunteer through fire procedures and

electrical safety. No exceptions, even if you've worked in radio before.

Station Manager: *[upbeat]* And a quick word about where you'll be working. As some of you know, we moved into our new premises in March. *[amused]* Lots of people think we moved to be closer to town. Actually, we're a little further out than before. The old building had a steep flight of stairs up to the studio, which shut out a lot of people, whereas here everything's on the ground floor and it's completely step-free. *[warm]* The move itself was paid for by a bequest from a long-time listener, although the builder did give us a generous discount.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 16 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Station Manager: *[shifting gear, brisk]* Right, let's go through the roles. First of all, newsreaders. We put out a five-minute local bulletin every hour from six until nine in the morning. *[matter-of-fact]* You might think we'd ask for a journalism qualification. We don't. Our trainers will teach you everything. What does matter is that if a reader calls in sick, we ring round at about half past five, so you need to be the sort of person who can drop everything and come in at very little notice.

Station Manager: *[enthusiastic]* Then there are technical assistants, who help with the desk during live shows and keep the equipment running. Again, you don't need any formal qualifications, but we invest a huge amount of time training you, so in return we ask you to stay with us for at least twelve months. *[reassuring]* You won't be called in at the last minute, though; we've got plenty of cover there.

Station Manager: *[light laugh]* Now, music presenters. Everyone wants to be a music presenter. *[short pause]* We used to hold voice auditions for this, but we found they put off a lot of perfectly good people, so we've dropped them. Instead, what we absolutely insist on is that you come along to the programme meeting every Tuesday evening, without fail, because that's where the schedule and the playlists are agreed.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Station Manager: *[conversational]* Next, our online content team, who look after the website, the podcasts and our social media. *[informative]* This role is ideal if you've got other commitments, because almost all of it is done on your own laptop in your own home. The team does get together face to face, but only about once a month, so it's very flexible.

Station Manager: *[lively]* And finally, events and fundraising. This team runs our stalls at the farmers' markets and organises the annual radiothon. *[emphatic]* Pretty much all of that happens on Saturdays and Sundays, so we do ask that you can give us at least one weekend a month. You don't need to commit for a year, and you won't need to come to the weekly meetings, but those weekends are essential.

Station Manager: *[sincere]* Whichever team you join, you'll get a reference from us after six months, and quite a few of our volunteers have gone on to paid jobs in commercial radio and even television. *[proud]* One of our former newsreaders now presents the evening news on a national network, and she still drops in to say hello.

Station Manager: *[warm, wrapping up]* So, have a think about which of those appeals. There are forms on the table at the back, and I'll be around for a cuppa afterwards if you'd like a chat.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 2. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 2. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 2 · Questions 11–20

Questions 11–15

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 11** Riverbend FM was first set up in order to
- A** provide coverage of local sports.
 - B** serve communities who did not speak English as a first language.
 - C** give young journalists practical experience.
- 12** Most of the station's income now comes from
- A** local government.
 - B** advertisers.
 - C** listeners who pay an annual fee.
- 13** According to the manager, the station's main problem at present is
- A** unreliable broadcasting equipment.
 - B** finding people to work at certain times.
 - C** a fall in the number of listeners.
- 14** What must all new volunteers do first?
- A** attend a session on safety
 - B** observe an experienced presenter at work
 - C** complete a course on the internet
- 15** What does the manager say about the station's new premises?
- A** They are more central than the old building.
 - B** They are easier for disabled people to use.
 - C** They were paid for by a local company.

Questions 16–20

What does the manager say about each volunteer role? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A–G, next to Questions 16–20.

A	requires a commitment of at least one year
B	requires availability at short notice
C	requires a relevant qualification
D	involves regular weekend work
E	involves passing a voice test
F	can mainly be done from home
G	requires attendance at a weekly meeting

- 16** newsreader
17 technical assistant
18 music presenter
19 online content
20 events and fundraising

Choosing Archaeology Modules

Academic discussion: 2 students + tutor (3 speakers) · British (en-GB) tutor and student; South African English student

Scenario: Two archaeology students discuss their choice of optional modules with their tutor.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB) tutor and student; South African English student
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Dr Pryce	Tutor — male, 50s, kind, measured, dryly humorous; British accent
Voice: Lerato	Student — female, early 20s, eager, conscientious; South African English accent (fallback: British)
Voice: Callum	Student — male, early 20s, enthusiastic, a bit sceptical; British accent
Script length	6,291 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 3. You will hear two archaeology students, Lerato and Callum, talking to their tutor about which optional modules to take next year. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 25. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Dr Pryce: *[office, door closing softly] [kind, measured]* Come in, both of you, have a seat. So, you've had a look at the list of optional modules for next year?

Lerato: *[eager]* We have. We've each got a shortlist, but we wanted your view before we commit.

Dr Pryce: *[warm]* Of course. Where do you want to start?

Callum: *[enthusiastic]* Maritime Archaeology. I've been looking forward to it since first year.

Dr Pryce: *[thoughtful]* It's a lovely module. And people tend to worry it'll clash with something, but it's on a Friday, so it doesn't. *[cautionary]* The thing you do need to know is that it isn't the workload that puts students off. It's that you have to pay for your own dive training and certification before the second term, and that's several hundred pounds.

Callum: *[deflated]* Ah. I hadn't realised that wasn't covered.

Dr Pryce: *[sympathetic]* Some students apply to the department's travel fund, which can help a little, but it rarely covers the whole amount, so do budget for it.

Lerato: *[moving on, brisk]* My first choice is Human Osteology.

Dr Pryce: *[approving, then serious]* Good choice. Now, students often assume that because it's about bones, it's mostly memorising names. It's a great deal tougher than that. You're estimating age and sex from fragments, and the lab tests are notoriously hard. *[reassuring]* On the other hand, you don't need a science background for it, whatever people say. Several of our best osteologists did history at school.

Lerato: *[relieved laugh]* That's good to hear, because I didn't.

Callum: *[curious]* What about Archaeological Illustration? I've heard it's brilliant for getting jobs.

Dr Pryce: *[dry, gently correcting]* Well, it's a wonderful skill, but I wouldn't say it's a route into commercial work these days; most units use digital survey now. *[practical]* The bigger issue is that it only takes twelve students, and you need to submit a portfolio of drawings in May to get a place.

Callum: *[thinking aloud]* Twelve. Hmm. Then I'd better start sketching.

Lerato: *[considering]* And Heritage Management? Someone told me it's been completely rewritten.

Dr Pryce: *[light laugh]* I'm afraid someone told you wrong; it's much the same as last year. *[emphatic]* But it's the module I'd recommend if you want to work for one of the contract archaeology firms. When they're interviewing graduates, that's the one they ask about, because so much of their work involves planning applications.

Callum: *[interested]* And finally Archaeometry, the scientific dating one.

Dr Pryce: *[enthusiastic]* Ah, that's had a real overhaul. There's a new convenor, and she's redesigned it from top to bottom: new practicals, new assessment, the lot. *[clarifying]* There was a timetable clash with the fieldwork module last year, but that's been sorted out now.

Callum: *[thinking aloud]* So if I want Maritime and Archaeometry, there's nothing stopping me doing both?

Dr Pryce: *[confirming]* Nothing at all, as far as the timetable's concerned. *[short pause]* *[gently]* Just bear in mind what I said about the diving costs before you sign up.

Lerato: *[teasing]* He'll be selling his bike to pay for it.

Callum: *[chuckles]* Don't give me ideas.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 26 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Dr Pryce: *[conversational]* Callum, you were on the excavation in Northumberland this summer, weren't you? How did you find it?

Callum: *[reflective]* Well, I spent most of it in the finds shed rather than out on site. I thought I'd hate that, but honestly, I didn't mind it at all. *[wry]* And the recording system was a bit chaotic at first, but the supervisor sorted it out in the first week. *[more serious]* What it really did was make me rethink things. I'd always assumed I'd stay on and do a PhD, but now I'd much rather work in the field professionally.

Dr Pryce: *[thoughtful]* That's a useful thing to find out early. Lerato, you mentioned taking both Osteology and Archaeometry?

Lerato: *[hesitant]* Yes, but I'm worried that two lab-based modules might be too much at once.

Dr Pryce: *[reassuring, measured]* I wouldn't put you off. It's not that the workload's unmanageable, plenty of students have done it, but that's not really my point. And it won't restrict which dissertation you can do, either. *[warm]* The thing is, they genuinely complement each other. The lab techniques overlap, so each one makes the other easier. If anything, I'd encourage it.

Lerato: *[pleased]* Oh, that's good.

Dr Pryce: *[practical]* And how's your dissertation proposal coming along? The deadline's the end of January.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Lerato: *[confident, then worried]* The deadline's fine, I've got a draft already. And I know the topic's still a bit broad...

Dr Pryce: *[interrupting gently]* That's quite normal at this stage. We'll narrow it down together.

Lerato: *[anxious]* Right. *[sighs]* What really bothers me is the Hartfield collection. The whole project depends on examining those burial goods, and the museum's closed for refurbishment until at least the spring. I'm not sure I'll be able to see them in time.

Dr Pryce: *[thoughtful]* Mm. Let me make some enquiries. The curator's an old colleague of mine.

Callum: *[changing topic]* Can I ask about assessment? A lot of these modules are assessed by portfolio instead of exams.

Lerato: *[enthusiastic]* Which I think is much fairer.

Callum: *[sceptical]* Fairer? I'm not sure about that. Some people get loads of help with them.

Lerato: *[conceding]* Okay, maybe not fairer exactly. *[thinking]* But I do think a portfolio suits someone who works steadily through the term, like me.

Callum: *[amused]* Well, it doesn't suit me. I'm a last-minute person. *[short pause]* But one thing I'll give you is that they swallow far more hours than you'd ever expect. I spent most of my Easter holiday on last year's.

Lerato: *[laughing]* Oh, absolutely. Mine looked tiny on paper and took me weeks.

Dr Pryce: *[wry]* Every year, students say the same thing. *[practical]* So, what's your next step?

Callum: *[uncertain]* I suppose we could email each of the module leaders with our questions.

Dr Pryce: *[gently discouraging]* You could, but they're inundated with emails at this time of year, so you might wait a while for a reply. And looking through past dissertations in the library is useful, but that's really for later, once you've chosen. *[encouraging]* What I'd do is go to the options fair on Thursday afternoon. All the convenors will be there, and you can just wander round and chat to them.

Lerato: *[decisive]* That sounds much more useful. Callum?

Callum: *[agreeing]* Yes, let's do that. I'll bring my questions about the dive training.

Dr Pryce: *[warm, wrapping up]* Good. Make a list of questions beforehand, though, because it gets very crowded and the convenors won't have long with each person. And come back and see me afterwards if anything's still unclear.

Narrator: *That is the end of Part 3. You now have one minute to check your answers to Part 3. [post: 60 s pause]*

Part 3 · Questions 21–30

Questions 21–25

What does the tutor say about each module? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A–G, next to Questions 21–25.

A	It has been substantially changed this year.
B	It is more difficult than students tend to expect.
C	It is valued by employers in commercial archaeology.
D	It clashes with another module.
E	It has a limited number of places.
F	Students must meet some extra costs.
G	It is unsuitable for students without a science background.

21 Maritime Archaeology

22 Human Osteology

23 Archaeological Illustration

24 Heritage Management

25 Archaeometry

Questions 26–30

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

26 What does Callum say about his summer excavation?

- A** Its methods of keeping records were poorly organised throughout.
- B** It caused him to change his long-term plans.
- C** He would have preferred to do more digging.

27 What is the tutor's view of Lerato taking both laboratory-based modules?

- A** The amount of work would be too great.
- B** It would limit her choice of dissertation.
- C** The two modules would support each other well.

28 What is Lerato most worried about regarding her dissertation?

- A** meeting the proposal deadline
- B** being able to study some important material
- C** the wide scope of her topic

29 Callum and Lerato agree that assessment by portfolio

- A** is a fairer method than examinations.
- B** is more time-consuming than it appears.
- C** suits students who work consistently.

30 What will the students do next?

- A** contact module leaders in writing
- B** read previous students' dissertations
- C** attend an event where they can talk to staff

Desalination Technologies

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A lecturer explains thermal and membrane desalination, its environmental impacts and new developments.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.50 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	Lecturer — female, 40s, clear, engaging, precise; British accent
Script length	6,258 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about technologies for removing salt from seawater. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. [post: 45 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture theatre, faint murmur fading] [clear, engaging]* Good afternoon. Today we're looking at desalination, the process of removing dissolved salts from seawater or brackish groundwater to make it fit to drink. It's worth remembering that less than one per cent of the water on this planet is fresh and readily accessible, so for many arid countries, desalination isn't a luxury; it's the main source of supply.

Lecturer: *[conversational, lightly amused]* The idea itself is very old. Sailors were boiling seawater and catching the steam on sponges as far back as the classical period, and by the nineteenth century steamships routinely carried small stills on board. *[more serious]* What's new is the scale. There are now around twenty thousand plants worldwide, and the largest of them supply drinking water to several million people each.

Lecturer: *[measured, explaining]* Broadly, there are two families of technology: thermal methods, which essentially boil water and collect the vapour, and membrane methods, which filter it. I'll take the thermal ones first, because historically they came first.

Lecturer: *[informative]* The most widespread thermal method is called multi-stage flash distillation. Seawater is heated, but, interestingly, not to boiling point. It's then passed through a series of chambers, and in each one the pressure is a little lower than in the one before. *[emphatic, slowing down]* Now, it's that drop in pressure, not any further rise in temperature, that makes the water boil, or 'flash', almost instantly. The vapour condenses on tubes, and that condensed water is your product.

Lecturer: *[candid]* The obvious drawback is energy. These plants burn enormous quantities of fuel. *[explaining]* For that reason, they're very rarely built in isolation. You'll usually find them right next to power stations, so that the waste heat from generating electricity can be used to warm the seawater. Engineers call this co-generation, and in the Gulf states it's the norm rather than the exception.

Lecturer: *[shifting gear]* Let's turn to membrane technology, and specifically reverse osmosis, which now accounts for the majority of new capacity worldwide. *[clarifying]* In ordinary osmosis, water moves naturally across a membrane towards the saltier side. In reverse osmosis, we apply very high pressure to the seawater to force it the other way, through a membrane fine enough to hold back the salt.

Lecturer: [cautionary] Those membranes are expensive and delicate, so the seawater has to be carefully pre-treated. [thoughtful] People often think the main threat is corrosion. Corrosion certainly affects the pipework, but for the membranes themselves the real enemy is fouling, that is, a gradual build-up of algae, bacteria and fine sediment on the surface, which steadily reduces the flow of water through them.

Lecturer: [upbeat] The good news is how much more efficient the process has become. [wry] You'll often read that energy use has halved since the nineteen-seventies. That's actually a considerable underestimate. A modern plant uses only about a quarter of the energy its equivalent did fifty years ago, and much of that saving comes from devices that recover the pressure from the outgoing stream and reuse it.

Lecturer: [practical] Even so, energy remains the single largest running cost, typically somewhere between a third and a half of the price of each cubic metre of water, which is why plants try to buy electricity at night, when it's cheapest.

Lecturer: [serious, measured] So, what about the environment? The first concern is the waste product, brine, which is roughly twice as salty as seawater. Because it's denser, it sinks and spreads across the seabed. [emphatic] Coral reefs tend to get the headlines here, but in fact the best-documented damage, particularly in the Mediterranean, has been to seagrass, which forms dense underwater meadows and is extremely sensitive to changes in salinity.

Lecturer: [explaining, precise] The second concern is the intake, where seawater is drawn into the plant. Two distinct problems occur here, and they're easily confused. Very small organisms, like plankton and fish eggs, are sucked right through the screens; that's known as entrainment. [slowing down] Larger creatures, such as adult fish and crabs, can't pass through, so they're pinned against the screens by the force of the flow. That's referred to as impingement, and it's the one that's easiest to reduce, simply by slowing down the intake velocity.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: [reasoned] Returning to the brine, how can its impact be reduced? The standard answer is diffusers: pipes with multiple outlets that spread the brine over a wider area so it mixes more quickly. [informative] An increasingly popular alternative, though, is to dilute it before it's released, by blending it with treated effluent from a nearby sewage works. This is less salty than seawater, so the two streams partly cancel each other out.

Lecturer: [enthusiastic] Finally, let's look at what's coming next. A lot of attention has gone to membranes made of graphene, a material just one atom thick. In theory, they'd let water through far faster than current membranes. [short pause] [measured, cautious] The problem isn't cost, as you might expect; the raw material is actually getting cheaper. It's that nobody has yet managed to manufacture sheets large enough without defects, and even a tiny hole lets salt straight through.

Lecturer: [informative] At the other end of the scale are small solar-powered units. The original idea was to supply villages in desert regions, but frankly, they haven't done well there; dust and maintenance have been major issues. [positive] Where they've proved most successful is on islands, particularly in the Pacific, where shipping in fresh water is extremely expensive.

Lecturer: [thoughtful] And one last development: brine mining. If brine is a waste product, could it become a resource? Salt has been extracted from it for centuries, of course, and magnesium has been recovered commercially for decades. [animated] But the real excitement at the moment is about lithium, because of the huge demand for batteries in electric vehicles. If that can be extracted economically, the economics of desalination itself could change completely.

Lecturer: [wrapping up] Right. For next week, please read the case study on the Sorek plant in Israel, and we'll discuss it in the seminar.

Narrator: That is the end of the Listening test. You now have two minutes to check your answers.
[post: 120 s pause]

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

Desalination

- 31** Multi-stage flash: water boils in a sequence of chambers because of a reduction in (31) _____
- 32** Plants are usually located beside (32) _____ stations to make use of their waste heat
- 33** Reverse osmosis: seawater is pre-treated to avoid (33) _____ of the membranes
- 34** Current plants need approximately a (34) _____ of the energy used in the 1970s
- 35** Strongest evidence of harm from sinking brine concerns (35) _____, e.g. in the Mediterranean
- 36** Large animals held against intake screens: this is called (36) _____
- 37** Alternative to diffusers: brine is diluted with (37) _____ from sewage works
- 38** Graphene membranes: hard to produce large sheets with no (38) _____
- 39** Small solar units: most effective on (39) _____
- 40** Brine mining: strong current interest in extracting (40) _____

FT09 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	Dannatt / DANNATT	Double letters twice; she warns people use a single N and T.
2	28th / 28 / twenty-eighth	The original date, the twenty-first, is said first and then postponed.
3	55 / fifty-five	Sixty and fifty-two are said first; the three trustees must be added.
4	11.45 / 11:45 / eleven forty-five	Noon, eleven fifteen, half past twelve and eleven o'clock are all mentioned.
5	sourdough	Rye was used in the past and white is available at extra cost.
6	9.75 / £9.75	£9.50 is read from last year's price list and then corrected.
7	lamb	The website still says chicken; a chickpea version is for vegetarians only.
8	socket	An oven and a sink are mentioned but are not needed.
9	beetroot	Hummus is ruled out; yoghurt, aubergine and horseradish are also heard (horseradish is not the main ingredient).
10	12.40 / £12.40	The standard price £13.90, the £1.50 reduction and a 10% discount are all mentioned.
11	B (serve communities who did not speak English as a first language.)	Sport and the reporter training scheme are mentioned but both came later.
12	C (listeners who pay an annual fee.)	The council grant ended three years ago; advertising is restricted by the licence.
13	B (finding people to work at certain times.)	The transmitter is old but repaired, and the audience has grown, not fallen.
14	A (attend a session on safety)	Sitting in with a presenter comes later; the online course used to be required but is now optional.
15	B (They are easier for disabled people to use.)	The building is further out, not more central; the builder only gave a discount, a listener's bequest paid.
16	B (requires availability at short notice)	A journalism qualification (C) is mentioned and rejected.
17	A (requires a commitment of at least one year)	Qualifications (C) and last-minute call-outs (B) are both explicitly ruled out.
18	G (requires attendance at a weekly meeting)	Voice auditions (E) used to be required but have been dropped.
19	F (can mainly be done from home)	A monthly face-to-face meeting is mentioned, which may suggest G.
20	D (involves regular weekend work)	A one-year commitment (A) and weekly meetings (G) are said not to apply.
21	F (Students must meet some extra costs.)	A timetable clash (D) is raised and denied; workload is said not to be the issue.
22	B (It is more difficult than students tend to expect.)	The tutor explicitly says a science background is NOT needed (G).
23	E (It has a limited number of places.)	Callum suggests it's good for jobs (C) but the tutor disagrees.
24	C (It is valued by employers in commercial archaeology.)	Lerato has heard it was rewritten (A), but the tutor says it is unchanged.
25	A (It has been substantially changed this year.)	A clash with fieldwork (D) existed last year but has been resolved.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
26	B (It caused him to change his long-term plans.)	The recording problems lasted only a week (A); he says he didn't mind the finds shed (C).
27	C (The two modules would support each other well.)	Workload (A) and dissertation choice (B) are both mentioned and dismissed with negatives.
28	B (being able to study some important material)	She says the deadline is fine (A) and the tutor says a broad topic is normal (C).
29	B (is more time-consuming than it appears.)	Lerato's claims about fairness (A) and steady work (C) are disputed by Callum.
30	C (attend an event where they can talk to staff)	Emailing (A) is suggested by Callum and discouraged; past dissertations (B) are 'for later'.
31	pressure	Students may write temperature, which the lecturer says is not what causes boiling.
32	power	Fuel and electricity are mentioned nearby but do not fit the gap.
33	fouling	Corrosion is mentioned first but affects the pipework, not the membranes.
34	quarter	The commonly quoted figure, half, is said to be an underestimate.
35	seagrass	Coral reefs are mentioned as getting the headlines.
36	impingement	Entrainment refers to small organisms passing through the screens.
37	effluent	Seawater and sewage are both mentioned near the answer.
38	defects	Cost is suggested as the obstacle but rejected.
39	islands	Desert villages were the original target but results there were poor.
40	lithium	Salt and magnesium have been extracted for a long time and are not the current focus.

Listening Full Test 10

FT10 · target band 7.0–8.0 · 4 parts · 40 questions · about 40 minutes of audio

Part	Title	Accent
1	Booking a Wildlife Boat Trip	British (en-GB)
2	Changes to Ashbury Market	British (en-GB)
3	The Economics of Music Streaming	Tutor British (en-GB); Maya American (en-US); Callum British (en-GB)
4	Animal Camouflage	British (en-GB)

Booking a Wildlife Boat Trip

Everyday social/transactional conversation (2 speakers) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A man phones a boat company in a seaside town to find out about its wildlife-watching trips and book one for his family.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.50 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Fiona	Booking assistant at the boat company — female, 40s, bright, efficient and chatty; British accent (light northern English)
Voice: Daniel	Caller — male, late 30s, friendly, slightly hurried, a father organising a family holiday; British accent (southern English)
Script length	5,706 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 1. You will hear a man phoning a company to book a wildlife-watching boat trip. First, you have some time to look at Questions 1 to 6. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Fiona: *[telephone rings twice, then the line clicks open] [bright, professional]* Good morning, Calderwick Wildlife Cruises, Fiona speaking. How can I help?

Daniel: *[friendly, slightly hurried]* Oh, hello. I'm hoping to book a boat trip for my family next month. We're coming up on holiday. But, um, I have to say I found your website a bit confusing. There seem to be quite a lot of different trips.

Fiona: *[warm, light laugh]* You're not the first person to tell me that. It's being redesigned at the moment. Shall I just run through the options for you?

Daniel: *[relieved]* That would be brilliant, thanks.

Fiona: *[clear, explaining]* Right. The shortest one is what we call the Harbour Trip. That lasts an hour and a quarter, and it goes round the bay and then out to the sandbanks at the mouth of the river.

Daniel: *[interested]* And what would we see on that one? My kids are desperate to see dolphins.

Fiona: *[gently honest]* Well, I wouldn't book the Harbour Trip for dolphins, I'm afraid. They tend to stay much further out to sea. *[brightening]* What it is good for is seals. There's a colony of about two hundred that come out of the water onto the sandbanks, and the boat can get surprisingly close.

Daniel: *[pleased]* Oh, they'd love that. And where does it go from? Is it the harbour steps? That's where we went from last time, but that was years ago.

Fiona: *[apologetic]* It used to be, yes, but the steps were badly damaged in a storm last winter, so all our boats leave from the floating jetty now. That's on the opposite side of the harbour from the fish market, right next to the aquarium.

Daniel: *[repeating slowly, as if writing it down]* The jetty... next to the aquarium. Okay. And how much is the Harbour Trip?

Fiona: *[reading from a screen]* For adults it's sixteen pounds fifty... *[short pause] [correcting herself, a little flustered]* oh, no, hang on, sorry, I've got last year's price list up. It's eighteen pounds fifty now. And children under fourteen pay half.

Daniel: *[good-humoured sigh]* Eighteen fifty. Fair enough. What about the longer trips?

Fiona: *[enthusiastic]* So the one most families go for is the Island Trip. That goes out to Ravenholm Island. Now, the website still says it's a five-hour trip, but we've shortened it this season, so it's four hours altogether, and that includes your time on the island.

Daniel: *[doubtful]* Four hours. Hmm. Is that going to be too long for a seven-year-old, do you think?

Fiona: *[reassuring]* Honestly, most children cope fine, because they get off the boat halfway through. *[informative]* The island's best known for its puffins, of course, and you'll almost certainly see gannets as well, diving for fish. *[slightly wistful]* There used to be a big colony of terns out there too, but they haven't nested on the island for three or four years now.

Daniel: *[thinking aloud]* Puffins and gannets. Right. And what is there to actually do once you're on the island?

Fiona: *[explaining]* You get about forty-five minutes ashore. There's a little medieval chapel, but that's shut while the roof's being repaired, so I'd walk up to the lighthouse. There's a small exhibition inside, and the view from the top is wonderful.

Daniel: *[interested]* Sounds great. And the price of that one?

Fiona: *[matter-of-fact]* It's forty-two pounds per adult, and that includes the landing fee for the island.

Daniel: *[hesitant]* Okay. And is there anything in the evenings? My wife mentioned something about a sunset trip.

Fiona: *[helpful]* Yes, that's the Evening Cruise. It's two hours, and it heads out to where the dolphins feed. *[carefully]* Now, we can't promise you'll see them. On average it's about two evenings out of three. But if dolphins are the priority, that's your best chance. It's thirty-five pounds.

Daniel: *[weighing it up, then decisive]* Hmm. I think the Island Trip, then. The children are mad about puffins anyway, and we could always try the evening one another year.

Fiona: *[pleased]* Lovely. Let me just take a few details from you.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 7 to 10. [post: 30 s pause]*

Fiona: *[efficient]* So, which date were you thinking of?

Daniel: *[checking a calendar]* We arrive on the twentieth of August, so... the Saturday would be ideal. That's the twenty-second.

Fiona: *[typing, then apologetic]* Ah. I'm really sorry, the Island Trip on the twenty-second is completely full. I could do the following day, if that's any good?

Daniel: *[thinking for a second]* Sunday the twenty-third, then. Yes, that works fine, actually.

Fiona: *[brisk]* Great. And can I take your name?

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Daniel: It's Daniel Pellow. *[slowly, spelling each letter clearly]* That's P... E... double L... O... W.

Fiona: *[reading back as she types]* B... E...

Daniel: *[politely correcting her]* No, sorry, it's P. P for Peter.

Fiona: *[light laugh]* Sorry about that. P... E... double L... O... W. Got it. And that's two adults and two children?

Daniel: That's right. The children are seven and eleven.

Fiona: *[practical]* Lovely. Now, on the day, you check in at the little ticket kiosk on the jetty. We used to ask people to turn up ten minutes before departure, but there's a safety briefing on the island boat now, with the lifejackets and so on, so please make sure you're there twenty minutes before it sets off.

Daniel: *[noting it down]* Twenty minutes. Fine. And what's the best thing to do about parking? Is there a car park near the jetty?

Fiona: *[explaining]* There's one right by the beach, but it's very expensive in August. And the supermarket car park is closer, but you can only stay there for two hours, which is no good for a four-hour trip. *[brightly]* What I'd suggest is the car park behind the library. If you show your boat tickets to the attendant, there's no charge at all.

Daniel: *[pleased]* Oh, that's handy. Thanks. And should we bring food?

Fiona: *[friendly]* There's no café on the island, so I'd bring a packed lunch. And warm clothes, even if it's sunny when you set off. It's always a good few degrees colder out at sea.

Daniel: *[chuckles]* Noted. Right, shall I pay now?

Fiona: *[cheerful]* Yes, please. I'll just put you through to the payment line.

Part 1 · Questions 1-10

Questions 1-6

Complete the table below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

CALDERWICK WILDLIFE CRUISES — TRIP OPTIONS

Trip	Length	Wildlife	Other information	Adult price
Harbour Trip	75 minutes	mainly (1) _____ on the sandbanks	departs from jetty beside the (2) _____	£(3) _____
Island Trip	(4) _____ hours in total	puffins and (5) _____	45 minutes ashore — chapel closed, so visit the (6) _____	£42 (landing fee included)
Evening Cruise	2 hours	dolphins (seen on most trips)	best option for dolphins	£35

1 Harbour Trip — wildlife: mainly _____ on the sandbanks

2 Harbour Trip — departs from the jetty beside the _____

3 Harbour Trip — adult price: £ _____

4 Island Trip — length: _____ hours in total

5 Island Trip — wildlife: puffins and _____

6 Island Trip — the chapel is closed, so visit the _____

Questions 7-10

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

BOOKING DETAILS — ISLAND TRIP

7 Date of trip: Sunday _____ August

8 Family name: _____

9 Arrive at the ticket kiosk _____ minutes before the boat leaves (for safety briefing)

10 Parking: free car park behind the _____ (show tickets)

Changes to Ashbury Market

Monologue in an everyday social context (local radio talk, with a short host introduction) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: On a local radio programme, the town-centre manager explains why the town's outdoor market is being reorganised and describes the new layout of the market square.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.55 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Host	Local radio presenter — male, 50s, warm and upbeat; British accent
Voice: Helen	Town-centre manager — female, 40s, confident, candid and well organised; British accent (Midlands)
Script length	5,394 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 2. You will hear a town-centre manager talking on local radio about changes to the town's market. First, you have some time to look at Questions 11 to 16. *[post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Host: *[radio studio, a short jingle fading out] [warm, upbeat]* And as promised, I'm joined in the studio by Helen Marsh, Ashbury's town-centre manager, to talk about the changes coming to our market. Helen, welcome.

Helen: *[friendly, confident]* Thanks, Jim. It's good to be here. *[measured]* I'm sure a lot of your listeners have heard that the market's being reorganised from April, and I'd like to explain why, and what it's actually going to mean for people.

Helen: *[candid, firm]* Let me deal with one rumour straight away. People keep telling me this is all happening because the market's losing traders. That simply isn't the case. We've got more stallholders now than we had five years ago, and there's a waiting list for pitches.

Helen: *[explaining]* What really started this off was a questionnaire we ran last spring. Over two thousand people filled it in, and the clearest message was that anyone working nine to five felt the market was never open when they could get to it. They were asking us, quite simply, to stay open later into the day.

Helen: *[more serious]* The other issue, frankly, was safety. At the moment the stalls run down both sides of Bridge Street, and delivery lorries are still squeezing between them first thing in the morning. We've had two or three near misses with pedestrians this year, and that can't go on.

Helen: *[even-handed]* Now, some of the shopkeepers on the High Street have complained that the stalls hide their windows, and I do understand that. But to be fair, that complaint's been made for decades, and it isn't what's driving the changes. And yes, the old canvas canopies are being replaced, but that's being funded by a regional grant. It's a separate project, not a reason for the move.

Helen: *[clear, moving on]* So, what's changing? First, the Thursday market. Some people assumed we'd move it to Wednesday, and we did look at that, but Wednesday's when the farmers' market runs over in Hexton, and we'd just be competing with them. *[reassuring]* So Thursday stays Thursday, and the opening hours won't change either.

Helen: *[explaining]* What will be different is what's on sale. From April, Thursdays will be given over entirely to food: fruit and veg, cheese, bread, fish and so on. The clothing and household stalls will move to Saturdays instead, when there's more room.

Helen: *[sympathetic]* I know a lot of traders have been worried about rents. We had originally planned a small increase for everybody to help cover the new canopies, but once the grant came through, there was no need for it. *[firm, clear]* So for the first twelve months, every trader will pay exactly what they're paying now, and we'll review it after that.

Helen: *[measured]* Some traders have also asked for a discount if they sign up for two years rather than one. That's something we're looking at, but no decision's been made yet, so please don't take it as a promise.

Helen: *[warmer, enthusiastic]* Now, the evening market, which is the really new thing. Our first idea was to hold it every Friday all year round, but the traders pointed out, quite rightly, that hardly anyone's going to stand about in the dark in January. And just once a month didn't seem enough to build up a regular crowd. So it'll be every Friday from May until the end of September, from five till nine.

Helen: *[apologetic, practical]* Parking is the question I get asked most. I'm afraid there's no room to create extra spaces anywhere near the square. We also looked at running a park-and-ride bus from the retail park, but the figures just didn't add up. *[brighter]* What we have agreed with the council is that the multi-storey on Station Road won't charge for the first two hours on any market day.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at Questions 17 to 20. [post: 30 s pause]*

Host: *[curious]* And Helen, the stalls are all coming off Bridge Street and into the Market Square itself. Can you describe how it'll be laid out?

Helen: *[clear, guiding]* Of course. Imagine you're standing on the steps of the Town Hall, looking out over the square. The fountain's in the middle in front of you, the High Street runs along the far side, and Church Street comes in on your right.

Helen: *[explaining]* The hot food stalls were the hardest to place. We'd thought about the corner just to your left, beside the Town Hall, but the council offices are right there and nobody wanted cooking smells drifting in. So they'll be in the far left-hand corner, where Bridge Street meets the High Street. That's handy for people coming over the bridge, too.

— **Chunk 2 of 2** —

Helen: *[informative]* The flower stalls need shade, so they won't be out in the open in the corner nearest the High Street on your right. Instead they'll be halfway down the right-hand side of the square, exactly where Church Street comes in, because the church wall keeps the sun off them for most of the day.

Helen: *[clarifying]* The information point is moving too. It used to be in front of the fountain, on the High Street side. From April, you'll find it right beside the fountain, on its left-hand side as you look from the Town Hall steps, so it's the first thing you see if you come in from Bridge Street.

Helen: *[warm]* And finally, we're adding a seating area with benches and some planters. We'd hoped to put that on the left-hand side, beside the bank, but the bank needs that space kept clear for the queue at its cash machines. So the seating will go in the corner just to your right as you come down the Town Hall steps, at the end of the building, which is lovely and sunny in the afternoon.

Host: *[cheerful, wrapping up]* Sounds great. Helen Marsh, thank you very much.

Part 2 · Questions 11-20

Questions 11-12

Choose TWO letters, A-E.

11-12 Which TWO reasons does Helen give for reorganising the market?

- A** a fall in the number of people running stalls
- B** objections from owners of nearby shops
- C** a demand for the market to operate at different times
- D** a risk of accidents in the current location
- E** the poor condition of the market's equipment

Questions 13-16

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

13 What will change about the Thursday market?

- A** It will be held on a different day.
- B** It will sell a narrower range of goods.
- C** It will open for fewer hours.

14 What does Helen say about stallholders' rents?

- A** They will go up slightly to pay for new canopies.
- B** They will not change for a year.
- C** They will be lower for traders who commit for longer.

15 The new evening market will take place

- A** weekly throughout the year.
- B** once a month.
- C** weekly for part of the year.

16 What has been arranged for shoppers who come by car?

- A** free parking for a limited period
- B** additional parking spaces close to the market
- C** a bus service from a car park outside the centre

Questions 17-20

Label the plan below. Write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 17-20.

NEW MARKET LAYOUT — MARKET SQUARE

Plan (for the designer): A rectangular Market Square, wider east-west than north-south. The TOWN HALL fills the north side, with its STEPS in the middle of its south face, leading down into the square (the listener stands on these steps facing south). A FOUNTAIN (circle) is in the centre of the square. The HIGH STREET runs east-west along the whole south side. CHURCH STREET enters the square from the west, at the midpoint of the west side; a CHURCH is drawn just outside the square to the north of Church Street. BRIDGE STREET leaves the square's south-east corner heading east towards a RIVER/BRIDGE drawn at the right-hand edge. A BANK (labelled, with cash machines) stands on the east side of the square, halfway along. COUNCIL OFFICES are labelled at the east end of the Town Hall. Letter positions: A = north-west corner of the square, beside the west end of the Town Hall. B = north-east corner, beside the east end of the Town Hall (by the council offices). C = midpoint of the west side, where Church Street enters. D = immediately east of the fountain. E = east side, in front of the bank. F = south-west corner, at the High Street. G = between the fountain and the High Street (directly south of the fountain). H = south-east corner, where Bridge Street meets the High Street.

A	A
B	B
C	C
D	D
E	E
F	F
G	G

H	H
----------	---

- 17** Hot food stalls
- 18** Flower stalls
- 19** Information point
- 20** Seating area

The Economics of Music Streaming

Academic discussion: 2 students + tutor · Tutor British (en-GB); Maya American (en-US); Callum British (en-GB)

Scenario: Two business students discuss their project on the economics of music streaming with their tutor.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Dialogue (one voice per speaker label)
Voice settings	Stability $\approx$ 0.45 · Similarity $\approx$ 0.75
Accent / locale	Tutor British (en-GB); Maya American (en-US); Callum British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Dr Hughes	Tutor — female, 50s, precise, encouraging but probing; British RP accent
Voice: Maya	Student — female, early 20s, energetic, quick to form opinions; American accent (en-US)
Voice: Callum	Student — male, early 20s, cautious, analytical, slightly dry humour; British accent (Scottish-influenced)
Script length	6,189 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: *Part 3. You will hear two students, Maya and Callum, talking to their tutor about their project on the economics of music streaming. First, you have some time to look at Questions 21 to 25. [post: 30 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Dr Hughes: *[office, a door closing softly] [warm, businesslike]* Come in, both of you. So, how's the streaming project going? You're about halfway through now, aren't you?

Maya: *[energetic]* Yeah, just about. And honestly, it's been kind of eye-opening.

Dr Hughes: *[interested]* In what way? What's struck you most so far?

Maya: *[thinking aloud]* Well, I went in expecting the big story to be how differently the platforms pay per stream. And they do vary, but it's a fraction of a cent either way, so that wasn't really the headline.

Callum: *[dry]* And everyone keeps telling us that vinyl's making a comeback, but I'd read loads about that before we started, so it was hardly news to me.

Dr Hughes: *[curious]* Not the gap between the top artists and everyone else?

Maya: *[light laugh]* No, we kind of knew that going in. The top one percent taking most of the money is no secret.

Maya: *[emphatic]* What neither of us had expected was that the streaming companies themselves are barely making any money. Most of them have run at a loss for years. We'd both assumed they were the ones getting rich.

Dr Hughes: *[knowingly]* Yes, that surprises a lot of people. Now, your original plan was to compare artists' contracts across different record labels. You've moved away from that, I gather?

Callum: *[slightly rueful]* We have. It wasn't that the topic had been done to death. There's quite a bit written on it, but we could've found a new angle. *[sighs]* The problem was that none of the labels would let us see the actual figures. Every contract we asked about was confidential.

Dr Hughes: *[measured]* I did warn you it was ambitious, but I wouldn't have told you to drop it. It just wasn't going to work without the numbers. Fair enough. So, you've done some interviews instead. How many?

Maya: Eight. Mostly local musicians, plus a couple of people from small labels.

Dr Hughes: *[thoughtful, probing]* Eight's perfectly adequate for a project of this scale, so the number doesn't worry me. And I'm glad you recorded them all. *[more critical]* What does concern me is the way a few of the questions were worded. Asking someone, 'Don't you feel you're underpaid?' rather invites them to agree with you.

Callum: *[conceding, a little embarrassed]* Yeah, that's fair. That one was mine.

Maya: *[keen, moving on]* Can we talk about the user-centric model? Where your subscription only goes to the artists you actually listen to, rather than into one big pool. I think it'd be so much fairer, especially for niche artists, like jazz or folk musicians, whose fans pay but whose money ends up with the big pop stars.

Callum: *[sceptical, careful]* I'm not so sure. The studies we've read suggest it would shift income by a few percent at most. For the vast majority of musicians, I really don't think it would change much at all.

Dr Hughes: *[even-handed]* The platforms also argue it would be expensive to run, though I suspect they've exaggerated that. Anyway, you can present both views. And for the presentation itself?

Maya: *[enthusiastic]* I wanted to do a live demo of the royalty calculator we built, but...

Callum: *[interrupting, wry]* But the Wi-Fi in that seminar room is a nightmare, so that's out.

Dr Hughes: *[gently]* And please don't add any more comparison charts. Your draft slides already have far too many. What would really bring it to life is something more concrete.

Callum: *[decisive]* Then let's follow one local band's earnings over a year, from start to finish. We've got the data from the Harbour Lights interview.

Maya: *[agreeing]* Okay, yeah. Let's go with that.

Narrator: *Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at Questions 26 to 30. [post: 30 s pause]*

Dr Hughes: *[businesslike]* Right. Now, in the findings section, you look at different groups in the industry. Talk me through them.

Maya: *[organised]* Sure. We started with the major labels. You'd expect their streaming money to come from whatever's in the charts right now, but it doesn't. Something like seventy percent comes from recordings that are more than eighteen months old. A lot of it's music from the eighties and nineties.

Dr Hughes: *[probing]* And why is that, do you think?

Callum: *[thoughtful]* Partly the recommendation algorithms, which keep suggesting familiar songs. And older listeners have finally moved over to streaming, so they're playing what they grew up with.

Callum: *[adding]* And people assume they've got all the power in negotiations with the platforms. We'd question that, actually. The platforms need them, but they need the platforms just as much now.

Dr Hughes: Interesting. What about songwriters?

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Callum: *[explaining carefully]* I'd assumed streaming would be their biggest earner, but for most of them it isn't. Radio and TV licensing still bring in more. The real finding, though, was that huge sums never reach them, because the information attached to each track, the writers' names and so on, is so often missing or wrong. So the money can't be matched to anyone.

Dr Hughes: *[serious]* Yes, that's a well-documented problem. And session musicians?

Maya: *[a little indignant]* That's the one that really got to me. You'd think they'd make up for it by selling T-shirts and things, but they can't, because they're not the face of the band. They're paid a one-off fee for the recording, and that's it. However many millions of times the track's streamed, they don't get another penny.

Callum: *[quietly]* A couple of musicians' unions are campaigning to change that, but nothing's been agreed so far.

Dr Hughes: *[thoughtful]* Mm. And the independent labels?

Callum: *[considering]* Some of them sell merchandise, but they always have, so that's nothing new. What has changed is that, by joining together through a few big distributors, they can now negotiate with the platforms on much better terms than they could ten years ago.

Maya: *[slightly doubtful]* I'm not sure that applies to the really small ones, but, yeah, overall that's what the evidence shows.

Dr Hughes: *[encouraging]* Fine, just acknowledge that. And the last group, the concert promoters?

Maya: *[lively]* They're actually doing pretty well out of it. They don't earn anything from streams directly. *[short pause]* But they look at where an artist's listeners are concentrated, city by city, and use that to decide where to book a tour.

Dr Hughes: *[amused]* So they profit from streaming without being paid for it.

Maya: Exactly. Not from it, but because of it.

Callum: *[light laugh]* Which is a bit ironic, given how little the artists earn from the streams themselves.

Dr Hughes: *[wrapping up, approving]* It is. Well, this is all coming together nicely. Get the revised slides to me by Friday, and we'll go through them next week.

Part 3 · Questions 21-30

Questions 21-25

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 21** What did the students find most surprising at the start of their research?
- A** the variation in what different services pay artists
 - B** the renewed popularity of physical formats
 - C** the financial performance of the streaming companies
- 22** Why did the students change the focus of their project?
- A** The subject had already been thoroughly researched.
 - B** They were unable to access essential information.
 - C** Their tutor considered the topic unsuitable.
- 23** What criticism does the tutor make of the students' interviews?
- A** Too few people were interviewed.
 - B** Some questions encouraged particular answers.
 - C** The interviews were not properly recorded.
- 24** What is Callum's opinion of the user-centric payment model?
- A** It would mainly help musicians in minority genres.
 - B** It would be costly for the platforms to operate.
 - C** Its overall effect would be relatively small.
- 25** What do the students decide to include in their presentation?
- A** a demonstration of a tool they have developed
 - B** a case study of one group of musicians
 - C** additional graphs comparing payments

Questions 26-30

What did the students find out about each of the following groups? Choose FIVE answers from the box and write the correct letter, A-G, next to Questions 26-30.

Findings

A	Streaming is now their largest single source of income.
B	Much of what they are owed is not paid because of poor record-keeping.
C	Their position when negotiating has improved.
D	Most of their streaming revenue comes from older material.
E	They receive nothing from repeated plays of their work.
F	They rely more heavily on merchandise than in the past.
G	They use listening data to plan live events.

- 26** major record labels
- 27** songwriters
- 28** session musicians
- 29** independent labels
- 30** concert promoters

Animal Camouflage

Academic lecture (1 speaker) · British (en-GB)

Scenario: A zoology lecturer explains the main forms of animal camouflage, including background matching, disruptive colouration and counter-shading, and their costs.

Setting	Value
Model / tool	eleven_v4 · Text to Speech (single voice)
Voice settings	Stability ≈ 0.55 · Similarity ≈ 0.75
Accent / locale	British (en-GB)
Voice: Narrator	Test narrator — neutral, clear, measured British RP; the same voice in every test
Voice: Lecturer	Zoology lecturer — male, 50s, articulate, lively, occasionally dry; British RP accent
Script length	5,876 characters (narrator excluded) · 2 chunks (use previous_text / next_text)

Eleven v4 Listening Script

Copy from here, including the bracketed tags. Speaker labels map to the voices above. Grey Narrator lines are generated separately with the narrator voice; the pauses shown are added in post-production.

Narrator: Part 4. You will hear a lecturer giving a talk about animal camouflage. First, you have some time to look at Questions 31 to 40. *[post: 45 s pause]*

— Chunk 1 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[lecture theatre, faint murmur fading] [lively, clear]* Good morning, everyone. Today we're looking at camouflage: the ways in which animals avoid being detected, or recognised, by predators, or indeed by their prey. It's a field that's changed a great deal in the last twenty years, largely because researchers have started to test ideas experimentally rather than simply describing what they see.

Lecturer: *[measured]* The simplest strategy is known as background matching, where an animal's colour and pattern resemble its surroundings. A stick insect on a twig, a sandy-coloured lizard on a dune. *[explaining]* Some species go further, and change their appearance as their surroundings change. The ptarmigan, a bird of mountain and tundra regions, is brown in summer and pure white in winter.

Lecturer: *[emphatic, slowing down]* Now, you'd naturally assume that it's falling temperatures that trigger the change. They don't. Birds kept in warm conditions still turn white on schedule. What sets off the moult is the shortening of the daylight in autumn, which is a far more reliable signal of the season than the weather.

Lecturer: *[informative]* Of course, a moult takes weeks. Other animals can change far more quickly. Flatfish such as the plaice, lying on the seabed, adjust both the shade and the pattern of their skin to match the sand or gravel beneath them. *[wry]* It was once believed this took hours. In fact, filmed experiments show that most of the change happens within seconds.

Lecturer: *[aside, slightly amused]* You may be wondering why I haven't mentioned the chameleon. The popular idea is that it changes colour to blend in, but that's largely a myth. Its rapid colour changes are mainly signals, to rivals or potential mates, so if anything they make the animal more noticeable, not less.

Lecturer: *[shifting, clear]* The second strategy is disruptive colouration. Here the markings don't so much match the background as break up the animal's outline. Bold, high-contrast patches create false edges, so a predator's visual system fails to see the separate parts of the body as belonging to a single animal.

Lecturer: *[explaining carefully]* An important detail is where these markings are placed. Patches in the centre of the body have relatively little effect. It's those that touch the edges of the body that do most to make the body impossible to recognise.

Lecturer: *[engaged, storytelling]* How do we know any of this actually works? Well, in a well-known series of field experiments, researchers pinned artificial 'moths' to tree trunks in woodland. You might picture solid plastic models, but these targets were triangles cut from paper and printed with different patterns, each with a dead mealworm attached as a reward. The researchers then counted how many mealworms were taken by birds.

Lecturer: *[pleased]* And the targets with disruptive markings survived significantly longer than those that merely matched the bark, particularly when the markings reached the edges of the triangle.

Lecturer: *[moving on, clear]* Which brings us to counter-shading. Many animals, from deer to sharks, are darker on their upper surface and paler underneath. The principle is often attributed to a zoologist, but it was in fact first described in the 1890s by an American painter, Abbott Thayer, which is why you'll sometimes see it called Thayer's Law.

Lecturer: *[explaining, with emphasis]* The logic is this. When light comes from above, a uniformly coloured animal looks lit on its back and dark on its belly, and it's this graded shading that tells our brains we're looking at a solid, three-dimensional object. Counter-shading cancels out the shadow on the underside, so the body appears flat and much harder to pick out.

Lecturer: *[intrigued]* A nice confirmation of this comes from certain caterpillars that habitually rest upside down beneath twigs. In those species the pattern is reversed: they're paler on the back and darker on the belly. Exactly what you'd predict, since for them it's the belly that faces the light.

Lecturer: *[informative]* In the sea, counter-shading does a slightly different job. Penguins and many fish are dark on their backs, so that from above they blend with the deep water below. But it's the pale belly that's more interesting. Seen from beneath, against the bright surface of the water, a dark belly would stand out as a clear silhouette. A pale one is far less visible.

— Chunk 2 of 2 —

Lecturer: *[enthusiastic]* One of the most striking recent findings comes from palaeontology. A remarkably well-preserved fossil of a small dinosaur, *Psittacosaurus* *"/sɪt.ə.koʊ'sɔː.rəs/"*, retained traces of its original pigment, and it clearly showed counter-shading.

Lecturer: *[careful, analytical]* What's more, the pattern of the shading can tell us about light conditions. Under direct sunlight in open country, the transition from dark to light on the body is quite sharp and set high up. On this animal, it was gradual and low down, which is what you'd expect under diffuse light. So the evidence points not to the open plains, as had been assumed, but to a forest habitat, with light filtered through a dense canopy.

Lecturer: *[briefly]* There are other strategies I'll only mention today: masquerade, where an animal resembles an object like a leaf or a bird dropping, and motion dazzle, the bold stripes that may make speed hard to judge. We'll come back to those next week.

Lecturer: *[reflective]* Finally, it's worth remembering that camouflage isn't free. People often suggest the main cost is the energy needed to produce pigments, but that's actually quite small. The real cost is behavioural. Camouflage only works if the animal stays motionless, so a well-hidden animal spends long periods unable to feed or look for a mate.

Lecturer: *[practical, wrapping up]* And it ties animals to particular places. A white ptarmigan on a hillside where the snow has melted early is very conspicuous indeed. *[dry]* With warming winters, that mismatch is becoming a real problem. Right, for next week, please read the two papers on the reading list.

Part 4 · Questions 31-40

Questions 31-40

Complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

ANIMAL CAMOUFLAGE

- 31** Background matching — ptarmigan: seasonal change of plumage is triggered by reduced _____, not by temperature
- 32** Flatfish (e.g. plaice) alter colour and pattern of skin: most of the change takes _____
- 33** Disruptive colouration — high-contrast patches hide the _____ of the animal
- 34** Markings are most effective when placed at the _____ of the body
- 35** Field experiment: imitation moths made of _____, with mealworms as bait
- 36** Counter-shading — first explained by a _____ (Thayer's Law)
- 37** Removes the _____ on the lower body so that the animal looks flat
- 38** Marine animals: a pale belly is hard to see from below against the light _____ of the water
- 39** Dinosaur fossil: gradual shading suggests the animal lived in a _____ environment
- 40** Main cost of camouflage: animals must remain _____, which reduces time for feeding

FT10 · Answer key

Alternatives after a slash are also correct. The trap column says what a weaker candidate is likely to write instead.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
1	seals	Daniel asks about dolphins, but Fiona says they stay further out and are not a reason to book this trip.
2	aquarium	The harbour steps (used in the past) and the fish market (on the other side) are both mentioned.
3	18.50 / 18.5 / £18.50	Fiona first reads £16.50 from last year's price list, and children pay half.
4	4 / four	The website still says five hours; the trip has been shortened.
5	gannets	Terns used to nest on the island but no longer do.
6	lighthouse	The medieval chapel is mentioned first but is shut for repairs; 'exhibition' is inside the lighthouse.
7	23rd / 23 / twenty-third	The family arrive on the 20th and first ask for Saturday the 22nd, which is full.
8	Pellow	Fiona mishears the first letter as B; the double L must be spelled correctly.
9	20 / twenty	Passengers used to be asked to arrive ten minutes before.
10	library	The beach car park is expensive and the supermarket one has a two-hour limit.
11-12	C + D (any order)	A is explicitly denied (more traders than before); B is a real complaint but 'isn't what's driving the changes'; E — the canopies are being replaced, but as a separate grant-funded project, not a reason.
13	B (It will sell a narrower range of goods.)	A Wednesday move was considered and rejected; Helen says the hours won't change.
14	B (They will not change for a year.)	A was the original plan, dropped after the grant; C is only being considered, with no decision made.
15	C (weekly for part of the year.)	Every Friday all year was the first idea, rejected by traders; once a month was judged not enough.
16	A (free parking for a limited period)	Helen says there's no room for extra spaces, and the park-and-ride was too expensive.
17	H (H)	The corner beside the Town Hall on the left (B) was considered and rejected because of the council offices.
18	C (C)	The corner nearest the High Street on the right (F) is mentioned and ruled out ('won't be').
19	D (D)	It used to be in front of the fountain on the High Street side (G).
20	A (A)	The space beside the bank (E) was hoped for but must be kept clear for the cash-machine queue.
21	C (the financial performance of the streaming companies)	Maya expected per-stream variation to be the story but says it wasn't; Callum already knew about vinyl.
22	B (They were unable to access essential information.)	Callum says it 'wasn't that the topic had been done to death'; the tutor says she wouldn't have told them to drop it.
23	B (Some questions encouraged particular answers.)	She says the number 'doesn't worry me' and she is glad they recorded them.
24	C (Its overall effect would be relatively small.)	A is Maya's view; B is the platforms' argument, mentioned by the tutor.
25	B (a case study of one group of musicians)	The live calculator demo is ruled out because of the Wi-Fi; the tutor asks for no more comparison charts.

Q	Answer	Trap / distractor
26	D (Most of their streaming revenue comes from older material.)	Negotiating power (C) is discussed for the major labels but Callum questions it.
27	B (Much of what they are owed is not paid because of poor record-keeping.)	Callum had assumed streaming was their biggest earner (A), but says it isn't.
28	E (They receive nothing from repeated plays of their work.)	Selling T-shirts (F) is mentioned but Maya says they can't.
29	C (Their position when negotiating has improved.)	Merchandise (F) is mentioned, but it is 'nothing new' for them.
30	G (They use listening data to plan live events.)	They earn nothing from streams directly, so A and E-type income statements are tempting but wrong.
31	daylight	Falling temperatures are the obvious assumption, explicitly rejected ('They don't').
32	seconds	It was once believed to take hours; 'weeks' is said for the moult.
33	outline	'not so much match the background' — candidates may write 'background' or 'colour'; 'false edges' and 'edges' are said nearby but belong to Q34.
34	edges	Patches in the centre are mentioned first but have little effect.
35	paper	Plastic models are mentioned first, but only as what listeners might picture.
36	painter	It is often attributed to a zoologist, which the lecturer corrects.
37	shadow	'shading', 'belly' and 'light' are all nearby; only 'shadow' is what is cancelled.
38	surface	'deep water' is mentioned for the dark back seen from above.
39	forest	Open plains had been assumed and are rejected; 'canopy' does not fit the gap grammatically as the habitat.
40	motionless	The energy cost of producing pigment is suggested first but described as small.